

DeskPRO Agent Manual

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1. Introducing DeskPRO

Welcome to DeskPRO!

This manual is about using DeskPRO as an **agent**. There are three categories of people who will interact with DeskPRO:

- **Agents:** the staff within your organization who use DeskPRO to provide help.
- **Users:** the people you are helping.
- **Admins:** agents who have administrator access to configure your DeskPRO helpdesk, change settings and permissions which determine how the agent interface works and what you are allowed to do.

As an agent, you'll access DeskPRO through the **agent interface**. Admins have additional access to an admin interface. Users may have access to a user portal, which agents can also log into if it's enabled.

This manual aims to be a comprehensive guide to using DeskPRO as an agent. If you just want a quick overview of how to get started, try the [Quick Start Guide](#) for agents.

If you want to know more about setting up and configuring DeskPRO as an **admin**, consult the [Admin Manual](#).

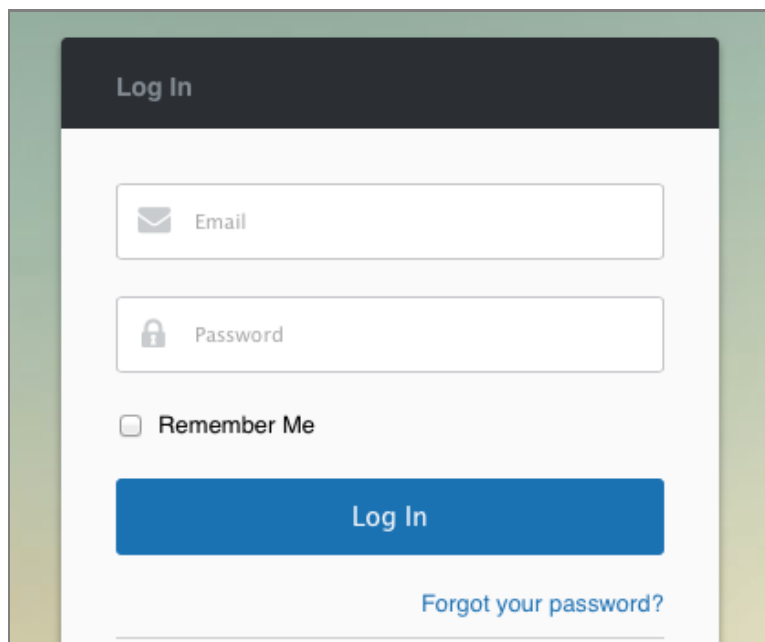
There's more help information available in the DeskPRO Knowledgebase at <https://support.deskpro.com/>, including how-to articles and troubleshooting guides.

You can also contact us directly at support@deskpro.com.

1.1. Getting started

You should have received an email with the subject "Your new DeskPRO helpdesk agent account" with your login details. If not, contact your admin, who will be able to create a new account for you.

Your administrators may have set up DeskPRO so you can sign in using your account from another service (such as LDAP, Microsoft Active Directory, Joomla, etc.).

A screenshot of the DeskPRO login interface. It features a dark grey header with the text "Log In". Below this is a white form area with a light green border. The form contains two input fields: the first is labeled "Email" with an envelope icon, and the second is labeled "Password" with a lock icon. Below these fields is a checkbox labeled "Remember Me". At the bottom of the form is a large blue button labeled "Log In". To the right of the button, there is a link that says "Forgot your password?".

If you check the **Remember me** box, you will stay logged in even if you close your browser. Otherwise, you will have to log out of DeskPRO from the [toolbar](#).

Logging in for the first time

When you log in, click **Preferences** at the top left to see your agent profile.

Check that your **Name** is correct. You can edit it if necessary.

Note that, by default, users will see the name you enter here. If you would prefer users to see a different name when you communicate with them, you can set an override name from your account preferences in the [Toolbar](#) to use instead. Other agents will still see your real name.

Check that the **Timezone** displayed matches your timezone.

DeskPRO automatically checks the timezone you choose against the one your computer is using. If they are different, DeskPRO will offer you the option to use your computer's timezone setting. Daylight Savings Time/Summer Time is handled automatically.

You should choose a picture to represent yourself to users and other agents. Click **Choose File** and select an image from your computer in GIF, JPEG or PNG format.

Click **Done, start using DeskPRO** to see the agent interface.

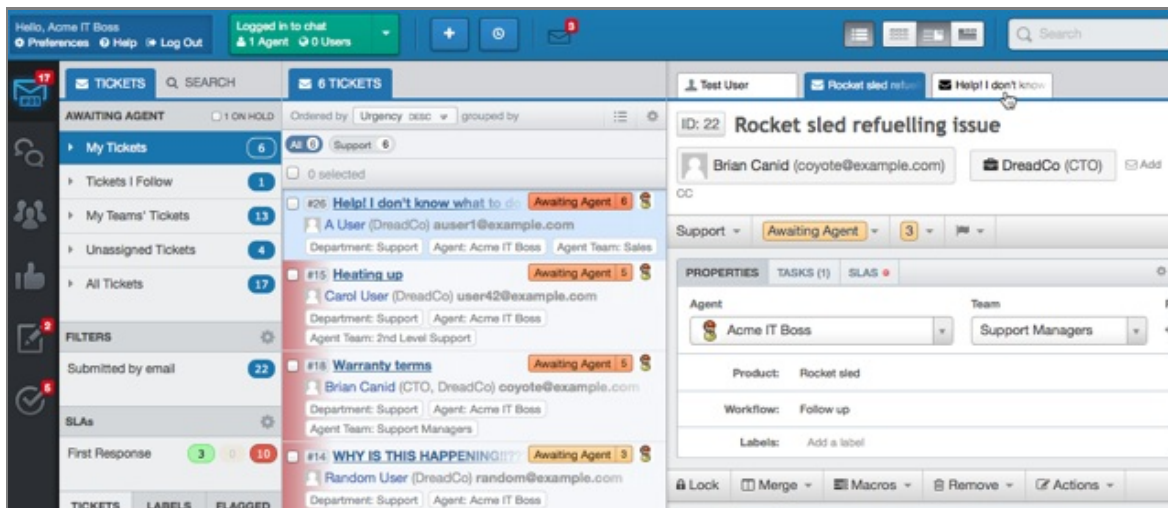
Agent permissions

Your account has **permissions** (set by your admins) which determine what you are allowed to view or modify within the helpdesk.

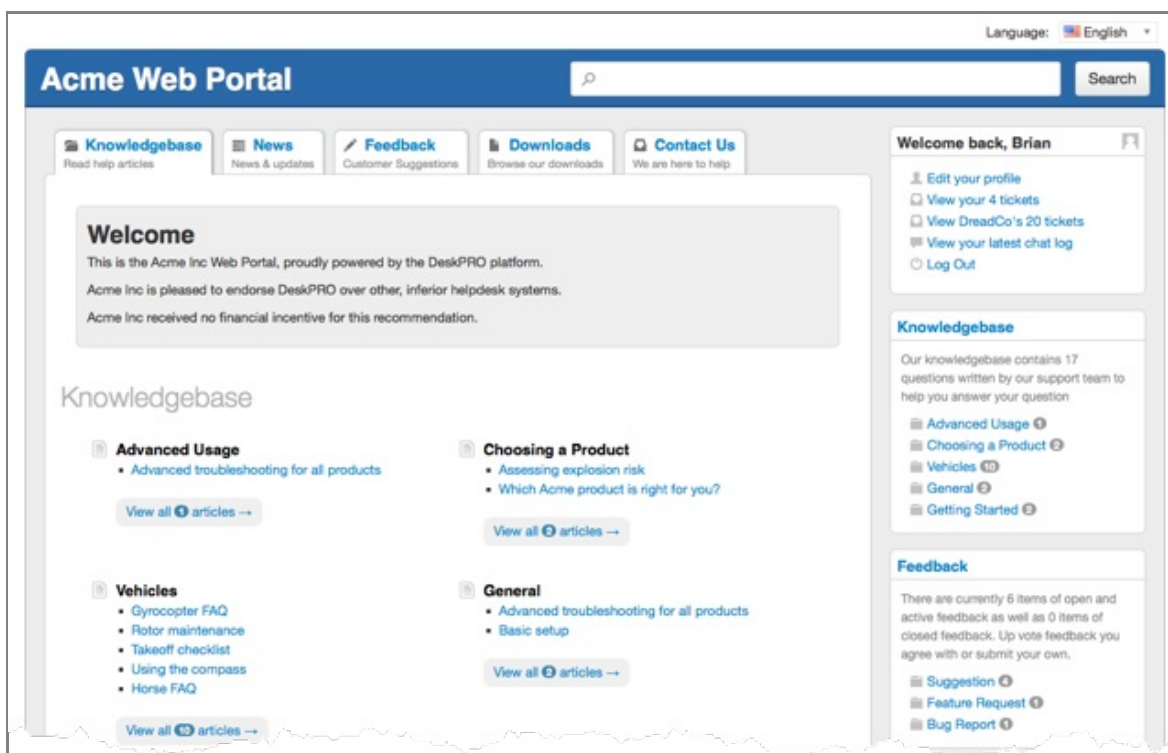
Depending on your permissions, you may not be able to use some DeskPRO functions. The administrators may also have disabled some helpdesk features altogether. If you find that this manual shows a function that is not available to you, consult your admins.

Agent vs user views

The DeskPRO agent interface is what you will use as an agent to provide helpdesk support to users.



Depending on how your organization has set up DeskPRO, your users may have access to a web portal where they can view their own tickets, and access help information:

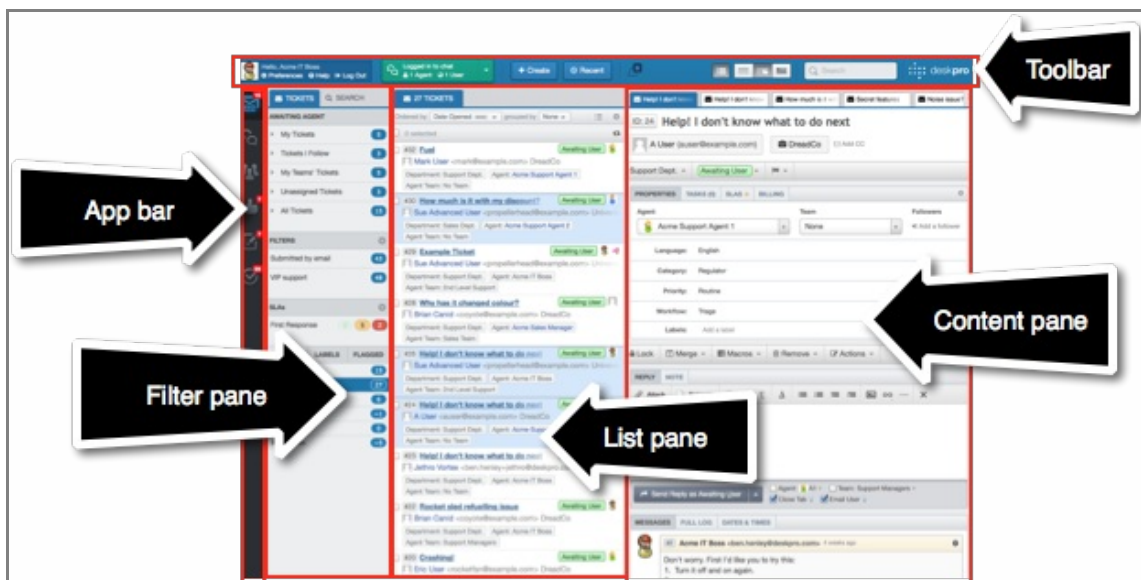


Users may be able to use the portal to submit tickets and provide feedback.

Your organization may not use the web portal at all, instead taking ticket submissions only through email or phone calls.

2. The Agent Interface

Here is an overview of the agent interface.



The **app bar** is where you select which DeskPRO app you want to use.

The **filter pane** lets you select groups of items to be displayed in the **list pane**, such as tickets, users etc. The app you're using determines what sort of items you'll see in these panes.

The **content pane** is where you can view and work with individual items. The tabbed interface lets you have multiple items from different apps open at the same time.

The **toolbar** offers quick access to important functions: your account preferences, logging into user chat, and the search bar. It's also where you can switch to a 1-column view that combines the filter and content panes.

2.1. App bar

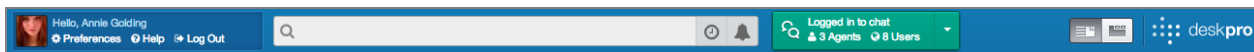
The **app bar** is where you select which DeskPRO application you want to use. Each app lets you work on a different type of helpdesk content.

The apps are:

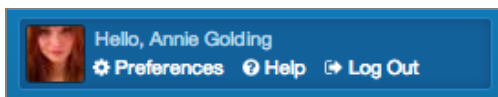
- **Tickets** - the main application you will be using as an agent to communicate with users about their tickets.
- **Chat** - this is where you communicate with users who have requested real-time text chat your portal or website, and view logs of previous chats.
- **CRM** - used to view a unified record of each user and their history with the helpdesk, such as all previous tickets.
- **Feedback** - view and manage crowdsourced feedback; users submit suggestions about your products/services via the web portal, and others can vote so you can identify the most popular ideas.
- **Publish** - create and manage the help content on your web portal; this can include news posts, downloads and articles
- **Tasks** - keep track of tasks that you or your fellow agents need to carry out.

2.2. Toolbar

The toolbar at the top of the agent interface gives you quick access to common tasks like creating a new item, and quick search.



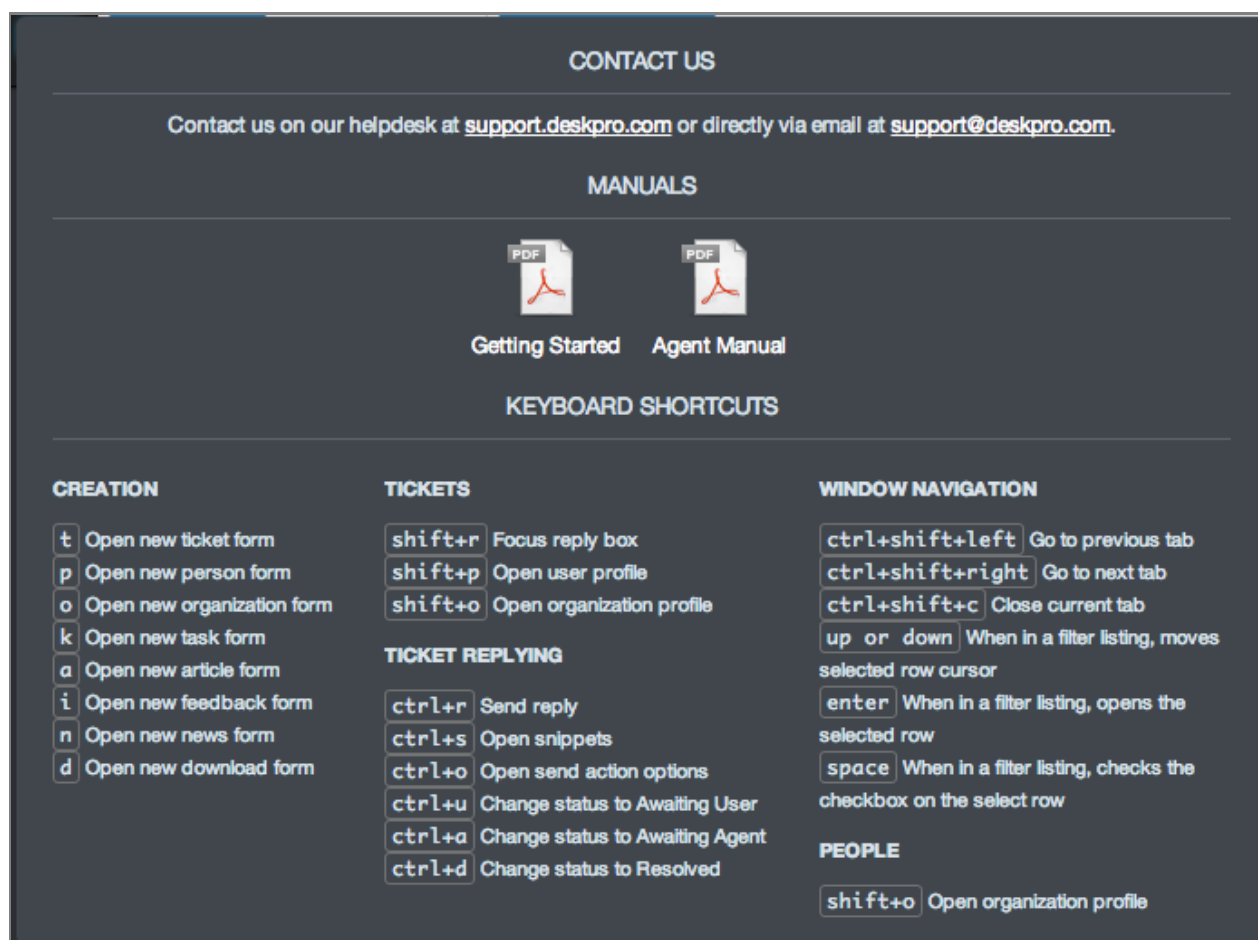
At the top left of the toolbar is the account area which shows you which agent you are logged in as, and lets you access **Preferences** and **Help**, or log out.



The Preferences link enables you to set options relating to your account: see [Account preferences](#) for details.

Help

The **Help** section tells you how to contact us, and has links to the latest documentation.



It also offers a guide to keyboard shortcuts you can use within DeskPRO.

Log Out

Click [here](#) to log out of your DeskPRO account.

You can just close your browser to log out, unless you selected the **Remember me** option when you logged in.

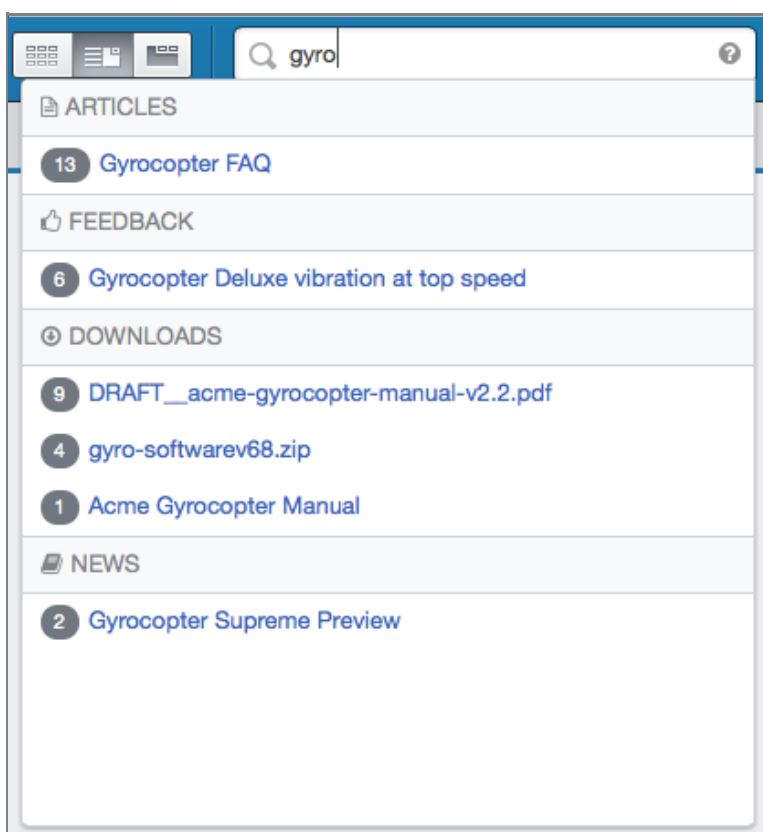
Search bar

The **search bar** is at the left of the toolbar.

If your helpdesk has a search technology called **Elasticsearch** enabled, you can use this bar for full-text search.

Otherwise, you can search for items by:

- **ID**
- **Ref code** (tickets)
- **Subject** (tickets)
- **Name** (users/organizations)
- **Email address** (tickets/users/organizations)
- **Title** (articles/news/downloads/feedback)
- **Labels**



If you need a more advanced search, you can search from the filter pane of most apps. The filter pane search lets you specify required values for multiple properties of a ticket. If you're getting too many matches from the quick search, the advanced search enables you to be more specific.

See the section on [Advanced ticket search](#) for details of using advanced search to find tickets.

The Recent button

The Recent button is the clock icon at right of the search bar.

Use the **Recent** button to get back to items you have viewed recently. Items are ordered by the time since you last viewed them, with the most recent at top. You can type to filter matching items.



This is useful if you want to go back to an item you've recently closed.

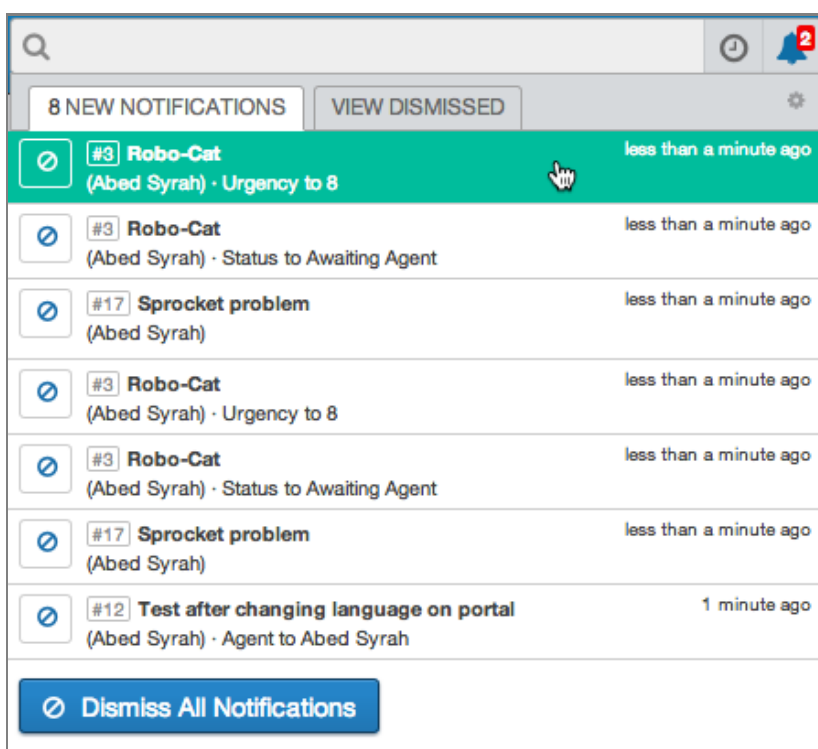
Notifications

The Notifications button is the bell icon at the right of the search bar.

This icon shows a count of your **browser notifications**, ordered by the most recent. The mail icon indicates that it's telling you about a ticket; different types of helpdesk content will have different icons.



Click the icon to expand the notification window:



You can control which events create a browser notification here using your [account preferences](#) or the gear icon at top right of the notification window. (You may not have permission to change your notification settings).

Click **Dismiss All Notifications** to clear all notifications. You can see dismissed notifications again using **View Dismissed**.

Toggling panes

These controls let you switch between 2-column and 1-column layout. The 1-column layout combines the list pane and content pane.



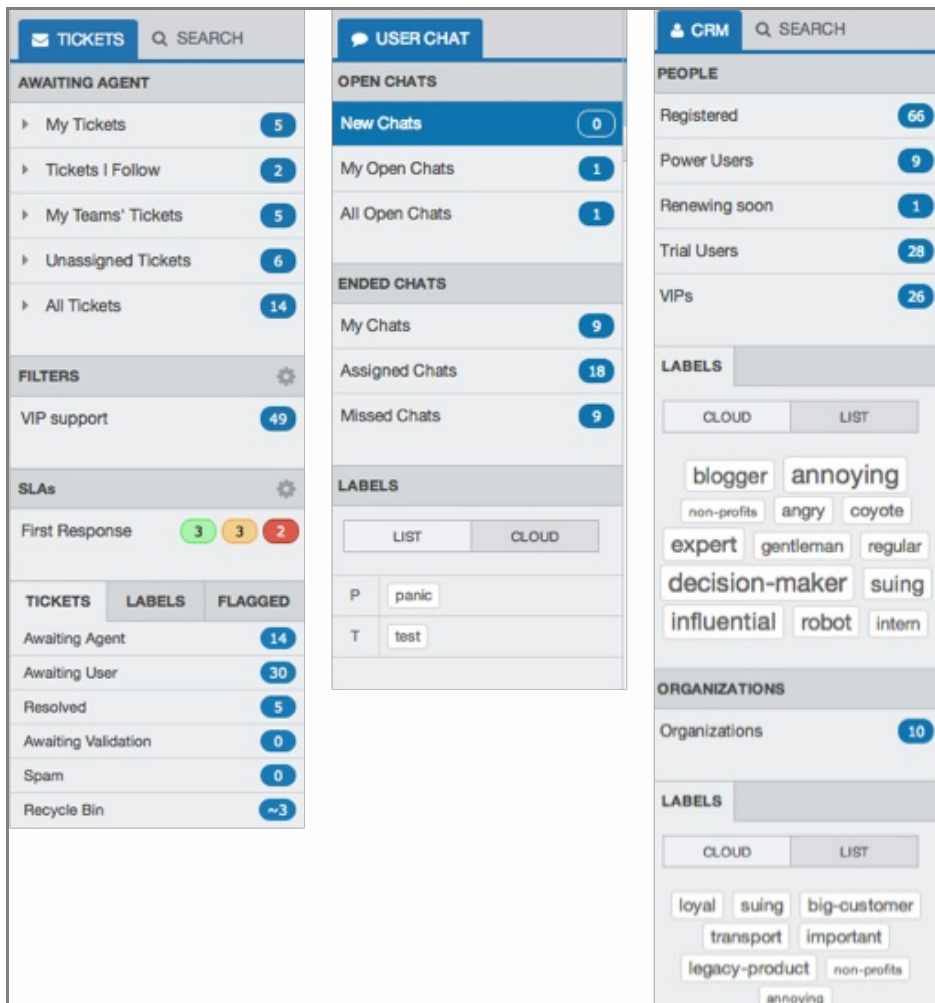
This can be useful if you are working on a relatively small screen, or if you just want to focus on a task in one or two panes.

See the section on [1-column view](#) for more details.

2.3. Filter pane

In each app, the **filter pane** on the left is used to filter the items you're dealing with: tickets in the tickets app, people and organization records in the CRM app, and so on.

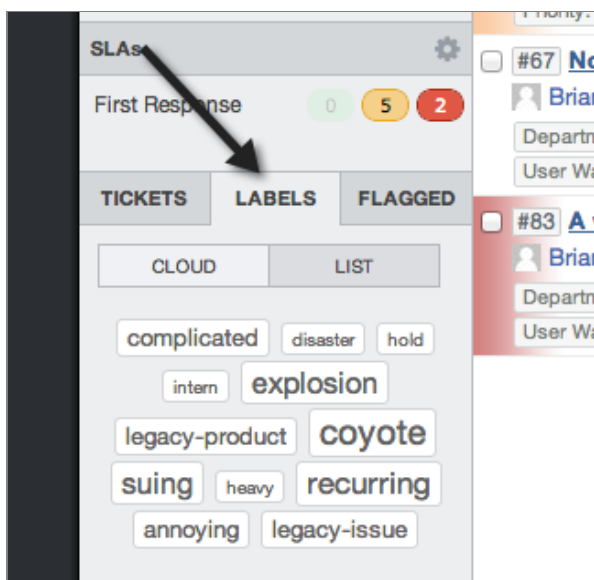
Selecting a filter lets you select a group of items to work on in the list pane.



Each filter shows only the items which match certain criteria - the number to the right of the filter shows how many match.

The **My Tickets** filter shows you tickets that are **assigned** to you. You are responsible for replying to the users who created these tickets, or otherwise helping to resolve the problem.

In most apps, you can also view items by **labels**: text tags entered by agents to help group similar items.

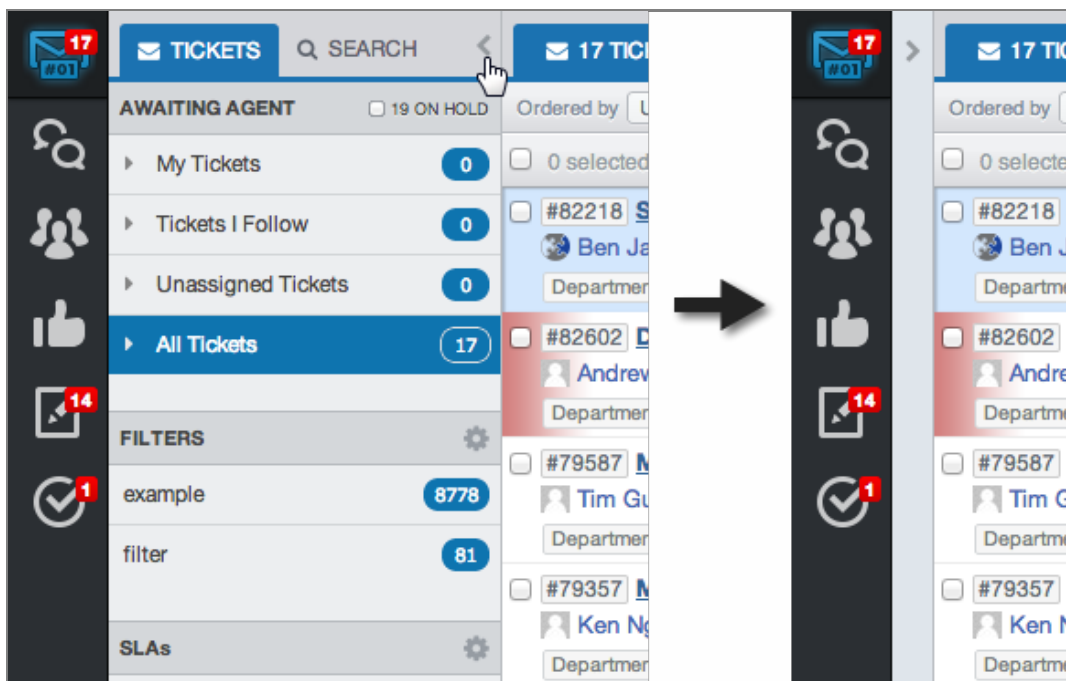


For more information about using filters in particular apps, see:

- [Filtering and sorting tickets](#)
- [Viewing closed and missed chats](#)
- [Filtering and sorting users and organizations](#)
- [Labeling Publish content](#)

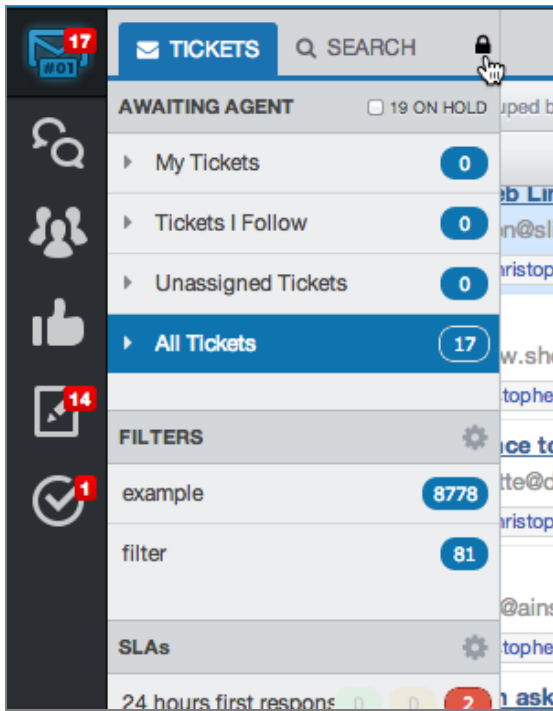
Collapsing the filter pane

Click the < icon at the top right to collapse the filter pane.



This is useful if you are working on a smaller screen and want to free up screen space, or if you prefer to focus on other parts of the interface and don't want to see the filters.

Mouse over the collapsed filter pane to temporarily expand it and select a different filter. It will collapse again when you move the mouse away, unless you click the lock icon in the top right of the pane.

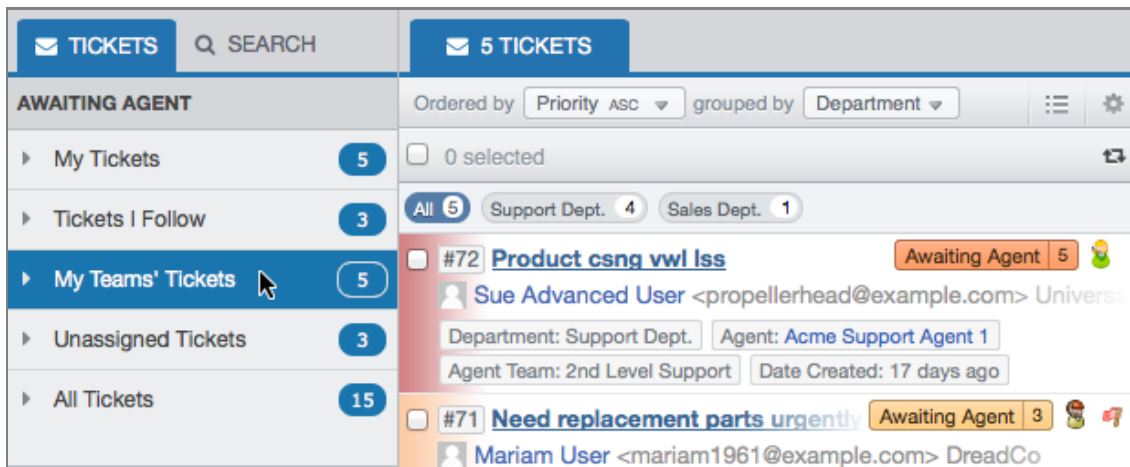


Clicking the lock keeps the filter pane expanded.

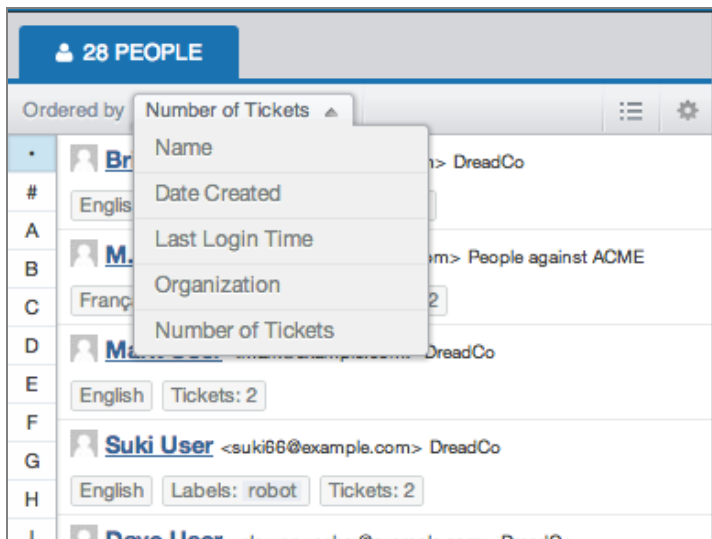
2.4. List pane

The result of your selection in the filter pane is displayed in the list pane.

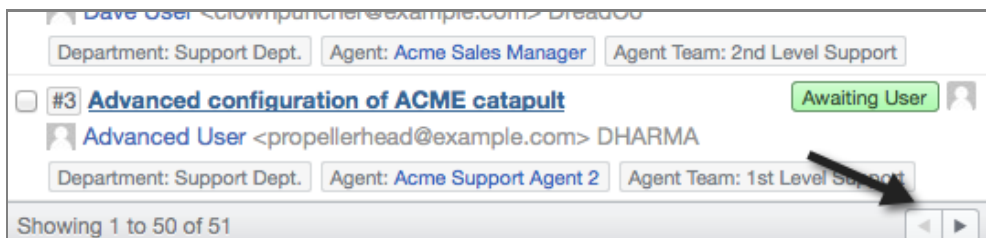
For example, if you click on a ticket filter, you will see the list of tickets that match the criteria of the filter in the list pane. You can think of it as being like a list of search results.



In some apps, you can change the ordering of items in the list with controls at the top of the list pane.

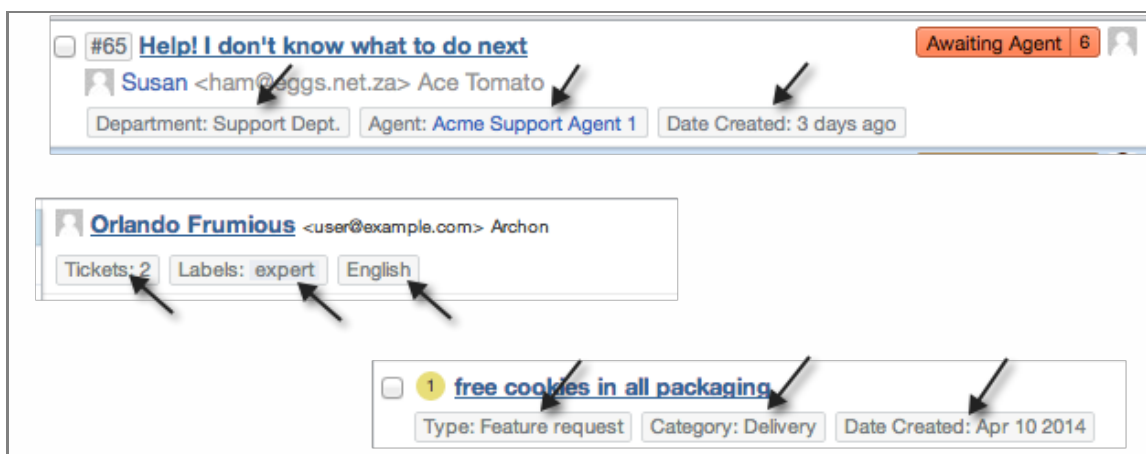


If you have more than 50 items in the list pane, the list is divided into multiple screens. Use the arrow controls at the bottom to move between screens.

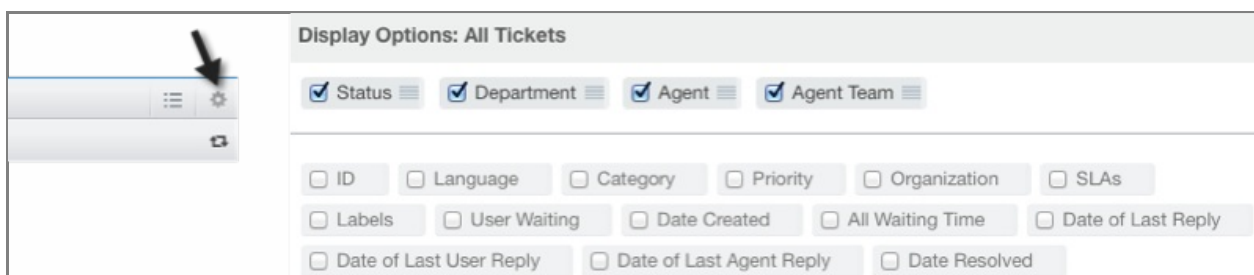


Viewing properties

In the Tickets, CRM and Feedback apps, properties are shown for each item using gray text labels.



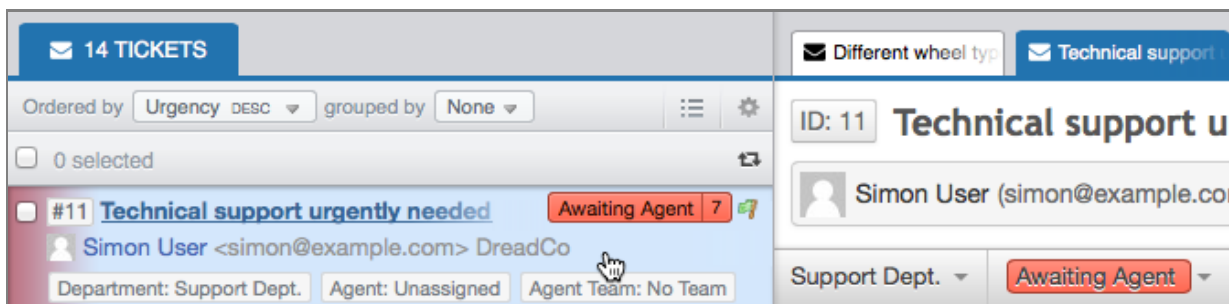
You can customize the properties which are displayed using the cog control at the top right of the list pane. Use this to display the properties that are most relevant to you.



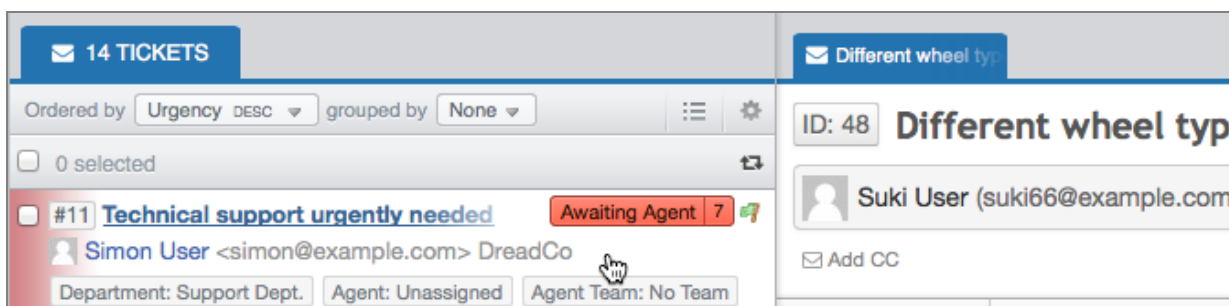
Opening items

You can **open** items from the list pane into the content pane to view them in more detail.

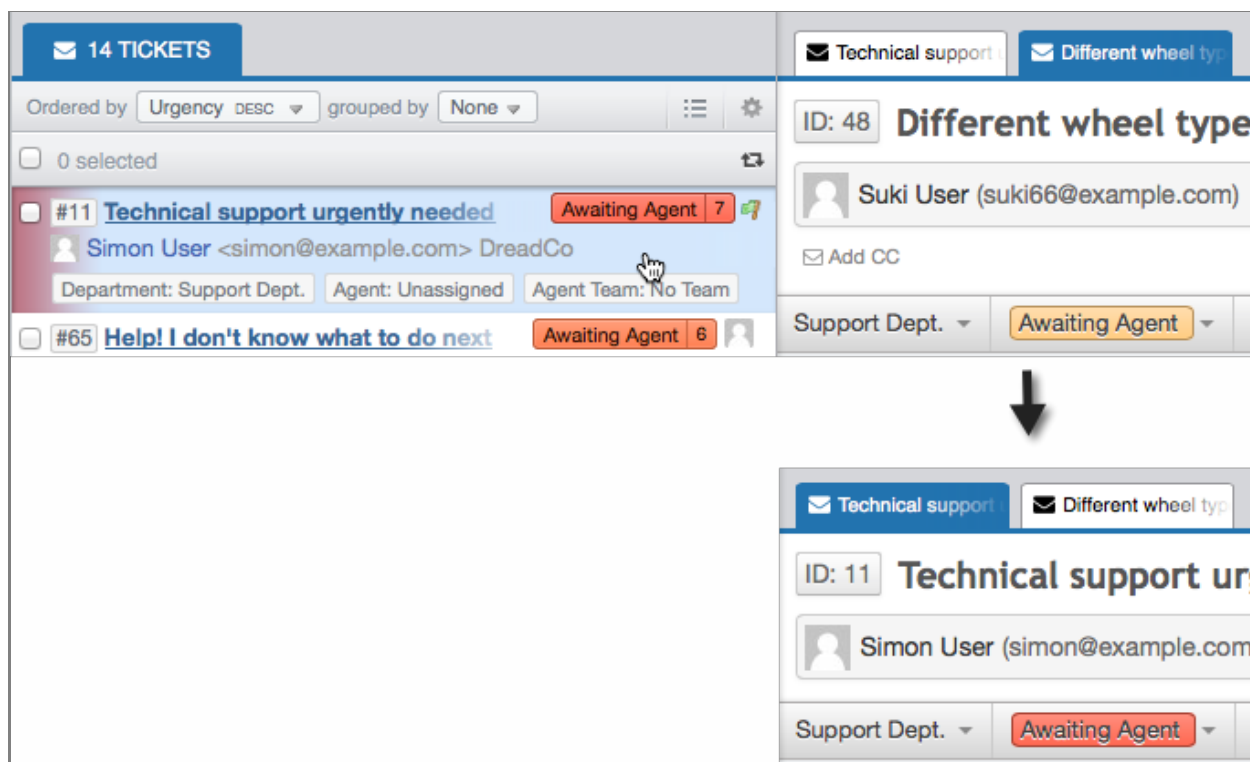
You open an item by clicking on it - it turns blue to show that it is open, and is displayed in a new tab in the content pane, in front of the tabs for any other items you have open.



Clicking an item that's already open *and* has its tab at the front of the content pane closes it.



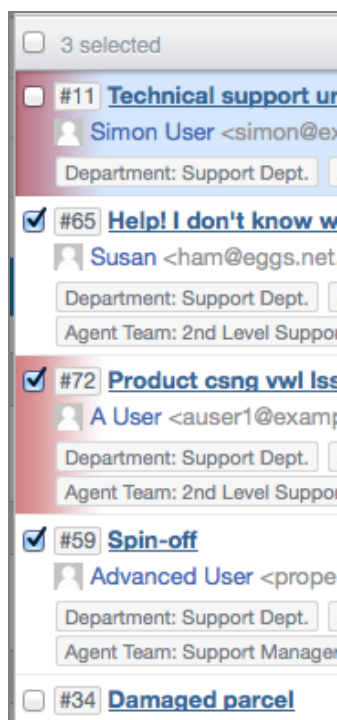
If you click an item that's already open but *not* at the front of the content pane, its tab is brought to the front.



In [1-column view](#), clicking an item from the list view opens it in the combined pane (or brings it to the front). You can go back to the list by clicking the  icon.

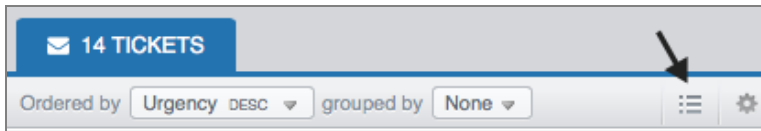
Multiple selections and mass actions

In the **Tickets**, **Tasks** and **Publish** apps, you can select multiple items from the list pane using the checkboxes at the left. This enables you to perform **mass actions** on up to 50 items at once - if you need to delete a lot of items at the same time, you don't have to open them one by one in the content pane.



Viewing a list as a table

In the **Tickets** and **CRM** apps, you can view the items in the list pane as a table by clicking on this button:



This is useful to get an overview of a long list of items.

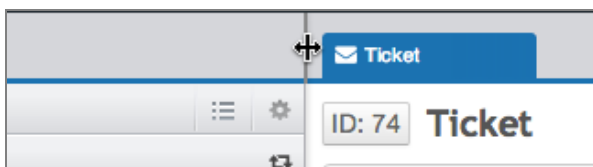
Subject	User	Department	Agent	Agent Team
#60118: Shipping Active Web Links	Ben Jackson	Support	No Team	Awaiting Agent 10
#60102: DeskPRO Issues	Andrew Sheppard	Sales	No Team	Awaiting Agent 10
#79087: Migrate local instance to hosted instance	Tim Guenette	Support	No Team	Awaiting Agent 10
#79087: Mobile app issue	Kan Nguyen	Sales	No Team	Awaiting Agent 10
#72775: Desktops installation asking for license code	John	Support	No Team	Awaiting Agent 10
#62148: No longer need Desktops	Gordon Roy	Support	No Team	Awaiting Agent 10
#60108: Jira Features and functions Documentation - User Guide	John Duggan	Support	No Team	Awaiting Agent 10
#60108: Chat Window in IE 8	Tammy Jackson	Support	No Team	Awaiting Agent 10
#60101: New Android Update Error	Terry Cook	Support	No Team	Awaiting Agent 10
#60108: Switching Victor to Atlassian's Account using Login	Shahar Mirza	Support	No Team	Awaiting Agent 10
#60118: Long Entries in Reply Field of Android App Don't Work	Kris van der Starren	Support	No Team	Awaiting Agent 10
#60100: email marked as unread in user inbox	Marin	Support	No Team	Awaiting Agent 10
#60107: Question: Seamlessly login our users from our site to our DeskPro	Gordyko Edward	Support	No Team	Awaiting Agent 10
#60104: Upgrade bug	Wes Richard	Support	No Team	Awaiting Agent 10
#60108: Agent custom email templates test after update	Alexandra Ripon	Support	No Team	Awaiting Agent 10
#60100: Escalations all and any conditions	Alexandra Ripon	Support	No Team	Awaiting Agent 10
#60118: anyone around today by any chance?	Jason Vukob	Support	No Team	Awaiting Agent 10

When you're in table view, you can export the items from the list to CSV format (accepted by spreadsheet programs) by clicking the  button at the bottom left.

Note that the CSV exported will contain many fields about the tickets/users, not just the ones displayed in the table view.

Resizing the list pane

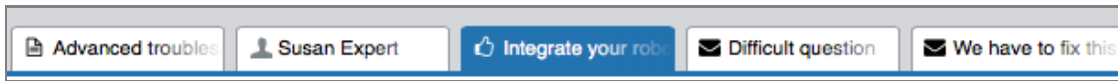
You can change the relative size of the list and content panes in 2-column view. Simply mouse over the top of the divider between them, click, and drag to resize.



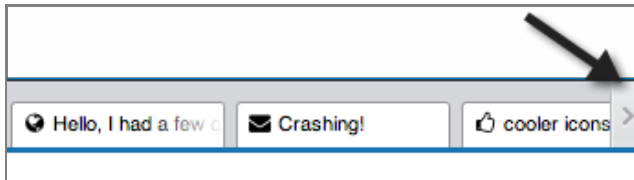
2.5. Content pane

The content pane is where you work with and create individual items (tickets, user records, articles etc.).

Note that, no matter what app you have selected, a mixture of types of items can be open in the content pane. You can switch between them by clicking on the tabs.

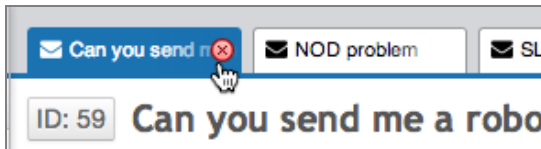


If you have more tabs than can fit in your browser window, you can scroll with the arrows at the edge of the tab bar.



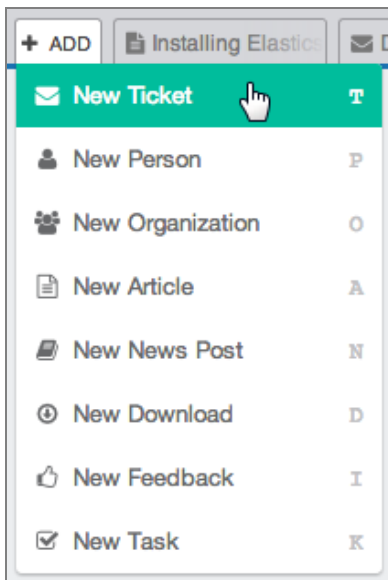
If the content of a tab changes while it's not at the front, (for example, a new message is added to a chat conversation), its borders will flash.

You can close a tab using the small X button that appears when you mouse over it:



Creating a new content item

Mouse over the + ADD button at the far left of the content pane, then click on the type of item you want to create.



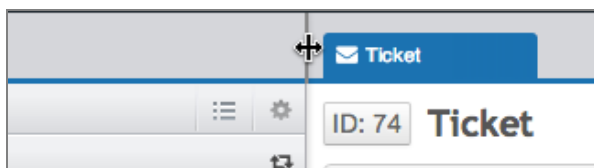
Alternatively, you can make sure your cursor is not in a text input box and then use the following shortcut keys to do the same thing:

t	Create new ticket
p	Create new user (person)
o	Create new organization

k	Create new task
a	Create new article
i	Create new feedback
n	Create new news post
d	Create new download

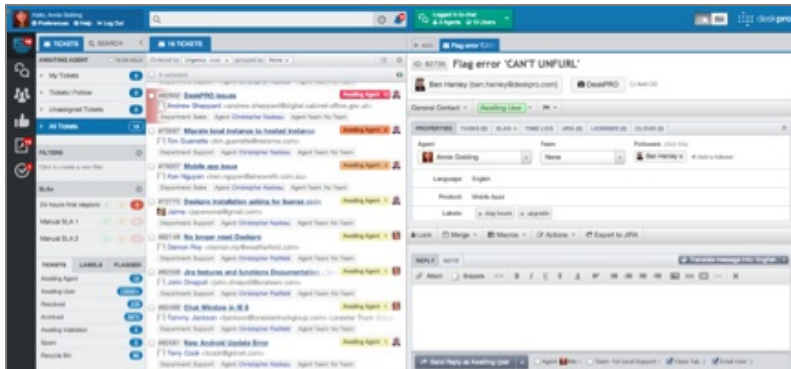
Resizing the content pane

You can change the relative size of the list and content panes. Simply mouse over the top of the divider between them, click, and drag to resize.



2.6. 1-column view

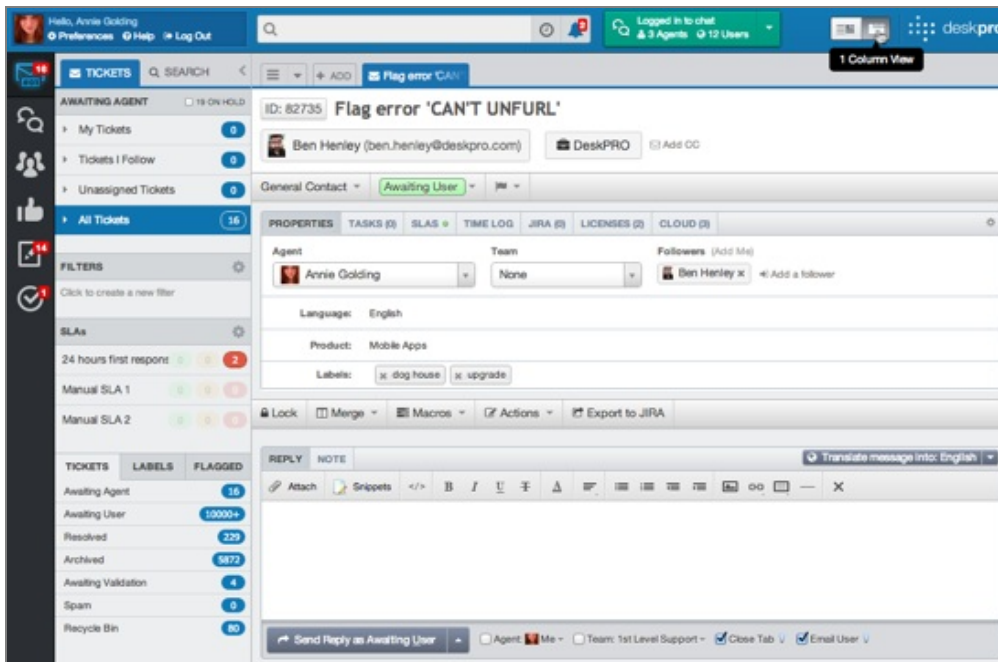
The default **2-column view** shows both the list pane and content pane.



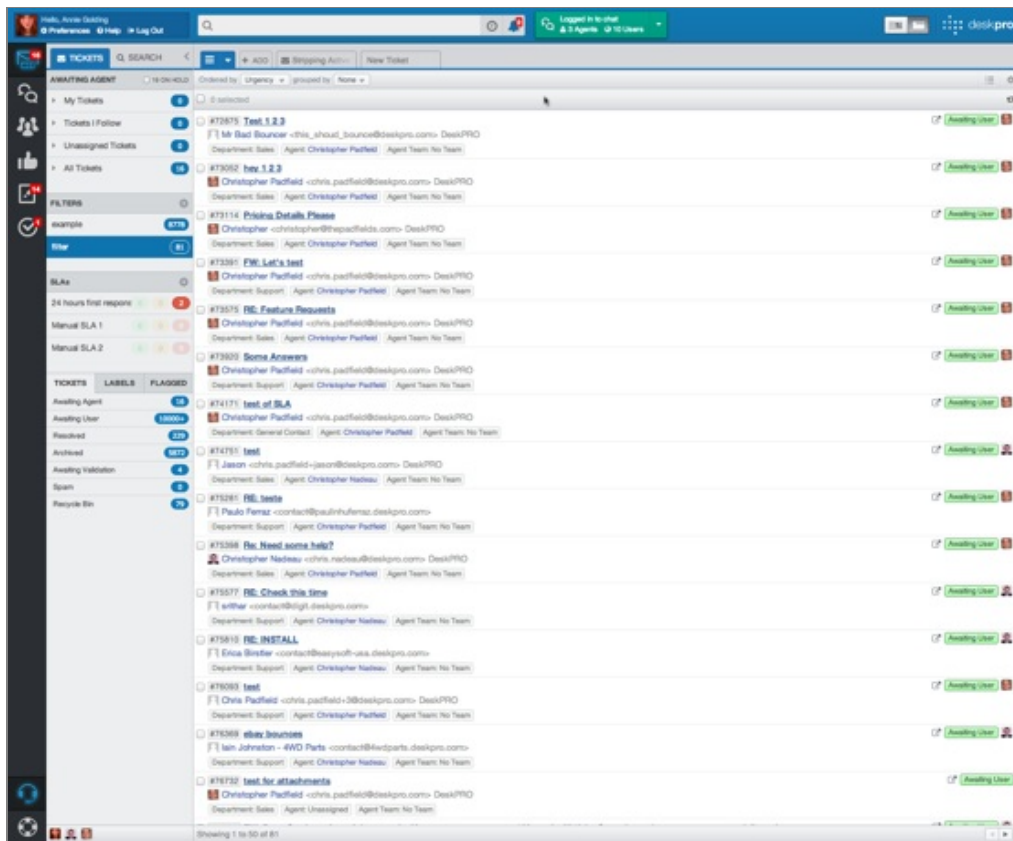
You can use the control at the top right of the toolbar to switch to **1-column view**. Using this view gives you more screen space when you are working on an individual item.

The list and content panes are merged into a single **combined pane** which displays *either* an individual item *or* the list of items matching the current filter.

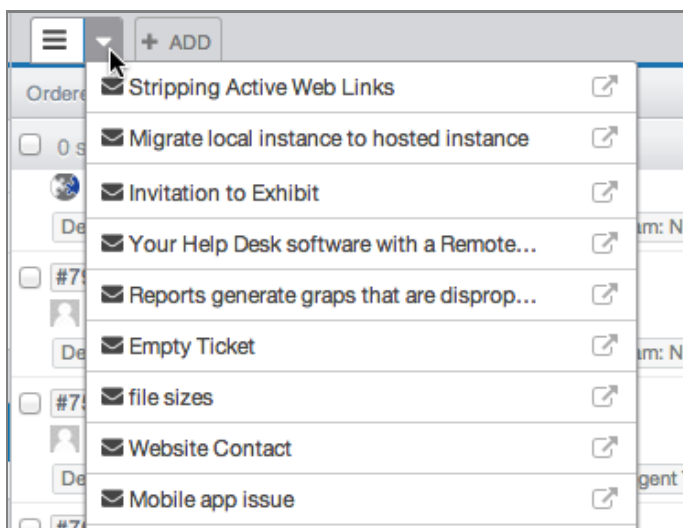
This is an individual item shown in 1-column view:



To view the list of items, click the  icon at the top left of the combined pane.



The control to the right of the icon displays the items in the list as a pull-down - you can use this even when you have an individual item focused in the combined pane.



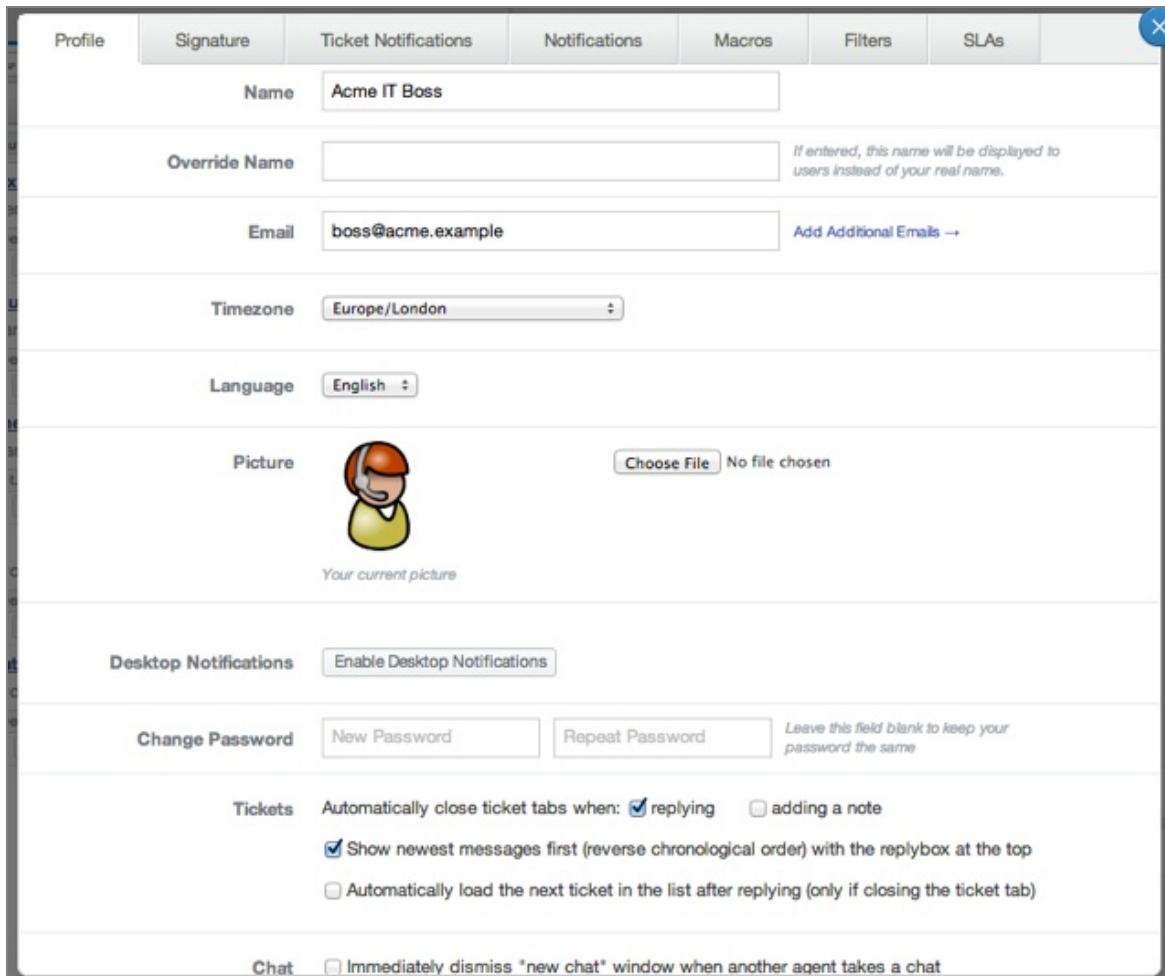
To open an individual item from the list (*replacing* the current focused item), click its title.

To open an individual item from the list in a new tab, click the  icon.

Clicking an item from the list view opens it in a new tab (or focuses it, if it's already open).

2.7. Account preferences

You can edit your account preferences from the **Preferences** link at the top left of the toolbar.



The screenshot shows the 'Account Preferences' dialog box with the 'Profile' tab selected. The dialog has a close button (X) in the top right corner. The tabs are: Profile, Signature, Ticket Notifications, Notifications, Macros, Filters, and SLAs. The 'Profile' tab contains the following fields and options:

- Name:** A text input field containing 'Acme IT Boss'.
- Override Name:** An empty text input field. A tooltip states: 'If entered, this name will be displayed to users instead of your real name.'
- Email:** A text input field containing 'boss@acme.example'. A link 'Add Additional Emails -->' is to the right.
- Timezone:** A dropdown menu showing 'Europe/London'.
- Language:** A dropdown menu showing 'English'.
- Picture:** A placeholder image of a person with a headset. To the right is a 'Choose File' button and the text 'No file chosen'. Below the image is the text 'Your current picture'.
- Desktop Notifications:** A button labeled 'Enable Desktop Notifications'.
- Change Password:** Two text input fields: 'New Password' and 'Repeat Password'. A tooltip for the second field states: 'Leave this field blank to keep your password the same'.
- Tickets:** A section with several checkboxes:
 - 'Automatically close ticket tabs when:' with sub-options: ☒ replying and ☐ adding a note.
 - ☒ Show newest messages first (reverse chronological order) with the replybox at the top
 - ☐ Automatically load the next ticket in the list after replying (only if closing the ticket tab)
- Chat:** A checkbox ☐ Immediately dismiss "new chat" window when another agent takes a chat.

Account profile

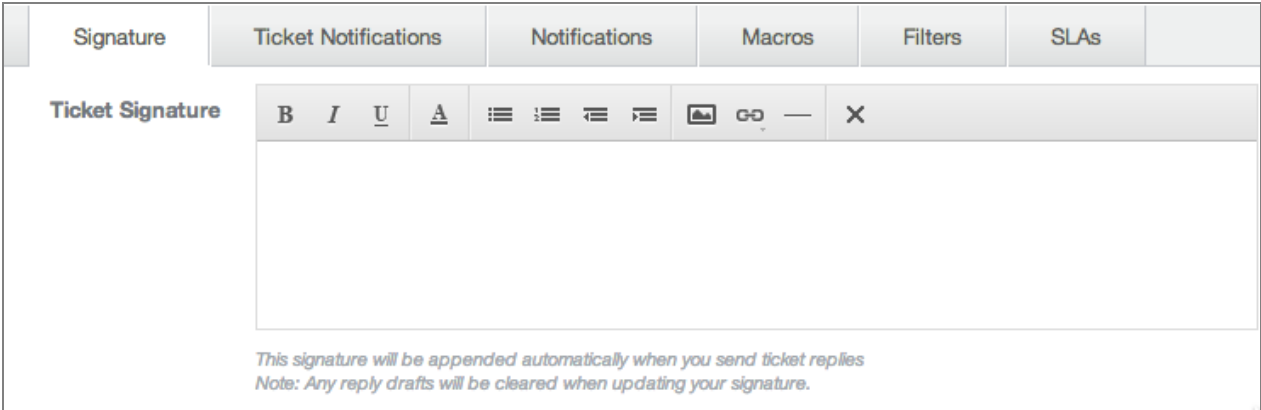
In the account profile, you can manage your account and set the following options:

- **Name** - this is displayed to your fellow agents in the agent interface; by default it will be used in email messages to users and on the web portal.
- **Override Name** - a name that is displayed to users instead of the name your fellow agents see. If you enter an override name, it will be used instead of the **Name** field in all user-facing communications (both in email and on the portal).
- **Email** - your main email address and any additional email addresses you want to use.
- **Timezone** - specify what timezone your helpdesk is in to ensure times are displayed correctly. Users can have their own timezone settings, so you should set this to the timezone where you actually work. Daylight Savings/Summer Time is handled automatically.
- **Language** - set your preferred language. You may be able to use the agent interface in this language if there is a translation available and your admins have installed it.
- **Picture** - depending on your permissions, you may be able to upload a picture to represent you. This will be displayed both in the agent/admin interface and on the user portal. You can change your picture by uploading a new one at any time.
- **Desktop Notifications** - with some browsers, you can receive pop-up notifications on your computer desktop about helpdesk events (such as when a ticket is assigned to you). See the section on [Notification preferences](#) below for more details.
- **Change Password** - you can change your password here. Password requirements are set by your admins.
- **Tickets** - you can change the behavior of the agent interface for replying to tickets here. The options are:
 - **Automatically close ticket tabs** when replying/adding a note - this closes the ticket as soon as you reply to it or write a [note](#) to fellow agents.
 - **Show newest messages first** affects the order that the messages within an individual ticket are shown under the reply box: by default, newest message are at the top.
 - **Automatically load the next ticket in the list after replying** means that if you reply to a ticket and **Automatically close ticket tabs** is enabled, the next ticket in the list pane will automatically open; enabling this is useful if you often have to work through a list of tickets in order.

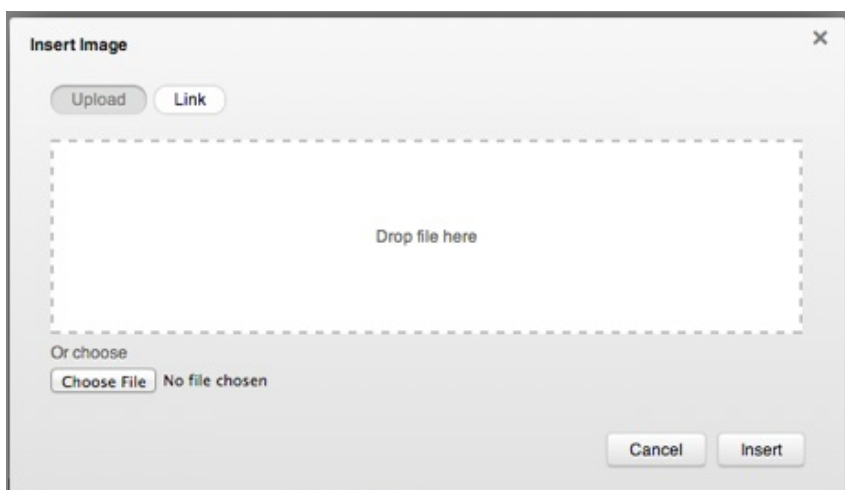
Signature

You can create a rich text signature that's automatically displayed at the bottom of your messages when you reply to a ticket. You should include a sign off and your name so that you don't have to type them every time you reply to a user.

If you have enabled an **override name**, remember to use the same name in your signature.



The  button enables you to insert an image into the body of the signature. You can either **Upload** an image file from your desktop, or select **Link** to provide the web address of an image file. If you use a web address, make sure it's on a site your organization controls.



The  button enables you to insert a clickable web link or email address into your signature. See the section [Using links in messages](#) for details.

Notification preferences

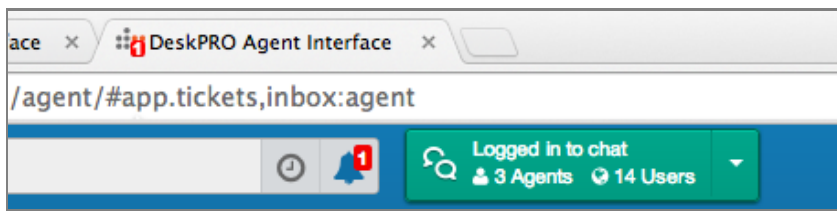
These settings control what notifications you get about tickets. You may not have permission to change your notifications, in which case you will see a message to contact your admins.

The screenshot shows the 'Notification Preferences' section of the DeskPRO interface. It includes tabs for Profile, Signature, Ticket Notifications, Notifications, Macros, Filters, and SLAs. The 'Ticket Notifications' tab is active, showing settings for Email and Browser notifications. Annotations highlight specific features:

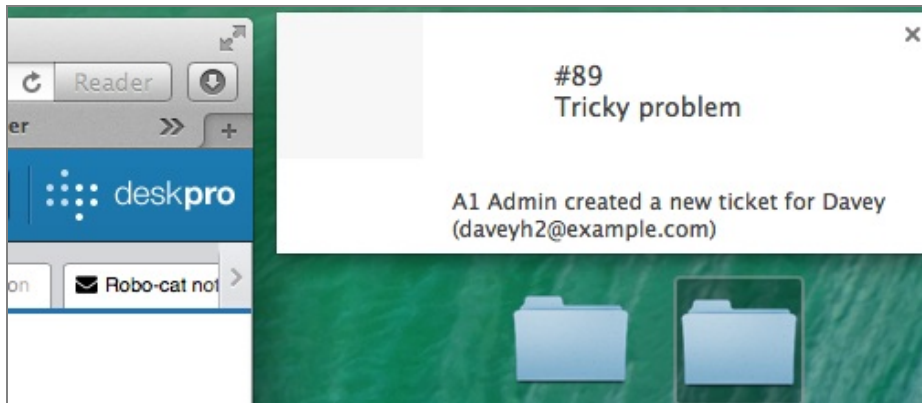
- Browser notifications are shown in the toolbar:** Points to the 'Browser Notifications' tab and a toolbar icon.
- Mouse over bulbs for details:** Points to a lightbulb icon in the 'Tickets I Follow' row, with a tooltip that says 'Notify me of any change to a ticket I follow'.
- Custom filters have their own notification settings:** Points to the 'Filters' section, which lists filters like 'Gyrocopter + urgent' and 'Sales tickets assigned to Roger' with their own notification checkboxes.
- By default, you don't get notified about changes you make:** Points to the 'All Actions' checkbox under 'My Events'.
- Agents can use @Your Name to alert you to a ticket note using agent IM and email:** Points to the 'Notes with @mentions' section, which has options like 'Always email & send a chat message' and 'Send a chat message if online or email if offline'.

There are two main kinds of notifications that DeskPRO can send: **email notifications** (which are simply emails sent to your DeskPRO account address) and **browser notifications**.

Browser notifications are shown in the notification tray to the right of the toolbar. The tab icon in your browser will also display the number of notifications and will flash when you have a new notification. You'll only see browser notifications if you're logged in to the agent interface.



If you've enabled **desktop** notifications, when you receive a browser notification you will also get a pop-up alert on your computer desktop. The exact appearance will vary depending on your operating system.



There are two notifications tabs:

- **Ticket Notifications** - set email and browser notifications about ticket events and @mentions (see [Replying to a ticket](#) details about @mentions). Note that you can set different notification options for tickets that match certain filters.
- **Notifications** - set what notifications you want to receive about non-ticket events: chats, tasks, feedback, publish content (new feedback and comments), CRM (new user registration). You can also opt to receive an email every time your account is logged into or there's a failed login attempt.

Macro preferences

From here you can create [macros](#) to automatically perform sequences of actions. You can either create personal macros that only you can use, or shared macros that everyone can access. If other agents have to do the same task that you've written a macro for, consider making it shared, to save them having to come up with their own version.

Profile	Signature	Ticket Notifications	Notifications	Macros	Filters	SLAs	
							Create Macro
Macros							
Bump up to L2 support							✖ ✎
Clean up							✖ ✎
Holding response							✖ ✎

Your admins can see everyone's macros, so contact them if you need help making a macro work.

Note that you can't run a macro if you don't have permissions to do all the actions it includes. If you run a macro and don't have the right permissions, you will receive a pop-up warning. Speak to your admins to resolve this issue.

Filter preferences

This shows your [custom filters](#). You can create filters here or from the filter pane of the Tickets app.

Profile	Signature	Ticket Notifications	Notifications	Macros	Filters	SLAs	
							Create Filter
Filters						Hide ?	Edit
Assigned to poor Kevin (RIP)						☐ Hide	Edit
NOD problems						☐ Hide	Edit
Urgent tickets from DreadCo						☐ Hide	Edit

You can hide custom filters from here if you don't want to see them in the filter pane.

SLA preferences

This option lets you control which [SLAs](#) (*Service Level Agreements*) you see in the Ticket app. If there are SLAs which are not relevant to you, you can choose not to see when tickets are warning or failing because of them.

Profile	Signature	Ticket Notifications	Notifications	Macros	Filters	SLAs	
Filter SLA results							
✓ Show all matching tickets Show only tickets assigned to me Show only tickets assigned to my team							
SLAs				Warning	Failure	Hide	
First Response	Time until first response (Default working hours)			90 minutes	3 hours	☐ Hide	
Manual SLA	Time until first response (Default working hours)			30 minutes	60 minutes	☐ Hide	

You can hide SLAs just as can with filters. You can also choose whether to show all the tickets that have had an SLA applied, or just those that are assigned to you/your team.

3. Tickets

The **Tickets app** is used to manage and reply to tickets. Each ticket denotes a user issue that your helpdesk needs to resolve.

DeskPRO tracks what is happening to a ticket using its [status](#). The ticket's status reflects who needs to reply to it next.

There are several features designed to help you decide which tickets to answer first. You can track [service level agreements](#), and assign tickets [urgency](#) and [priority](#) levels.

You can work more efficiently with tickets using [macros](#) to apply a series of actions to a ticket, and [mass actions](#) to work on several tickets at once.

Tickets can be changed by automatic processes (**triggers**, **SLAs** and **escalations**) set up by your admins. For example, the helpdesk could automatically assign tickets based on their properties.

3.1. Ticket properties

When you open an individual ticket in the content pane, you can see the information DeskPRO stores about it.

The screenshot shows a ticket titled "Freezing during boot" with ID 27. The interface includes several sections and annotations:

- Header:** Ticket title "Freezing during boot", ID "ID: 27", and a status dropdown set to "Awaiting Agent".
- Metadata:** "Support Dept." dropdown, "User" (Susan Expert), and "User organization" (DreadCo).
- Properties Tab:**
 - Agent:** "Acme Support Agent 1", "2nd Level Support".
 - Followers:** "Acme IT Boss".
 - Properties List:** Language: Spanish, Category: Regulator, Priority: Routine, Product: Catapult, Workflow: Triage, Labels: Add a label.
 - Annotations:** "Department" points to "Support Dept.", "User" points to "Susan Expert", "User organization" points to "DreadCo", "Flag" points to the "Awaiting Agent" status, "Status" points to the status dropdown, "Urgency" points to the "3" urgency indicator, and "Click icon to edit ticket properties" points to a gear icon in the top right of the Properties tab.
- Actions:** "Ticket action buttons" points to a row of icons including Lock, Merge, Macros, Remove, and Actions.
- Reply Section:** Includes a "REPLY" tab, a rich text editor with "NOTE" and "ATTACH" options, and a "Send Reply as Awaiting User" button.
- History Section:** Includes "MESSAGES", "FULL LOG", and "DATES & TIMES" tabs. "Ticket history" points to the "FULL LOG" tab.

The fields you see will vary:

- Some built-in fields are optional.
- Your admins can add custom fields.
- If there is no value entered for a field on an individual ticket, the field is not displayed even if your helpdesk uses it.
- The required fields can be different for tickets in different [departments](#).

Click the  at the top right of the **Properties** tab to see all available fields, including custom fields for your helpdesk.

IDs and ref codes

Every ticket has a unique **ID** number. These are assigned in the order tickets are created.



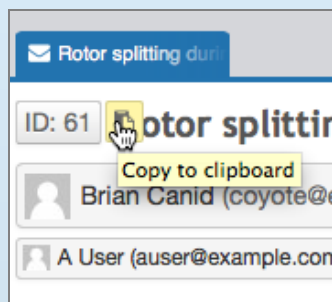
You may notice that other items in DeskPRO have their own ID numbers. For example, users and knowledgebase articles have IDs. ID numbers for different items are separate - for example, you can have a ticket with ID 17 and a user with ID 17.

Your admins may have set your helpdesk so that users see a unique **ref code** instead of the ID. The ref code is usually a string of numbers and letters (e.g. WHPL-4979-OBV). Your admins may have customized the format. Click on a ticket's ID to toggle to displaying the ref code instead.

The ref code format can be customized to include information about the date and time that the ticket was created, e.g. 2014-07-WHPL-4979 .

Another advantage of ref codes is that they make it harder for your users and competitors to work out how many (or how few) tickets you have.

Put your mouse cursor over an ID or ref code and a yellow clipboard icon appears. Click the icon. The ID or ref is now copied to your clipboard, for easy pasting.



You can find a ticket quickly by putting its ID or ref code into the Quick Search bar; this is the best way to call up a ticket if a user is calling you about it on the phone (or a fellow agent is yelling about it across the room).



Note that emails DeskPRO sends about tickets will include either an ID or ref code for the relevant ticket.

3.2. Ticket status

DeskPRO tracks the **status** of a ticket, which tells you whether it's an agent or the user that needs to act next - or if there's no need to act at all, for example the problem behind the ticket was resolved, or the ticket was created from a spam email.

A single ticket might be assigned back and forth between several agents, and go through several different statuses, before it is resolved or deleted. You can view the details of a ticket's history when you open it in the content pane.

Core statuses

The most important statuses for a ticket are:

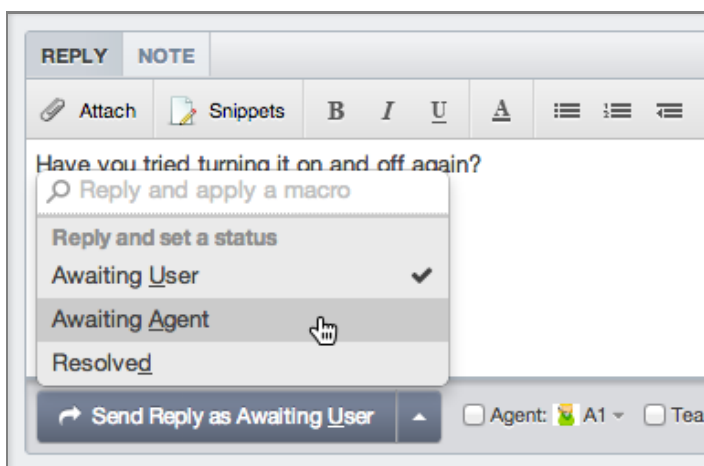
- **awaiting agent** - this means the helpdesk needs to act on the ticket; typically, the user is expecting a reply.
- **awaiting user** - this means the helpdesk is awaiting a reply from the user before any more progress can be made in resolving the issue.
- **resolved** - the issue is resolved to everyone's satisfaction, and communication has ended.

As an example, consider a user who reports an issue by email, creating a ticket with 'awaiting agent' status.

An agent replies, perhaps requesting more information, and setting the ticket to 'awaiting user' status.

The user's next message would set the status back to 'awaiting agent' again.

As you will see later, when you write your reply to a ticket, you can decide what status to give it.



Usually you would reply and set the status to 'awaiting user' (the default).

You might need to reply and set the status to 'awaiting agent' if you are telling the user that you're assigning the ticket to a different agent, or reassuring them that you're working on the problem and will get back to them.

The goal for most tickets will be to get them to 'resolved' status.

Resolved tickets can be re-opened by agents (and possibly by users; this depends on [usergroup](#) permissions).

Other possible statuses are:

- on hold
- awaiting validation
- spam
- deleted

On hold status

On hold status is a way to record that an agent needs to act on the ticket, but that you're waiting for something else to happen first. This often involves waiting for a third party.

For example, a user has raised a new ticket and you need to check something with one of your suppliers before you reply. You have emailed the supplier and you are waiting to hear back.

Leaving this ticket marked as **awaiting agent** isn't quite right, since that would make it seem like there's something you need to do to it now, whereas in fact you just have to wait for the supplier. The solution is to put it on hold.

You can think of **on hold** as a sub-status of awaiting agent.

If you have tickets on hold, there will be a checkbox in the top part of the filter pane of the Tickets app - check it to view the tickets on hold, uncheck it to view awaiting agent tickets as usual.

AWAITING AGENT ☐ 3 ON HOLD	
▶ My Tickets	2
▶ Tickets I Follow	3
▶ My Teams' Tickets	5

See the section on [Holding tickets](#) for more detail.

Hidden tickets: awaiting validation, spam and deleted

There are three ticket statuses that are used for tickets that should be hidden from agents. These are

- awaiting validation
- spam
- deleted

These hidden statuses will not generate notifications and will not show up in searches from the filter pane.

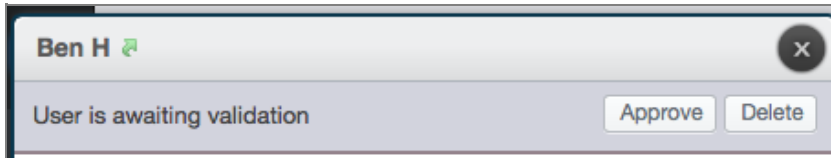
Depending on how your helpdesk is set up, new users may need to be **validated** before their tickets are shown in the main parts of the agent interface. You can still see tickets from unvalidated users in the **Awaiting Validation** filter of the Tickets app.

TICKETS	LABELS	FLAGGED
Awaiting Agent		11
Awaiting User		24
Resolved		6
Awaiting Validation		1
Spam		0
Recycle Bin		~5

See the section on [new users](#) for more details.

There are two independent methods of validation that may be required:

- 1 Email validation - new users are emailed a link which they have to click on to prove they have provided a valid address. This may be set to happen when they first register, or when they submit a ticket.
- 2 Agent validation - new users have to be manually approved by an agent.



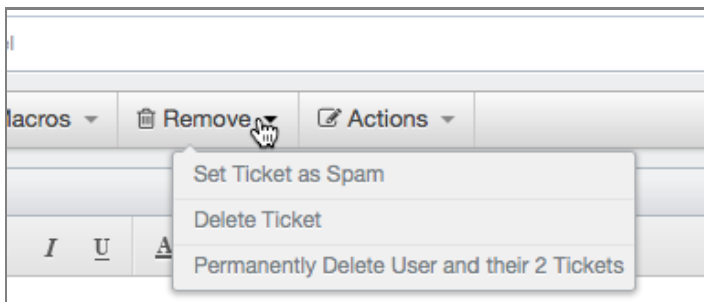
You may get tickets created as a result of spam emails or web robots posting junk messages into the forms on the web portal. You can set the status of these tickets as **spam**.

DeskPRO does not have its own automatic spam filter, but your admins may use another spam filter system combined with DeskPRO features to mark suspected spam automatically.

Tickets set as spam can be seen in the **Spam** filter in the filter pane.

Tickets can also be **deleted**. They are then shown in the **Recycle Bin** in the filter pane. You might want to delete a ticket that is abusive or irrelevant (e.g. the user has sent it to the wrong company). You don't need to delete valid resolved tickets - it's better to keep them around.

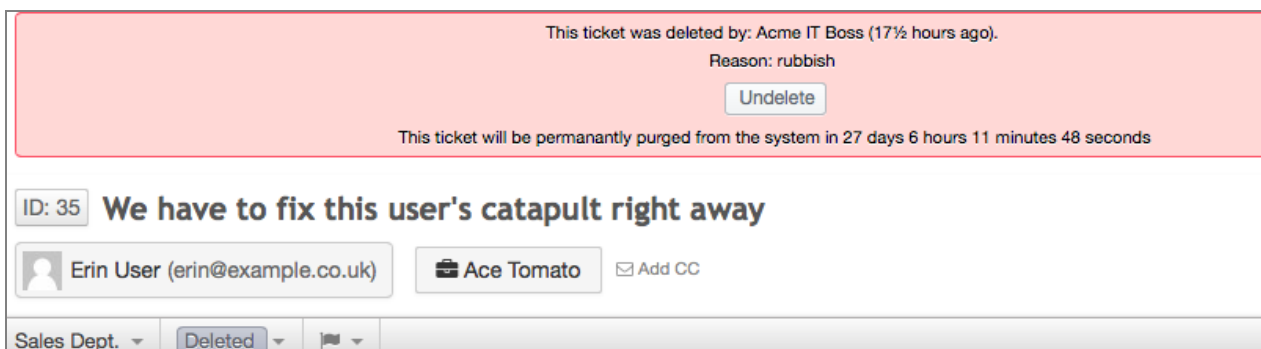
You can set a single ticket as spam or delete it using the **Remove** button.



You can use [mass actions](#) to spam or delete tickets in bulk.

Tickets in the Spam filter or the Recycle Bin will be **purged** - deleted permanently - after a certain amount of time. Your admins set the time until automatic purging. It can be different for deleted and spam tickets. Admins can also purge all the deleted tickets manually.

You can always undelete or unspam a ticket before it is purged.



Before you undelete a ticket, you need to correct any errors, such as missing fields - otherwise the undelete button won't work.

3.3. Ticket assignment

Assignment is about keeping track of who is responsible for each ticket.

There are two separate types of assignment: you can assign tickets to an agent or to a [team](#) (a group of agents).

Agent and team assignments are independent - a ticket can be assigned to one or the other, or neither, or both.

This screenshot shows the **Agent** and **Team** assignment controls on an individual ticket:

Select the agent or team to assign using the pull-down menus.

You can also click the **Assign to Me** link as a quicker way to assign the ticket to yourself. Similarly, the **Assign to My Team** assigns the ticket to your first team.

Assigned tickets have an **Unassign** link to clear the agent or team assignment.

Assignment is important because it affects the notifications you receive, and interacts with permissions.

Assignment and notifications

There is a set of notification preferences about assignment (for both email and browser notifications).

The tickets that are most relevant to you are usually the ones that get assigned to you directly, so you can choose to receive notifications only for those.

	New Ticket	Assignment
My Tickets	☒	☒ ☐
Tickets I Follow	☐	☐ ☐
My Teams's Tickets	☒	☒ ☐
Unassigned Tickets	☐	☐ ☐
All Tickets	☐	

In the example above, the settings in the **My Tickets** row mean you would get notifications when a new ticket was created with you as the assigned agent, or when an existing ticket was assigned to you - but you wouldn't get notifications for **Unassigned Tickets**, for instance.

Assignment and permissions

If a ticket is assigned to Agent A, that doesn't necessarily stop Agent B acting on it: Agent B may still be able to reply to the ticket, assign it to another agent, etc.

Depending on how your admins have set up the helpdesk, you may not be able to edit, answer or even see tickets that aren't assigned to you. For example, your admins may decide that junior staff can only work on tickets that they've already been assigned.

Agent assignment also overrides department permissions. If an agent doesn't have permissions for the department a ticket is in, they can't even view it. But if the ticket is assigned to the agent, they can view and edit it, subject to their other permissions settings.

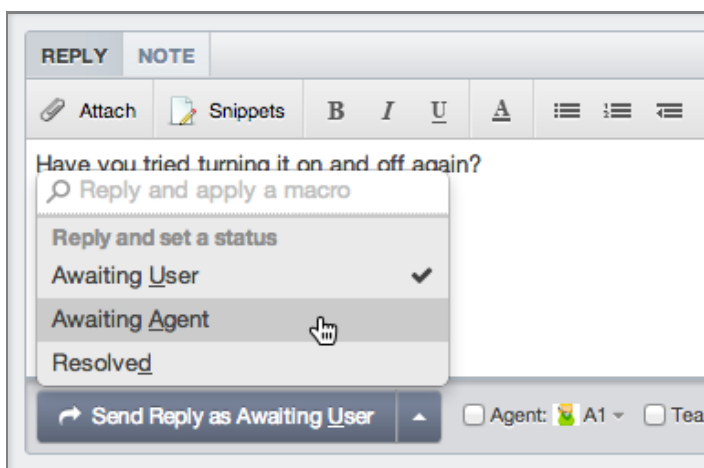
See the section on [Departments](#) for more details.

Using assignment

On most helpdesks, newly created tickets will mainly be unassigned. Unassigned means not assigned to an agent *or* a team.

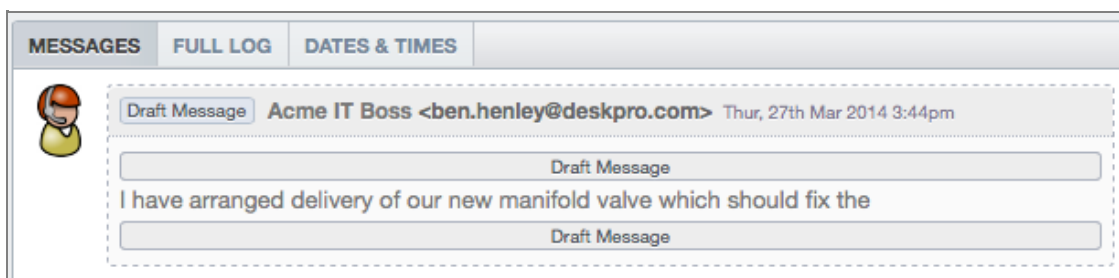
In some helpdesks, agents may just pick which unassigned tickets they want to handle. You'll notice that there are quick controls to **Assign to Me** and **Assign to My Team**.

When you reply to a ticket from within the agent interface, the default is to assign it to yourself.



In others, there is an agent who is responsible for assigning tickets to the right agents/teams.

Note that if another agent is replying to a ticket, you can see a live preview of what they're typing. This makes it easy to see when someone else is answering a ticket, even if they're not assigned to it.



Teams

Instead of assigning a ticket to an individual agent, you can assign it to a **team**: a group of agents.

Teams are useful because they let you bring a ticket to the attention of multiple agents.

Typically, agents who tend to answer the same type of tickets would all be in the same team: for example, you might use teams for Tier 1, Tier 2 and Tier 3 support. An agent can be a member of more than one team.

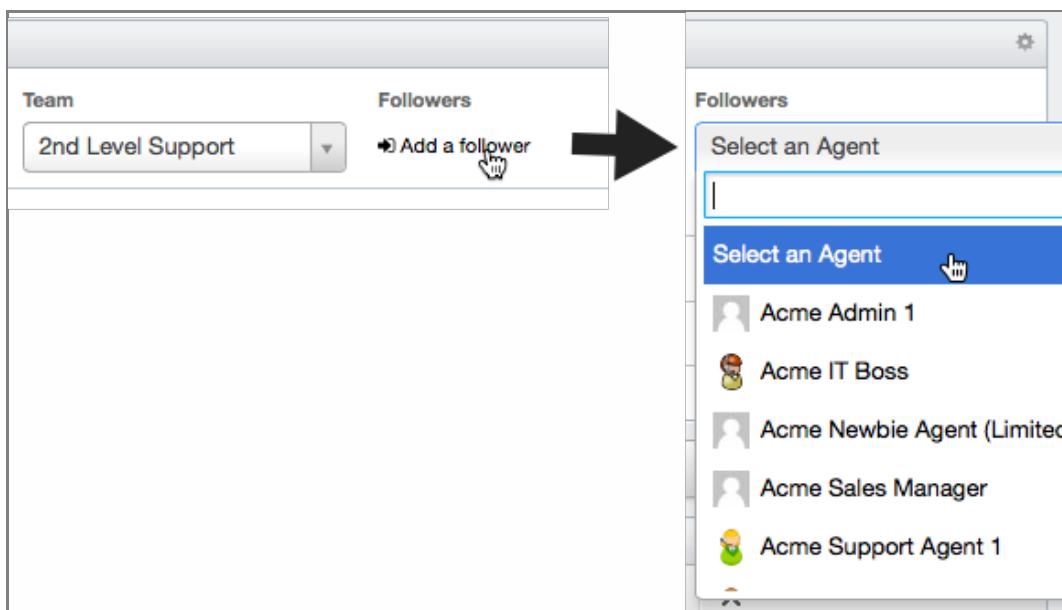
Agents can set team notification preferences, just as they can for individual assignment.

Note that a ticket can be assigned *both* to an individual agent *and* to a team. If a ticket is assigned to you individually, and you assign it to a team, it will still show up in your "My Tickets" filter, unless you change the individual assignment to yourself.

You have the same permissions to modify a ticket that's assigned to your team as you would if it was assigned to you directly.

Following tickets

Following is a way to keep track of a ticket without it being assigned to you.



You can add yourself as a follower using the **Add Me** link if you want to keep an eye on a ticket. If you follow a ticket:

- you can get [notifications](#) about it (depending on your **Tickets I Follow** notification preferences).
- it shows up in the "Tickets I Follow" filter whenever it has **awaiting agent** status.
- you will be able to see it even if it is set to a department you don't have permission to view.

Agents can also add each other as followers. For example, suppose you are training an agent who's not ready to answer tickets; you don't want to assign them tickets, but you could add them as a follower to a ticket that you want them to watch.

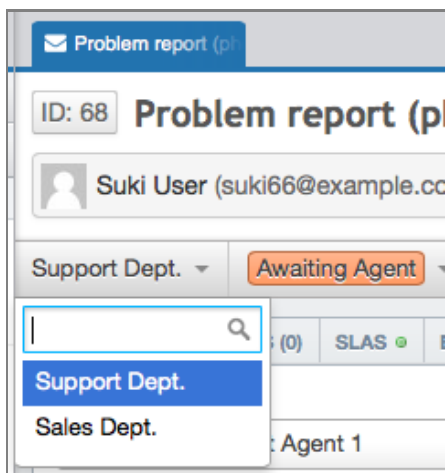
The permissions you have as a follower of a ticket are not necessarily the same as the permissions you have if it's assigned to you. For example, your helpdesk may let you modify tickets you're assigned, but not tickets you are following.

Your helpdesk may also be configured to add you as a follower if a user cc:s you in on a ticket email.

3.4. Departments

Departments have multiple effects, but their general purpose is to divide up the helpdesk and control access.

A ticket must have a department (but can't have more than one)



Agent accounts can be set so they do not have permission to view tickets in certain departments.

For example, suppose your helpdesk had a Research department and a Customer Service department. You might not be able to see Research tickets; another agent might not be able to see Customer Service tickets, and a third agent might be able to see tickets in both.

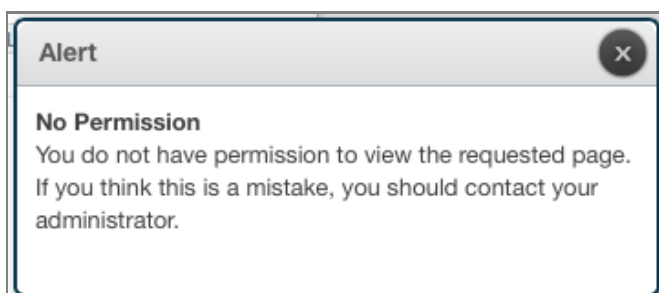
The advantage of this is that you only have to sort through the tickets that are relevant to your particular role.

However, **assignment and following always overrule departments**

If you're not normally allowed to see Research department tickets, but one is assigned to you or your team, you can then see it. And if a ticket you were following was then set as a Research ticket, you would still be able to see it.

You may be allowed to assign a ticket to a department that you don't have permission to view. It depends on your permissions, which are set by your admins.

In the example above, if you found a useful customer suggestion among the Customer Service tickets, your account might let you assign it to the Research department. If you tried to access the ticket afterwards, you would see a **No Permission** error message.

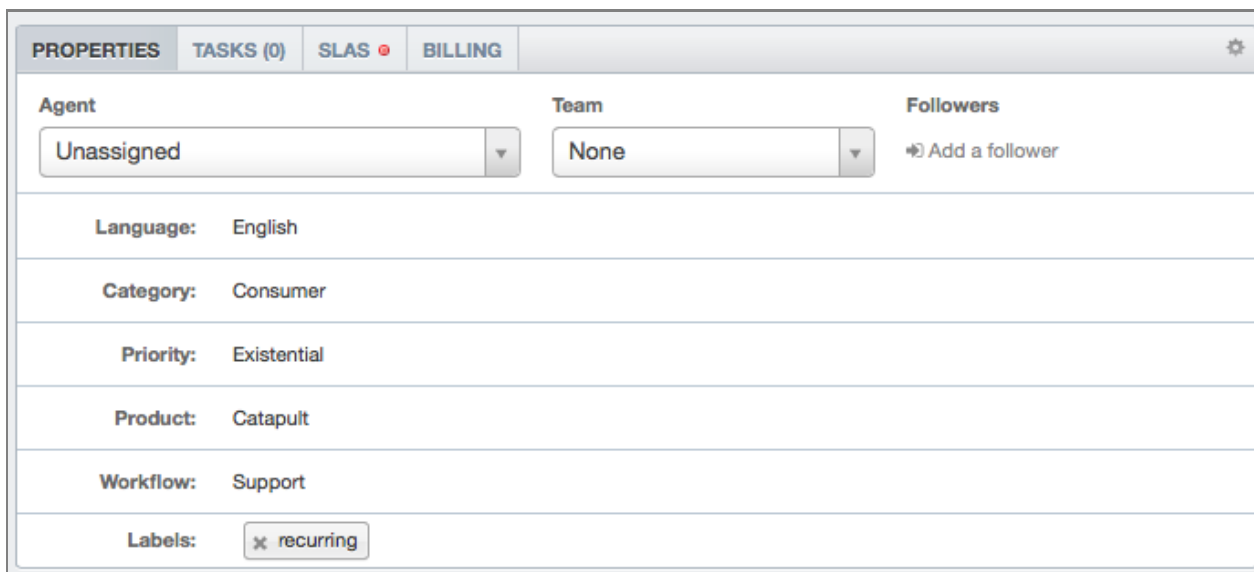


A final point to bear in mind is that your helpdesk can be customized so that different departments have different forms for creating a ticket. This customization can be done separately for users and for agents. You may find that the fields which are visible or mandatory when you're creating a ticket vary between departments, and between users and agents.

3.5. Ticket fields

Aside from core information like subject, status and user, DeskPRO can store extra **fields** giving you more information about a ticket.

You can view them in the ticket **Properties** tab.



The screenshot shows the 'PROPERTIES' tab of a ticket in DeskPRO. The interface includes tabs for 'PROPERTIES', 'TASKS (0)', 'SLAS', and 'BILLING'. The 'PROPERTIES' tab is active, displaying several fields: 'Agent' (set to 'Unassigned'), 'Team' (set to 'None'), 'Followers' (with an 'Add a follower' button), 'Language' (set to 'English'), 'Category' (set to 'Consumer'), 'Priority' (set to 'Existential'), 'Product' (set to 'Catapult'), 'Workflow' (set to 'Support'), and 'Labels' (with a 'recurring' label). A gear icon for settings is located in the top right corner of the tab.

You can edit them by clicking the  icon at the top right. Note that if there is no value set for a particular field, the field will not be shown until you do this.

Your admins have a wide variety of configuration options. Some built-in ticket fields are optional, and may not be set up on your helpdesk. The fields you see may vary by the department of the ticket you're creating.

The optional **Language** field records what language the ticket is in.

Categories

The **Category** field may not be enabled. If your helpdesk uses it, the values you can choose from are set by your admins.

This field is used to divide tickets into categories that are useful to your company.

If it's enabled, users can choose a category when submitting a ticket from the web portal.

Here are some examples of how different helpdesks could use categories:

- Software/Hardware
- Question/Complaint/Praise
- Consumer/Professional/Reseller
- Windows/Mac/Linux

Products

The **Product** field may not be enabled. It is used to track different products your company makes or supports.

If your helpdesk uses it, the values will usually be products you help people with.

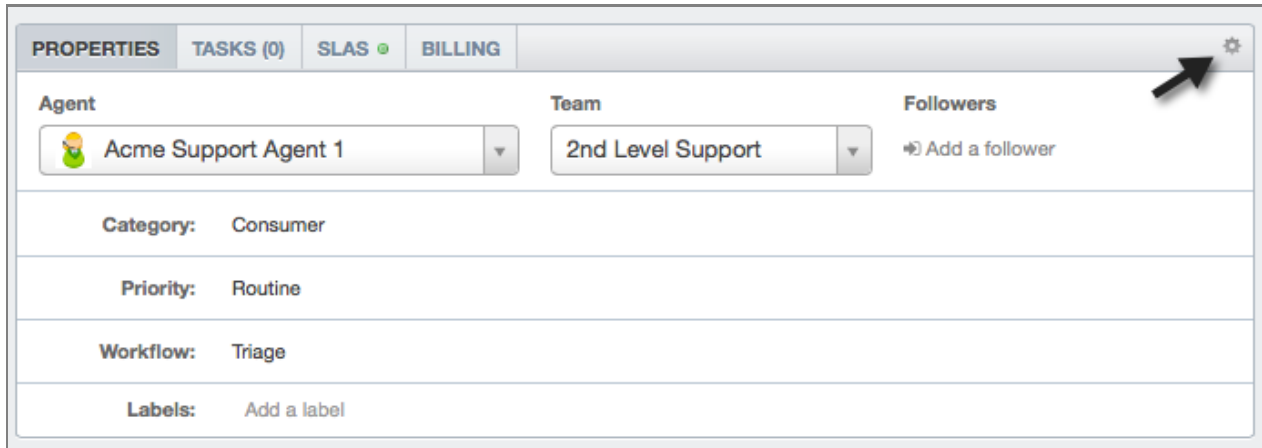
If it's enabled, users can select a product when submitting a ticket from the web portal. You can also select a product for knowledgebase articles.

Workflows

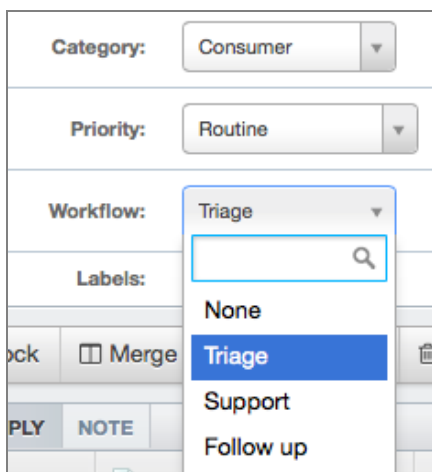
Workflow is an optional field used for tracking the progress of a ticket through your helpdesk, according to your company's procedures.

Since it describes your internal processes, the workflow field is never visible to users.

Workflow is set in the ticket **Properties** tab.



Click the  icon at the top right to edit properties.



If your helpdesk uses workflow, the available workflow stages are defined by your admins. You may be required to set the workflow yourself, or it could change automatically.

Here's an example of how workflow could be used:

- 1 every new ticket has the workflow field set to "Triage", to show that a first-line agent needs to assess which team needs to deal with it and how serious it is
- 2 once it is assigned to a team, the workflow field is set to "Support"
- 3 once the agent thinks they have dealt with the ticket, the workflow field is set to "Follow Up" and a manager reviews their work before marking the ticket resolved.

Custom fields

Your admins can also add custom fields to track extra information about tickets.

These custom fields will have a name chosen by your admins. Custom fields can either be visible to users (for example on the web portal), or for agents only.

If you see a ticket field at the bottom of the **Properties** section that isn't mentioned in this manual, it's a custom field.

The screenshot shows a 'Properties' section with the following fields:

- Product:** A dropdown menu currently set to 'None'.
- Workflow:** A dropdown menu currently set to 'Triage'.
- Flammability:** Two radio buttons, 'Flammable' (selected) and 'Inflammable'.
- Labels:** A text input field with the placeholder 'Add a label'.
- Bottom Bar:** A row of buttons: 'Lock', 'Merge' (with a dropdown arrow), 'Macros' (with a dropdown arrow), and 'Remove' (with a trash icon).

The kind of input a custom field can take varies:

- Text - a simple one-line text box.
- Textarea - a multi-line text box that can be used for longer entries like descriptions or notes.
- Choice - a set of predefined options presented as a drop-down select menu, radio buttons or checkboxes.
- Toggle (on/off) - a single checkbox that you can check or uncheck.
- Date - lets you select a date using a calendar widget.
- Display - this is a field you can't edit, that is used for displaying information to the user.
- Hidden - this stores information from the user's browser; the user won't see it on the portal, but the information stored can be viewed and edited by agents

Custom fields aren't matched from the Quick Search bar, but you can find them from the advanced ticket search.

The screenshot shows the 'Advanced Ticket Search' interface with the following sections:

- TICKETS SEARCH:** A header bar with a 'TICKETS' button and a 'SEARCH' button.
- Status:** A list of checkboxes for ticket status: 'Awaiting Agent' (checked), 'Awaiting User' (checked), 'Resolved' (unchecked). Below this is a section for 'Hidden Tickets' with 'Awaiting Validating' (unchecked), 'Spam' (checked), and 'Deleted' (unchecked).
- Message:** A text input field with a settings gear icon to its right.
- User:** A text input field with a settings gear icon to its right.
- Organization:** A text input field with a settings gear icon to its right.
- Dates & Times:** A text input field with a settings gear icon to its right.

Field validation

When you're creating or editing a ticket, you may find that selecting or entering a value for some fields is compulsory. This is determined by **validation** options set by your admins. In this example, the **Priority** field is compulsory:

Your admins can set it up so that some fields are compulsory for agents, but not users. If you open a ticket with some compulsory fields missing, you will see this:

Before you continue to work with a ticket that is missing required fields, you must correct the problem.

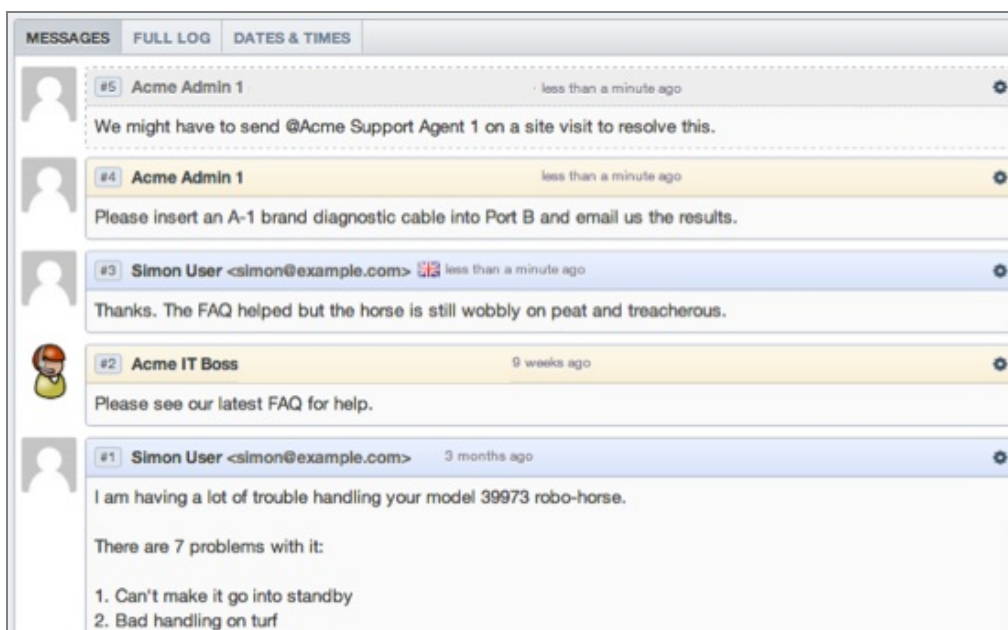
3.6. Ticket history

At the bottom of a ticket as you view it in the content pane is the ticket history. There are three tabs which provide different information:

- **Messages** connected with this ticket - emails to and from the user, and internal agent notes.
- **Full log** of all the actions that have been applied to the ticket by agents, users, or automatic processes.
- **Dates and times** associated with the ticket - when it was created, how long the user has been waiting, etc.

Ticket message history

The ticket message history shows all messages between agents and the user about this ticket. It also shows agent [notes](#) in gray: these are used for internal communication between agents.



By default, the message history is shown in reverse chronological order with the newest message at the top. You can change this to chronological order, with the newest message at the bottom, by changing the **Show newest messages** setting in your [account preferences](#).

You can access any attachments the user has sent from the ticket message history.

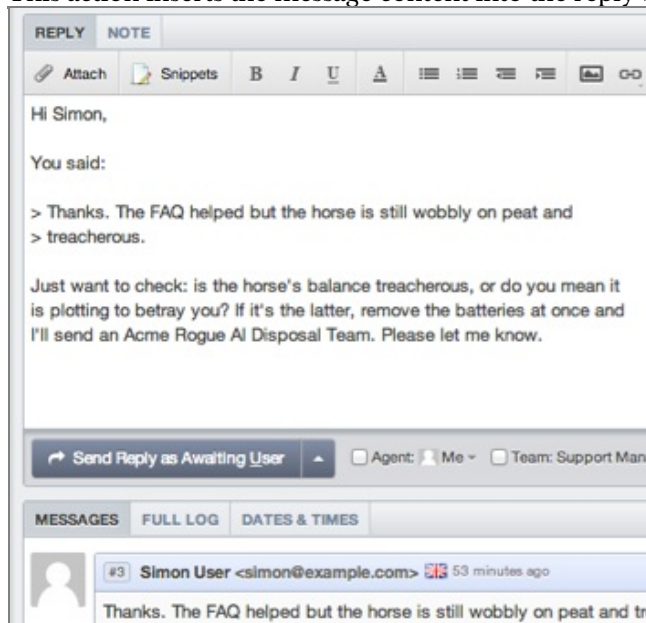


You can use the gear icon on the right-hand side of individual messages to carry out actions on individual messages. You may not have permissions to use all of these.

The possible message actions are:

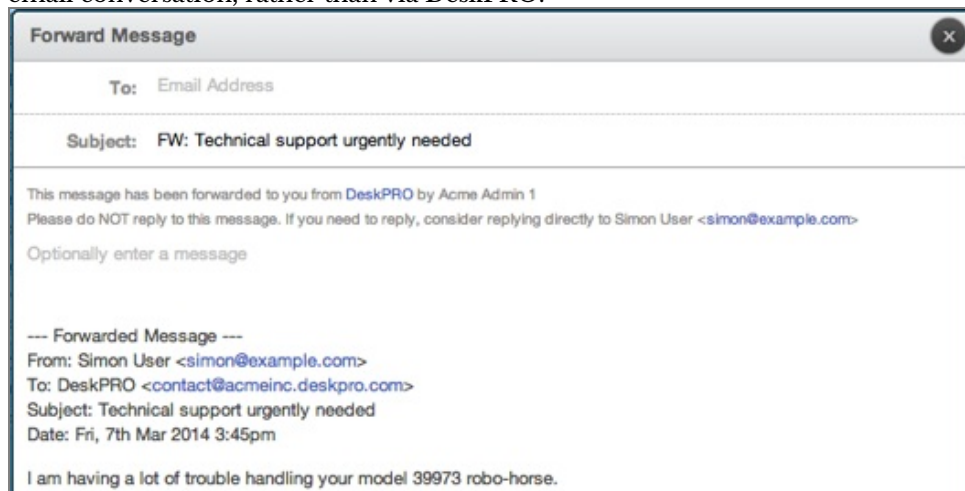
- **View message in a new window** enables you to view the raw message, email headers and HTML source code - see [Viewing raw message source](#) for details.
- **Quote:**

This action inserts the message content into the reply box, formatted as a quote, email-style.



- **Forward message**

This lets you forward the message as an email, for when you want to discuss it as part of a normal email conversation, rather than via DeskPRO.



- **Delete message** deletes the individual message (as opposed to the ticket). Note that this action cannot be undone; deleted messages do not go to the Recycle Bin.
- **Set as agent note** converts the message to a [note](#) visible only to agents.
- **Split message** removes the message from the thread and makes it into a new ticket. See the section on [Splitting messages to a new ticket](#) for more details.
- **Create Linked Ticket** uses the message as the initial message in a **linked ticket**, linked to the original ticket. See the section [Create a linked ticket](#) for more details.
- **Edit** lets you edit the message content, if you have the correct permissions.
- **Download Debug File** is used to diagnose technical problems. Your admins or a DeskPRO employee may ask you to send them this file.

Ticket log

Click on the **Full Log** tab to see a record of everything that has happened related to the ticket: which SLAs were applied, automatic actions by your helpdesk, which emails have been sent, changes to properties, etc.

MESSAGES	FULL LOG	DATES & TIMES
All (13)	Messages (1)	Attachments (1)
New ticket by user		
Ticket ID 93 created		
User Owner set to ID 18		
Subject set to I have no idea what I'm doing		
Language changed from None to English		
Status set to to Awaiting Agent		
Department set to Support		
Product changed from None to Robo-cat Mk 1		
New message ID 127 (submitted via web interface from IP 194.74.6.175) — View		
User emailed Maria User <maria1961@example.com>		
User emailed Maria User <maria1961@example.com>		
SLA added: 5 hour first response		
SLA added: 5 hour first response 3 Day Resolution		

If a ticket has changed in a way you don't understand, checking the log will usually explain what made the change.

You can click on the controls at the top to show only **Messages** (from both agents and users), **Attachments** (from both agents and users) or **Assignments** (when the ticket's user, assigned agent or team was changed).

This is useful to find the relevant content if the ticket has a long history; for example, this is what it looks like when you filter the log to show only attachments.

MESSAGES	FULL LOG	DATES & TIMES
All (20)	Messages (2)	Attachments (2)
raw-email-kb.html (1.15 KB) A1 Admin, 2 minutes ago		
icons.png (15.79 KB) Maria User, 20 minutes ago		

Ticket dates and times

Click on the **Dates & Times** tab to see details of significant events in the ticket lifecycle, and user waiting times.

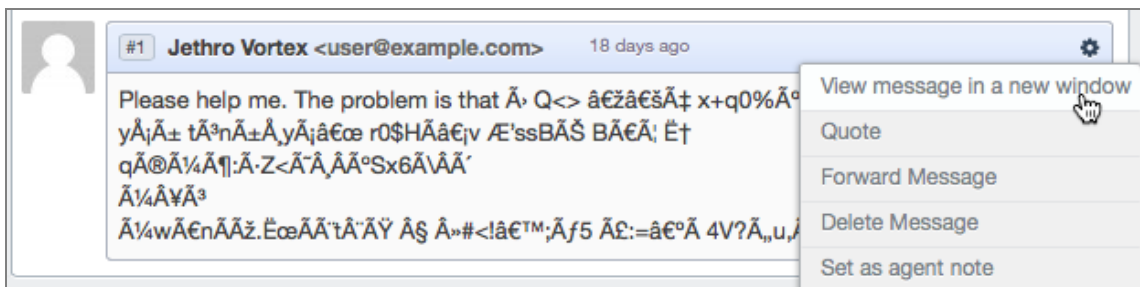
MESSAGES	FULL LOG	DATES & TIMES
Created: 28 minutes ago (Tue, 10th Jun 2014 11:37am)		
Current user waiting time: 18 minutes, 53 seconds ⓘ (since Tue, 10th Jun 2014 11:37am)		
Total user waiting time: 18 minutes, 53 seconds ⓘ		
Waiting until first reply: 17 minutes, 50 seconds ⓘ		
First assignment: 11 minutes ago (Tue, 10th Jun 2014 11:54am)		
First agent reply: 11 minutes ago (Tue, 10th Jun 2014 11:55am)		
Last agent reply: 11 minutes ago (Tue, 10th Jun 2014 11:55am)		
Last user reply: 28 minutes ago (Tue, 10th Jun 2014 11:37am)		

Viewing raw message source

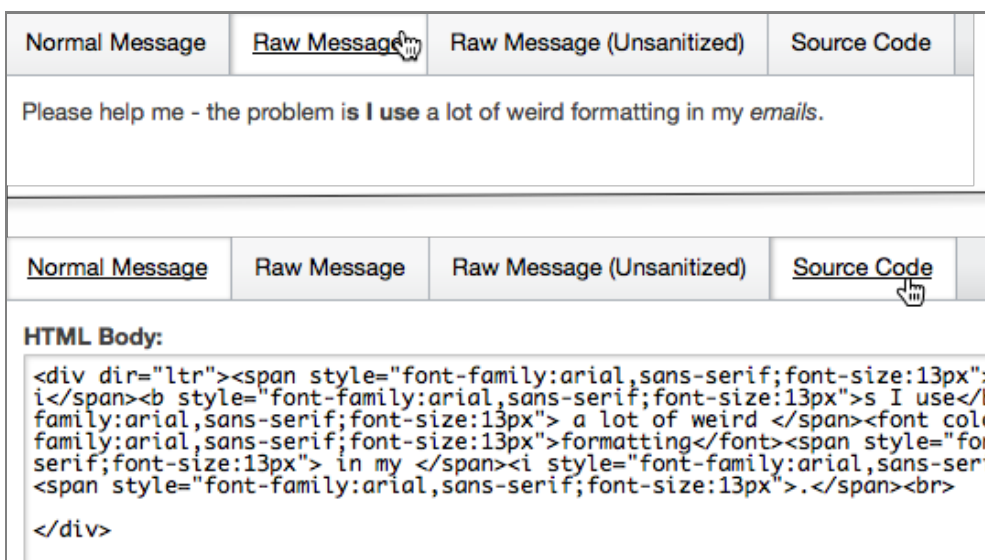
Sometimes it is useful to view the raw message source for a ticket message. Sometimes the user's email client or browser may have inserted formatting that DeskPRO can't interpret; if a message isn't displaying properly or contains strange characters, doing this might help you decipher it.

You may also want to view the email headers on a message to diagnose delivery problems.

Click on the gear icon in the top-right corner of the message to bring up the context menu, then click **View message in a new window**.



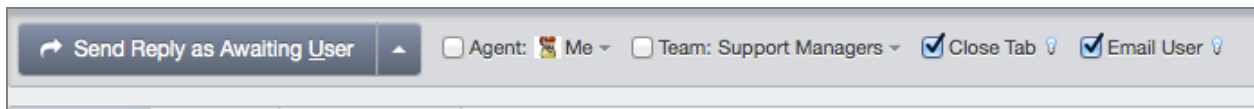
In the window that opens, click on the **Raw Message** tab or the **Source Code** tab.



If a message contains malicious code, viewing the **Raw Message (Unsanitized)** tab may allow it to run. It's best to consult with your admins before using this view.

3.7. Replying to a ticket

When you're viewing an individual ticket in the agent interface, you can send a **message** to the user from the reply area.



By default, when you press the **Send Reply as...** button, your message is emailed to the user's primary address.

Use the pull-down menu at the right of the **Send Reply as...** button to select what the status of the ticket should be after you send the message:

- **Send Reply as Awaiting User**(default) - if you need to hear back from the user before progressing.
- **Send Reply as Awaiting Agent**- if an agent needs to act further on this ticket.
- **Send Reply as Resolved** - if the user's issue is resolved and no more communication is needed.

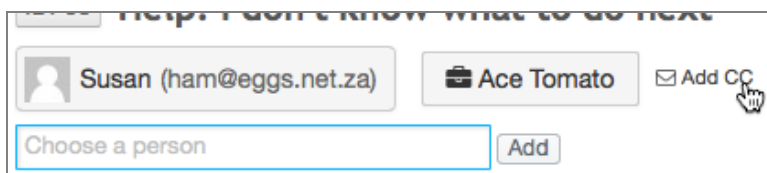
You can uncheck the **Email User** checkbox if you don't want this message to be sent to the user - for example, if the message is a summary of a phone conversation you had with the user.

Note that you can also reply directly to a ticket email notification from your email software. See the section on [Replying to a ticket by email](#) for more details.

Messages should be used for communicating with the user - if you want to communicate with other agents, use [notes](#) instead.

Using ticket CC to copy in users

Adding a user to the ticket **CC** field means they will be copied in on ticket email messages, even though they are not the main user associated with the ticket.



You must enter the exact email address for the person.

CCs enable multiple users to track the progress of the ticket.

Any user who is cc'd into the original email which created the ticket will be added as a CC user (up to a limit of 10 cc: addresses). Agents cannot be CC'd to a ticket; instead they can be added as ticket [followers](#). If an agent is cc'd into the original email, by default, they will be added as a follower (although your admins may have disabled this feature).

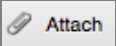
Note that the CC users will only be copied in on *outgoing* emails *from* DeskPRO; the main user associated with the ticket must use "Reply All" from their email software for the CCed users to see their messages.

Another way to allow multiple users to track the progress of a ticket is using [organization managers](#). An organization manager can see all the tickets from their organization, even if they are not the main user or CC'd.

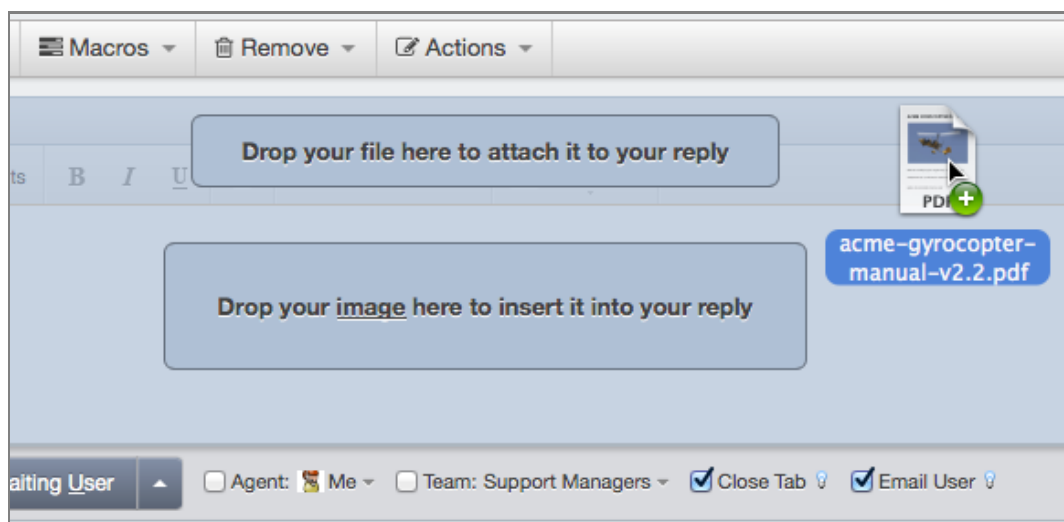
Message attachments

You can attach a file to your message, for example a screenshot, updated software drivers, or an electronic manual.

Your admins may set limits on the type and size of files you are allowed to attach. Remember that the user's email system may reject large files (the limit varies, but is typically 5MB-50MB), or files that look like they might be harmful, like `.exe` files.

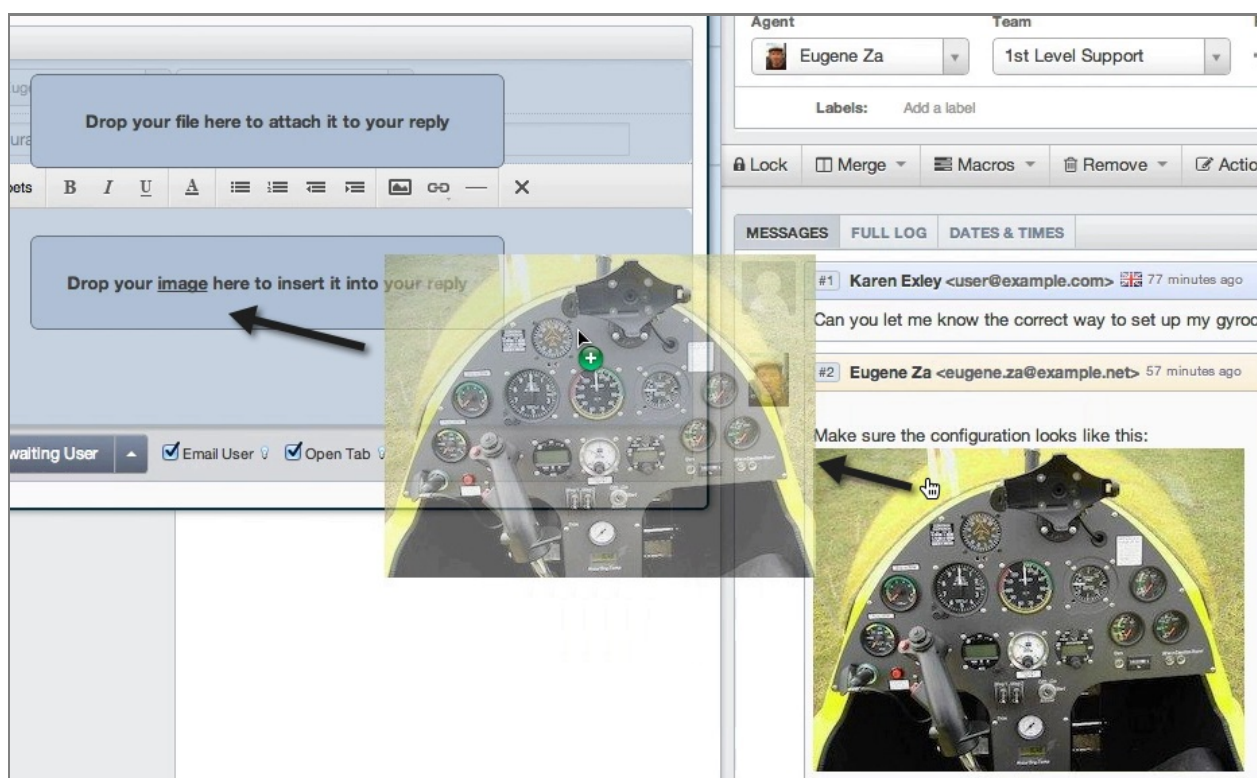
Click the  button to select a file from your computer to attach to the message.

A quicker way to add attachments is using **drag and drop**. You can drag a file to attach onto the bar above the reply box. You can drag an image file directly into the ticket reply box to insert it into the message, and then add text before or after it.



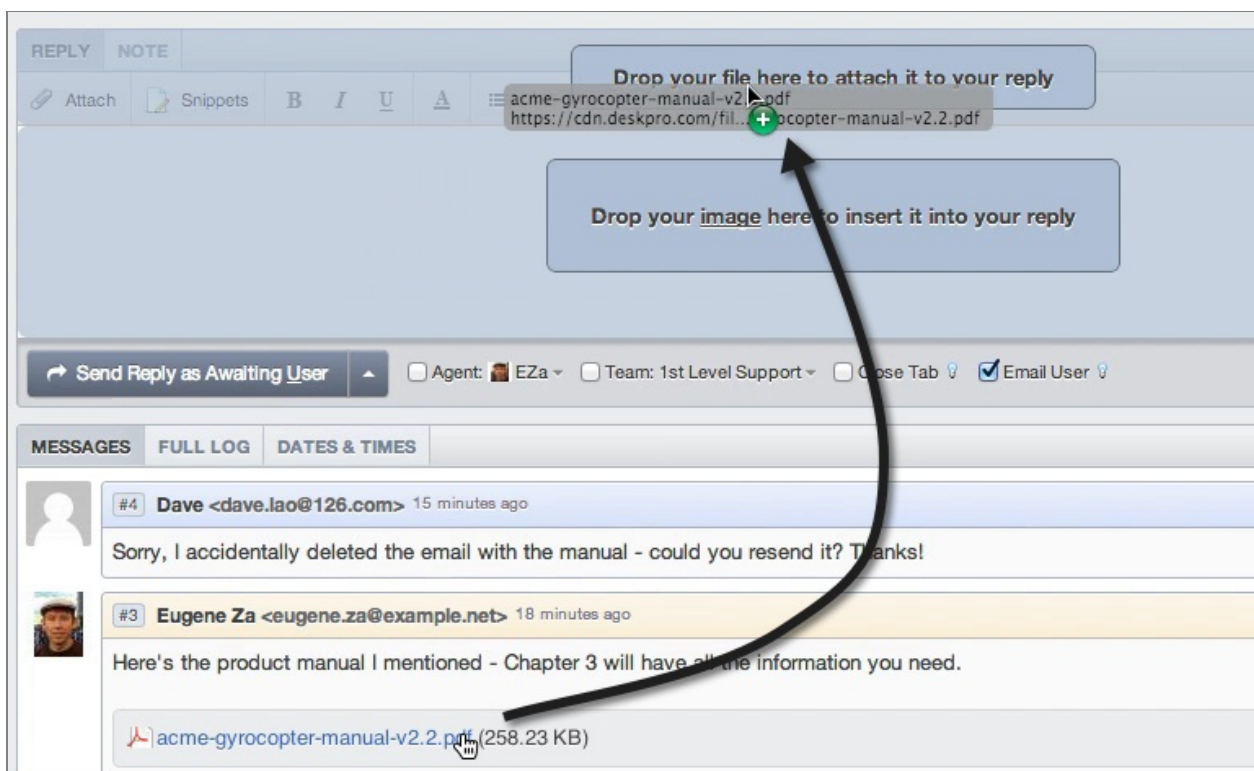
You can use drag and drop to attach multiple files to a message at the same time.

You can copy an attachment from one ticket to the reply box or initial message of another ticket by dragging it:

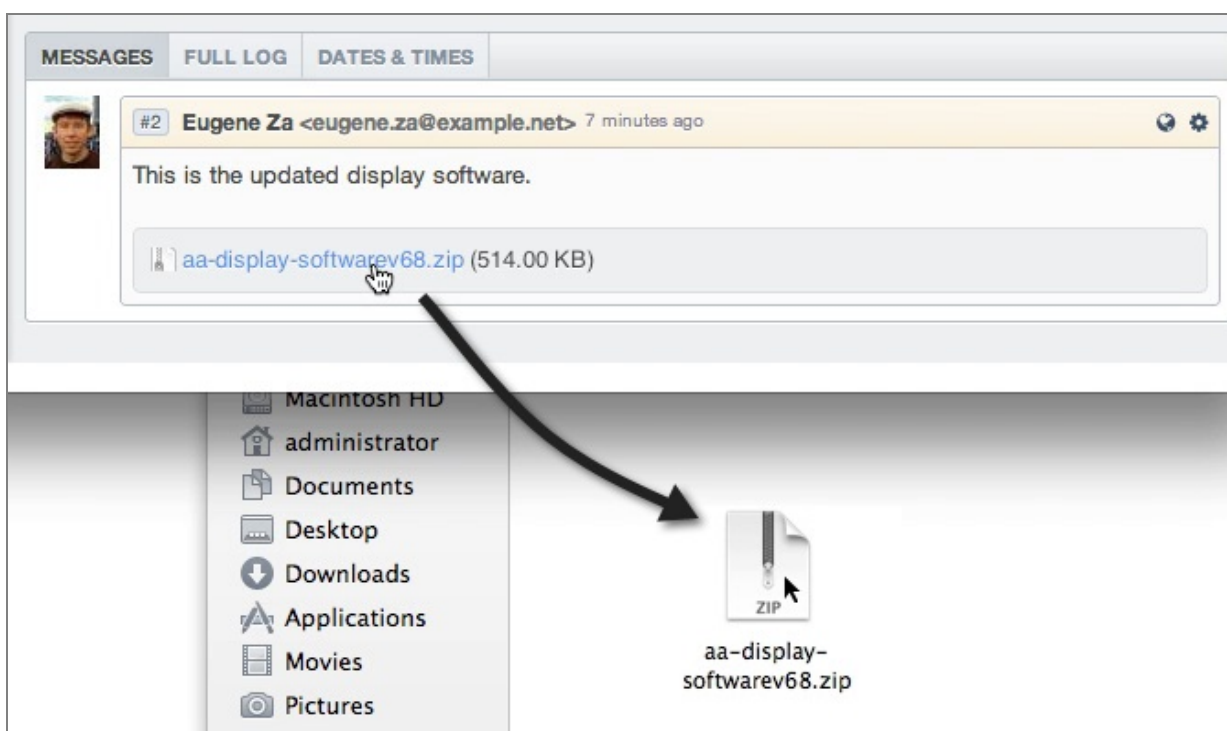


To drag an attachment between two tickets that are open in the content pane, drag it to the tab of the destination ticket. This will bring the destination ticket to the front, and you can then drop the attachment where you want it.

You can drag an attachment from a previous message on a ticket into the current reply.



You can drag an attachment from a ticket message back into your desktop file system.



Drag and drop is only supported on recent versions of the Firefox and Chrome browsers.

Quick message screenshots with paste or drag and drop

You can quickly add screenshots or other images to the body of your message by **pasting** them from your clipboard.

If you have software on your computer that can save a screenshot directly to the clipboard with a keyboard shortcut, then you only need to press Ctrl-V (Mac: Cmd-V) in the reply box to upload the image. Taking and adding a screenshot to your ticket reply can be done in two key presses.

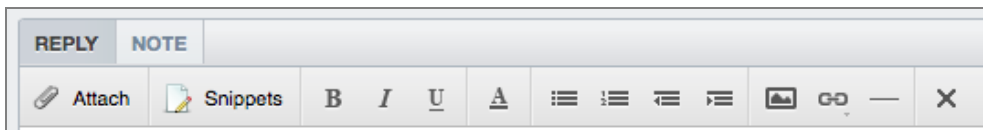
Pasting screenshots only works correctly on recent versions of Firefox and Chrome browsers.

For Windows users, we recommend the free software [Greenshot](#) for taking screenshots.

You can also drag and drop an image file from the desktop into a ticket message.

Ticket message formatting

You can apply rich text formatting to your message using the controls above the text area. If you've used standard word-processing software before, you should find them familiar.



The text style buttons are:

- **B** for bold
- *I* for italics
- U for underlined text
- **A** for colored text (select the color after you click on it)

You can use these buttons in two ways:

- 1 Toggle: without any text selected, click a button to apply the relevant style to everything you type from that point on. Click it again to stop.
- 2 Paint: select some text, then click a button to apply the relevant style to the selection. Click it again with the same selection to remove that style.

You can toggle bold with the keyboard shortcut **Ctrl-B** and italics with **Ctrl-I**.

To the right of the text styling controls are buttons which apply formatting to your current paragraph, or all paragraphs under the selection area:

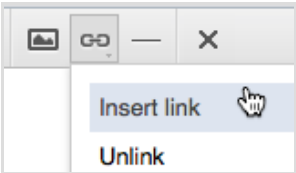
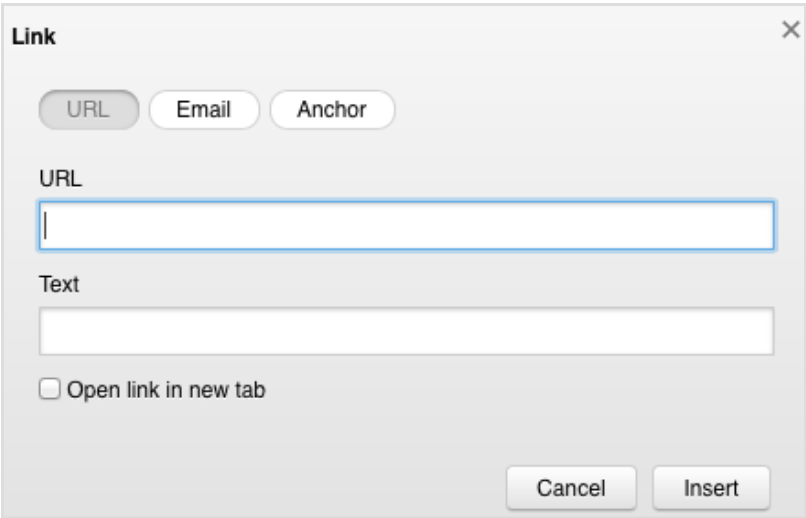
- bulleted list
- numbered list
- shift paragraph left
- shift paragraph right

The button enables you to insert an image into the body of the message. You can either upload an image file from your desktop, or provide the web address of an image file.

The button enables you to insert a clickable web link or email address into your message.

Using links in messages

To insert a clickable link to a website or file server:

- 1 Optionally, highlight some text you want to turn into a link.
- 2 Click the  icon, then click **Insert link**.

- 3 The default **URL** link type is used for inserting a web link.

- 4 Enter the full address in the URL field e.g.
`http://www.yourcompany.com/troubleshooting` .
- 5 Enter the text for the link in the Text field e.g. "our troubleshooting guide" - if you highlighted some existing text, it will appear here.
- 6 Check the **Open link in a new tab** box if you want the link to open in a new tab when the user clicks it. (This will usually happen anyway, depending on how they read their email).

The result is the link "[our troubleshooting guide](http://www.yourcompany.com/troubleshooting)," which goes to `http://www.yourcompany.com/troubleshooting` .

To insert a clickable email address that will open a new email in the user's email client:

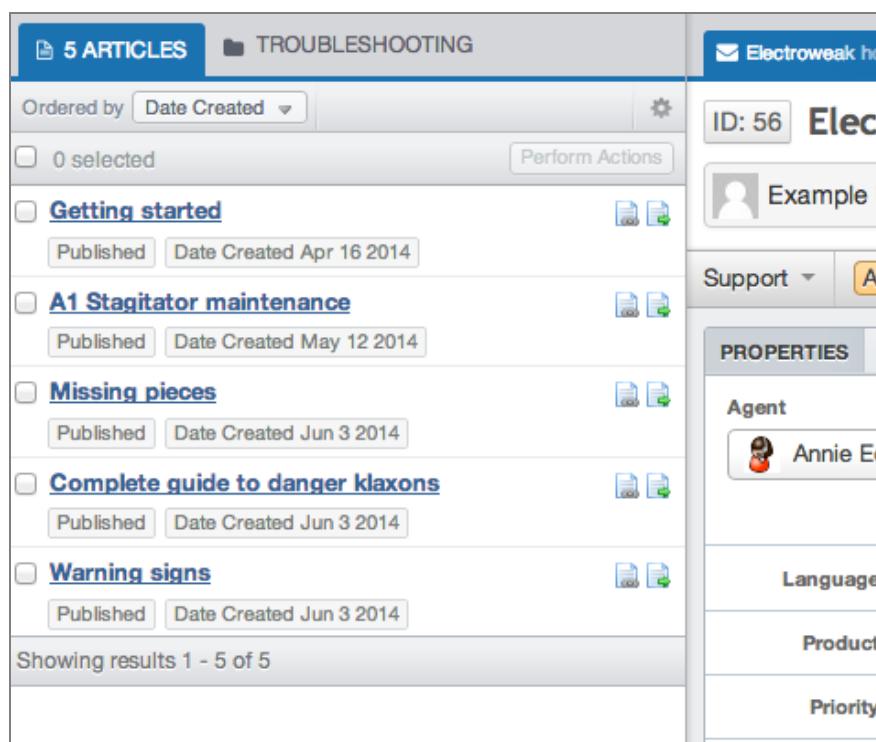
- 1 Optionally, highlight some text you want to turn into an email link.
- 2 Click the  and click **Insert link**.
- 3 Select the **Email** link type.
- 4 Enter the email address in the Email field e.g.
- 5 Enter the text for the link in the Text field e.g. "email our sales team".

To remove a link, highlight it, press the  button and click **Unlink**.

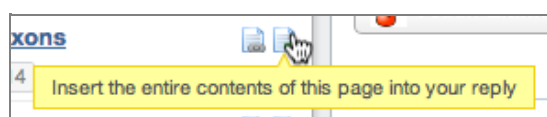
Quick-linking to Knowledgebase articles and downloads

You can quickly direct users to Knowledgebase content while keeping the ticket you're working on open in the content pane.

Open the relevant Knowledgebase articles or downloads in the list pane.



For articles, you can use the page/arrow icon to insert the full article contents into a ticket message.

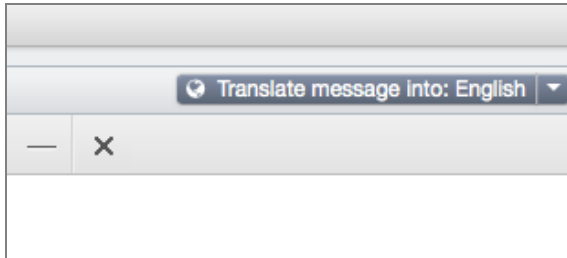


For articles and downloads, you can use the page/chain icon to insert a link to the item.



Automatic translation plugin

If your admins have installed the Microsoft Translator plugin, you will see a control to translate the message content between languages.



Note that this is automatic translation, and quality of results can vary. Be cautious when sending automatically translated replies in a language you don't understand.

Ticket notes

Notes are messages intended for viewing only by other agents. They show up in the message history as usual, and agents will be notified of them according to their preferences, but they are not sent to the user.

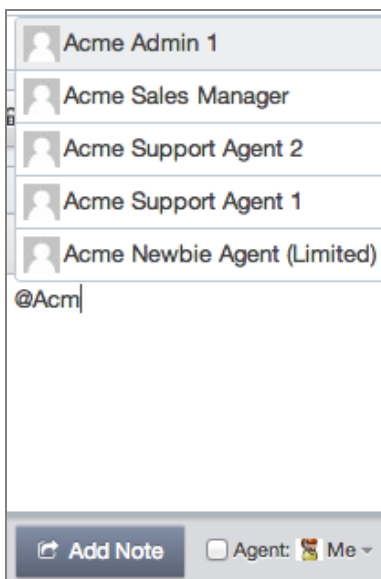
Click the **Note** tab to enter a note.

You can convert a normal ticket message to a note, or vice versa, by using the gear icon to the right of the note or message.

@mentions

You can quickly alert another agent that you've written a note you want them to see using **@mentions**.

Type @ and then start typing the agent's name - you'll see a list of matching suggestions.

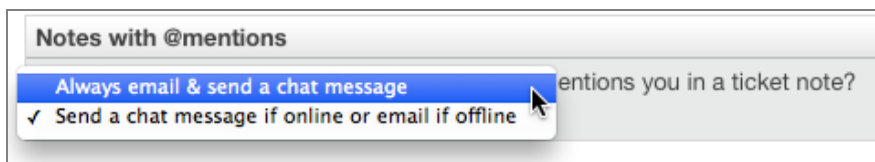


Click on the agent you want to notify.

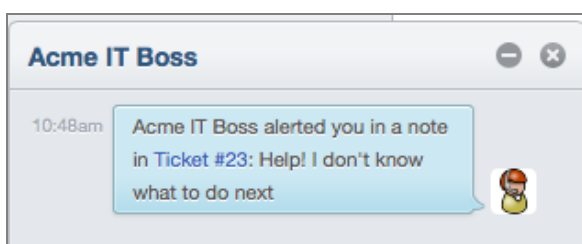
Enter the rest of your note. When you click **Add Note**, the agent you mentioned will be notified that you mentioned them.

How you are notified when somebody @mentions you depends on your **Notes with @mentions** preferences setting: you can choose either:

- Always receive an email and an agent IM message
- Receive an agent IM message if online, and an email if you're not logged in to DeskPRO



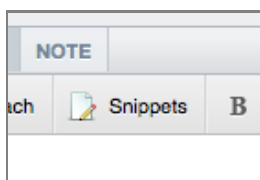
Note that the @mention IM notifications use the agent IM system; you will receive them even if you are logged out of user chat in the toolbar.



Snippets

Snippets are a way to avoid typing the same thing into messages over and over again.

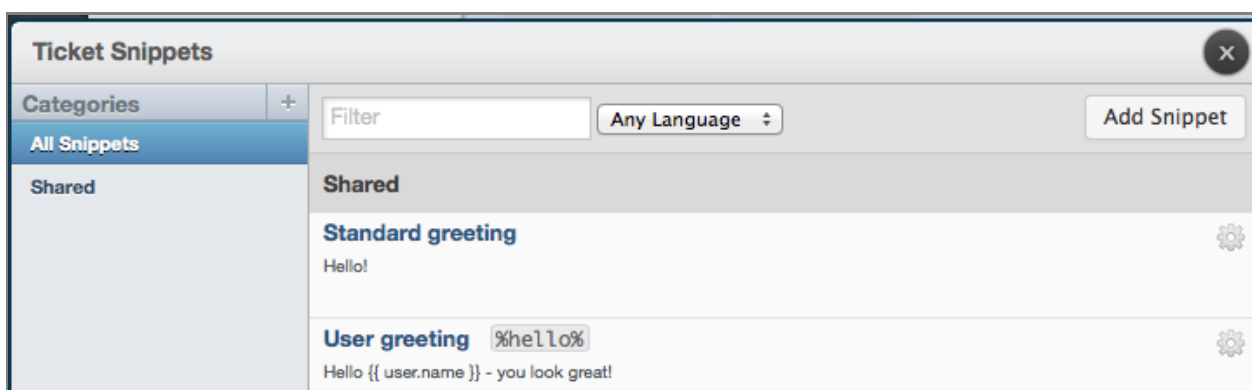
You can use a snippet to automatically insert a piece of rich text, including images.



To set up a snippet:

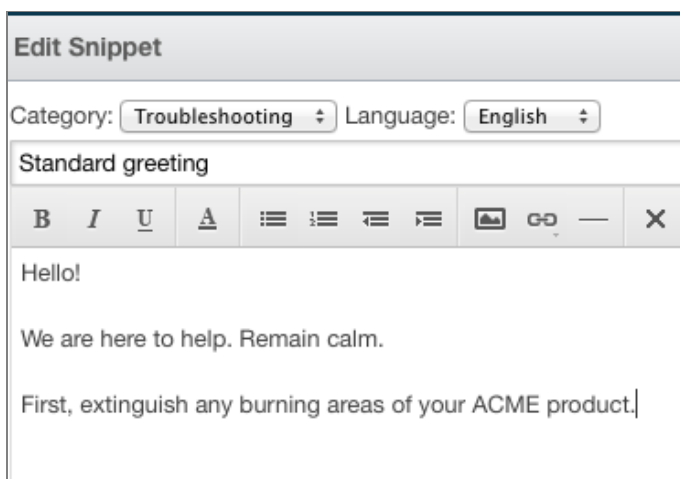
Click the **Snippets** button. You may be prompted to create a category - if so, enter "Personal" and leave the "Category can be used by" option set as "Just me".

From the resulting **Ticket Snippets** window, click **Add Snippet**.



In the **Edit Snippet** window, enter a title for the snippet. This is to describe what the snippet does; it will not change the title of a ticket.

Enter and format the snippet content. For example, perhaps you want to be able to quickly enter your standard greeting.



Click **Save** in the **Edit Snippet** window.

Now in the **Ticket Snippets** window, click the title of your new snippet and it will be inserted into your message at the cursor.

You can edit the content that a snippet will insert by clicking the gear icon next to its title.

Note that you don't need to use a snippet to add a personal signature to your messages - use the **Ticket Signature** setting in **Preferences**.

Snippet categories and sharing

You can organize your snippets into categories. Create a new category with the **+** button in the Categories pane of the Ticket Snippets window.

If you choose to create a **Shared** category, any snippets in that category will be available to all agents.

This is useful for standardizing your communication. For example, if you want agents to use a standard greeting, you can save it as a shared snippet. Then all agents can insert the exact same greeting.

Another use for snippets is to provide standardized "canned answers" to common problems.

Snippet shortcuts

There's a quicker way to insert a snippet, using a **shortcut code** that you type into a message.

For example, you can set it up so that your standard greeting is inserted whenever you type `%hello%`. Shortcut codes always begin and end with `%`.

Open the **Ticket Snippets** window and edit a snippet with the gear icon.

You can enter a shortcut code for the snippet at the lower left (you don't need to type in the symbols).



Snippet variables

What if the content you want to enter with a snippet varies from ticket to ticket? For example, what if you want your standard greeting snippet to mention the user by name?

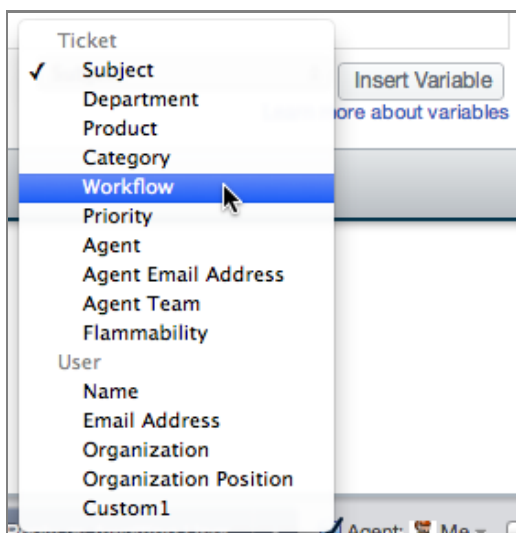
You can automatically insert information into your message using **variables**.

For example, to make a snippet which addresses the user by name, you can add the following to the snippet content:

```
Hello {{ ticket.person.display_name }}
```


When you paste the snippet into a message, the variable is replaced by the user's actual name.

The easiest way to insert variables is to select them from the list at the lower right of the **Ticket Snippets** window, then click **Insert Variable**.



The following variables are available.

Snippet variable	Value inserted
{{ ticket.product.title }}	current product of ticket
{{ ticket.category.title }}	current category of ticket
{{ ticket.workflow.title }}	current workflow stage of ticket
{{ ticket.priority.title }}	current priority of ticket
{{ ticket.id }}	ticket ID number
{{ ticket.ref }}	ticket ref code
{{ ticket.fieldX }}	display a custom ticket field; replace X with field ID *
{{ ticket.date_created }}	time and date ticket was created e.g. 2014-03-14 11:38:17
{{ ticket.agent.display_name }}	the name of currently assigned agent (or override name if set)
{{ ticket.person.display_name }}	user's name
{{ ticket.person.fieldX }}	display a custom user field; replace X with field ID *

* you can find out the ID for custom fields by using the **insert variable** function or asking your admins

3.8. Replying to tickets by email

When you receive an email notification about a message from a user, you can reply to it in your email client, rather than in the agent interface. DeskPRO will process your message as a reply to the user.

You must make sure to type your reply above the `=== REPLY ABOVE ===` line.

Note that if you receive an email as a follower of a ticket, any reply you make by email will be sent to the user, not to the assigned agent - even if you are replying to a message the agent sent. If you want to send a message via email to the agent, you can use an email action code to send your reply as a note. Simply put `#note` at the top of your response. The content of your email will be added as a note on the ticket, and the assigned agent will be notified about if they have enabled the relevant preference.

Email action codes

DeskPRO allows agents to perform actions via the use of special action codes. Action codes must be placed at the top of the email message and all follow the format:

`#codename option`

where **codename** is the name of a code, and ***option*** is an optional parameter used to perform an action.

For example, if you reply to a user by email and put `#status resolved` at the top, the relevant ticket will be set as resolved.

You can enter as many codes in one email as you want so long as they are at the very top of the email. DeskPRO strips out codes when it sends email, so they are not seen by the user.

Code	Description	Example
<code>#status <i>option</i></code>	Sets the ticket status. Available options: ▪ <i>agent</i> ▪ <i>user</i> ▪ <i>resolved</i> ▪ <i>hold</i>	<code>#status resolved</code>
<code>#awaiting-agent</code>	Shortcut for <code>#status agent</code>	<code>#awaiting-agent</code>
<code>#awaiting-user</code>	Shortcut for <code>#status user</code>	<code>#awaiting-user</code>
<code>#resolved</code>	Shortcut for <code>#status resolved</code>	<code>#resolved</code>
<code>#hold</code>	Shortcut for <code>#status hold</code>	<code>#hold</code>
<code>#unhold</code>	Removes hold status on a ticket and sets status to awaiting agent.	<code>#unhold</code>
<code>#note or #is-note</code>	Sets the current reply to be an agent note rather than a ticket reply.	<code>#is-note</code>
<code>#assign <i>option</i> or #agent <i>option</i></code>	Assigns the ticket to the agent specified. Option can be: ▪ Agent email address. ▪ Full agent name (e.g., "john doe").	<code>#assign</code> <code>john@example.com</code> <code>#assign john doe</code>

#team <i>option</i> or #assign-team <i>option</i>	Assigns the ticket to the team specified	#team support
#user <i>option</i>	Used only if an agent is sending a new ticket to the helpdesk, this sets the ticket user by email address.	#user user@example.com
#label <i>option</i> or #labels <i>option</i>	Adds labels to the ticket. Provide labels as a comma-separated list.	#label bug, important
#dep <i>option</i> or #department <i>option</i>	Sets the department.	#dep support
#cat <i>option</i> or #category <i>option</i>	Sets the ticket category.	#cat consumer
#prod <i>option</i> or #product <i>option</i>	Sets the product.	#prod gyrocopter
#pri <i>option</i> or #priority <i>option</i>	Sets the priority.	#pri urgent
#field <i>value</i>	Sets any custom field. #field is the name of the custom field with spaces removed or turned into dashes, and value is the value to set.	#license-id 12345 #discount yes
#noreply	Prevents a message from being added to the ticket. Use this when you want to use other action codes but don't want to add an actual reply to the ticket.	#noreply

When DeskPRO is searching for values based on a string title or name (for example, a category name or an agent name), all comparisons are case-insensitive and ignore white space and punctuation. Here are a few examples:

- "Booker Dean-DeWitt" is matched as `bookerdeandewitt` .
- "License ID" is matched as `licenseid` .
- "Product Name (Full)" is matched as `productnamefull` .

Your **option** values are treated the same way. So `#assign Booker dean dewitt` or `#assign booker dean de-WITT` would both match the name "Booker Dean-DeWitt".

3.9. Creating a ticket

A ticket can be created in the following ways:

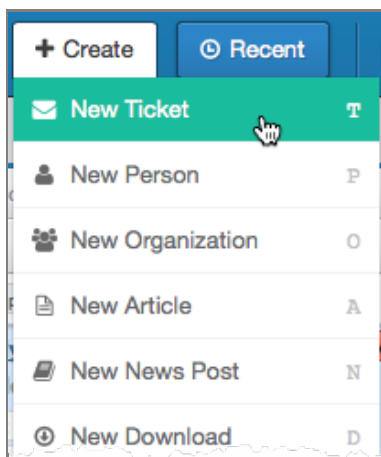
- 1 A user submits a ticket through the **web portal**
- 2 A user sends an email to a support address that is linked to DeskPRO.
- 3 An agent creates a ticket on behalf of a user, *either*
 - by using the agent interface *or*
 - by forwarding a user email message to the support address.

A ticket is always associated with a user. You can change a ticket's user, but it's not possible to have a ticket without a user at all. (As a result, deleting a user will also delete all their tickets).

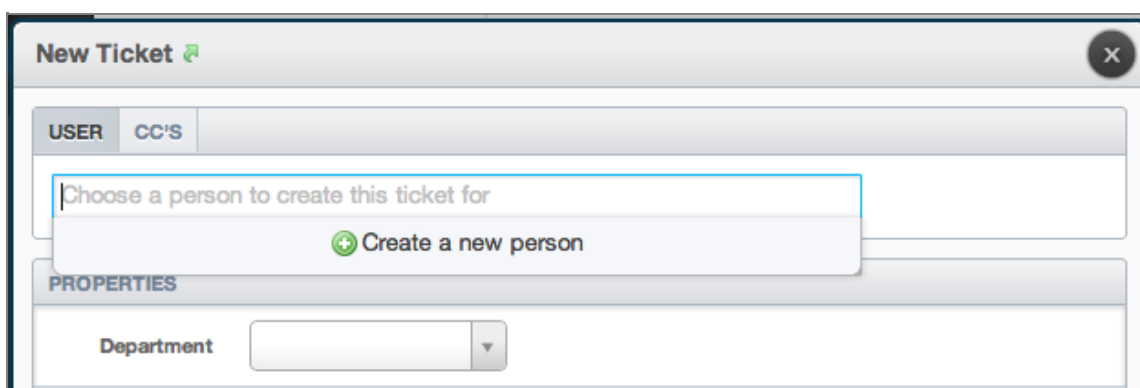
In most helpdesks, users will normally create their own tickets by sending an email or using the ticket submission form in the Contact Us section of your web portal.

However, you may need to create a ticket on behalf of a user - for example, if they are telling you about the issue over the phone or in person.

You can create a new ticket from the **Create button** in the toolbar at the top of the agent interface.



The new ticket must be associated with a user, so you must either choose a user or create one.



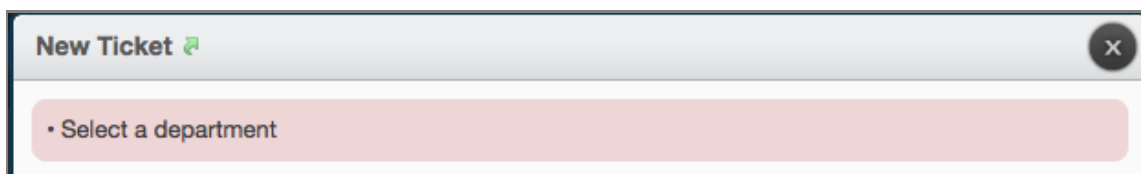
Begin typing either a name or an email address in the **Choose a person to create this ticket for** text area. DeskPRO will show you matching records as you type.

Alternatively, click **Create a new person** to make a new user record. You will need to provide the user's email address and name.

Field validation

Depending on your helpdesk configuration, it may be compulsory to select or enter values for some of the ticket fields.

For example, if your helpdesk has [departments](#), you have to specify one:



When you have selected the fields, you can assign the ticket to an agent or team.

Note that when an agent creates a ticket, the fields which are compulsory may differ from when a user creates a ticket.

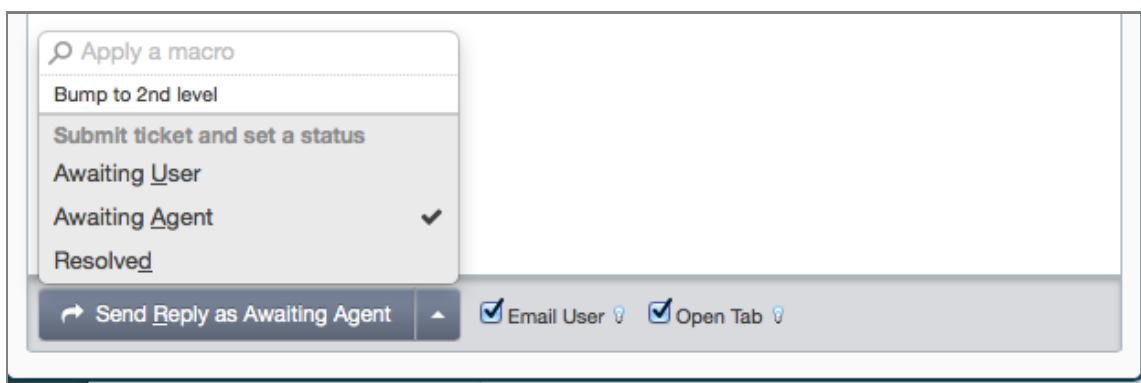
The requirements for fields can also be different between departments.

New ticket message

When you create a ticket, you must write a message, which would usually include a description of the problem.

Your options when sending the message are as follows:

- Set the status of the new ticket as:
 - **awaiting user** (default)
 - **awaiting agent** or
 - **resolved**
- Select whether or not to email the message to the user with the **Email User** checkbox.
- Select whether or not to open the new ticket in a tab in the content pane straight away with the **Open Tab** checkbox.



For example, suppose your job is to take down the content of a phone call and pass it to the right part of your company. You could write a summary of the issue for the other agents, uncheck **Email User**, assign it to the appropriate agent/team, and then choose **Send Reply as Awaiting Agent**

On the other hand, your job might be to research the issue and then send help information to the user by email. In that case, you might write a message addressed to the user, summarizing the problem and suggesting a fix. It would make sense to leave **Email User** selected, assign the ticket to yourself, and **Send Reply as Awaiting User**.

If you were able to resolve the user's issue on the phone, you would probably want to **Send Reply as Resolved**.

See [Replying to a ticket](#) for more details about ticket messages.

Forwarding an email to create a ticket

There's another way you can create a ticket on behalf of a user: you can forward a user email to an email address configured to automatically create tickets. This feature is convenient if a user has emailed a support request to the wrong place.

DeskPRO will make a ticket from the user's original message and associate it with that user, even though it came from your address. The text of the forwarded email appears as the first message on the ticket. If you write something above the forwarded text, that appears as a message from you.

The ticket is created as unassigned, but you will be added to the ticket as a follower. If the original message had addresses in the email cc: field, they will be added to the [CC](#) field for the new ticket.

You can use [Email action codes](#) when creating a ticket in this way.

'Unable to verify the email address' error

Some email programs forward messages in a way that stops DeskPRO detecting the original email address of the user.

DeskPRO tries to work out the original user from the text headers of the email you send. For example, if the headers are:

-----Original Message-----

From: Victoria Johnson [mailto:victoriajohnson@example.co.uk]

Sent: 05 November 2013 14:38

To: agent_email@example.com

Subject: Support Request

DeskPRO can detect `victoriajohnson@example.co.uk` in the From: line and determine that she is the original user.

Some clients send a `From:` header that is missing the email address when a message is forwarded, e.g.

From: Victoria Johnson

This commonly happens in enterprises that use Outlook and Active Directory.

If you run into this problem, you should forward the original email to DeskPRO *as an attachment*. This will give DeskPRO the information it needs to work out the original user.

'Unable to parse the original message' error

This means that your client forwarded a message that DeskPRO did not understand. If you are using less common email software, DeskPRO may not be able to interpret the headers.

If you receive this error, please forward an example email to `support@deskpro.com` so our developers can fix the issue in future update.

Processing email cc: field

When a ticket is created from an incoming email, DeskPRO will process any email addresses that are cc'd in to the email.

By default, any agents who are cc'd in to the original email will be added to the ticket as followers. Your admins may have disabled this.

Any non-agent email addresses cc'd in to the email will be CC'd to the ticket.

3.10. Ticket actions

Aside from the core reply and assignment functions, there are various other actions you can apply to tickets.

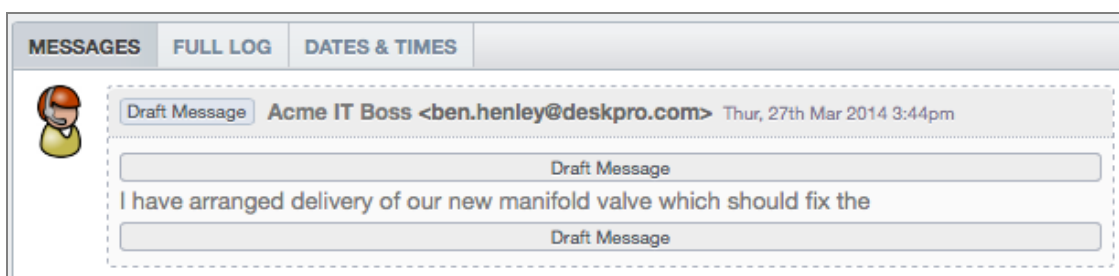
All the actions below are available from the buttons above the reply area.



Locking tickets

Confusion about who is working on a ticket is usually prevented by:

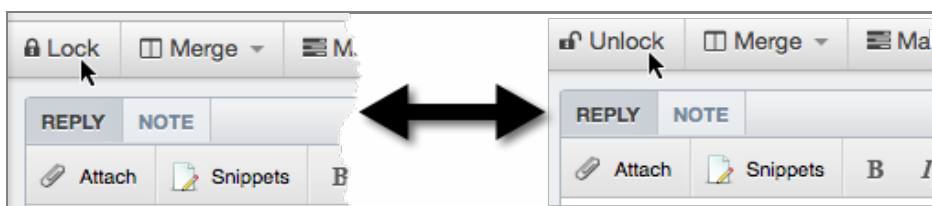
- 1 agent assignment
- 2 the live draft messages you see if another agent is replying to a ticket.



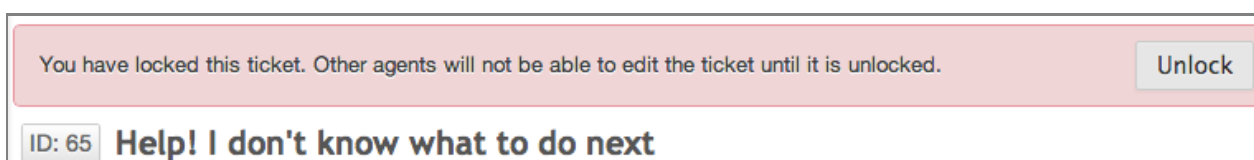
Sometimes you may want to make clear to other agents that you're working on a ticket and prevent them from editing it - for example, if you are researching the issue.

Locking the ticket achieves that.

The **Lock** button is above the reply area when you view a ticket in the content pane.



You can unlock the ticket from the **Lock** button or at the top of this tab.



The lock will automatically be removed after a period of time set by your admins (one hour is the default). This is to stop tickets being left locked for too long.

DeskPRO can also be set to automatically lock a ticket while an agent is viewing it.

Merging tickets

Sometimes you will end up with two tickets about the same issue - for example, two different users in the same organization report the same thing, or a user emails about the same issue from two different email addresses.

You can quickly **merge** two tickets together, combining their details to make one ticket.

When tickets merge, some properties will be overwritten. For example, a ticket can only have one subject, so the merged ticket can keep the subject from only one of the original tickets.

You can pick which ticket will overwrite the other ticket's properties.

If a value for a property is only set in one ticket, then it is kept in the merged ticket, regardless of which ticket you pick. For example, if one ticket is assigned to an agent team A, and the other ticket isn't assigned to any team, the new ticket will always be assigned to agent team A.

If the tickets have different users, the other user will be added as a **CC** to the new ticket.

The labels from both tickets will be applied to the new ticket.

The **Merge** button is above the reply area when you view a ticket in the content pane.

- 1 Open one of the tickets in the content pane.
- 2 Click the **Merge** button.
- 3 You are shown a list of the user's tickets and open tickets. If you want to merge with a different ticket, click **Search**, then enter a ticket ID. It may take a second or two to show the matching ticket.
- 4 Select the ticket you wish to merge with.
- 5 The **Merge Ticket** window opens. Click **Switch** to pick which ticket's properties to keep where there's a conflict. The values shown in red will be overwritten.

Merge Ticket

Find ticket

	Keep This	Switch	Merge This
ID	8		9
SUBJECT	Trouble booting up drilling machine		Capacity of the Acme Gyrocopter
PERSON	Eric User		Eric User
DATE CREATED	Fri, 7th Mar 2014 10:45am		Fri, 7th Mar 2014 11:00am
DEPARTMENT	Support Dept.		Support Dept.
STATUS	Awaiting User		Awaiting Agent
URGENCY	7		2
LANGUAGE	English		English
CATEGORY	Reseller		Consumer
PRIORITY	Busywork		Busywork
PRODUCT			Gyrocopter
WORKFLOW			Follow up
LABEL			explosion legacy-product recurring

Merge these two tickets

Click **Merge these two tickets** to complete the process. You cannot undo a ticket merge.

Holding tickets

Putting a ticket **on hold** is useful if the user is awaiting a reply, but you are waiting for a third party to do something before you can respond. For example, you need to hear back from one of your company's suppliers before you can send the user a solution to their problem.

You can put a ticket on hold using the **Actions** pulldown menu.

Only tickets that are **awaiting agent** can be put on hold. You can think of on hold as a sub-status that applies to **awaiting agent** tickets.

If there are tickets on hold, you will see how many there are in the **Awaiting Agent** area of the filter pane; the checkbox toggles between not showing held tickets and *only* showing held tickets.

TICKETS	SEARCH		TICKETS	SEARCH
AWAITING AGENT	☐ 3 ON HOLD		AWAITING AGENT	☒ 3 ON HOLD
▶ My Tickets	1		▶ My Tickets	0
▶ Tickets I Follow	3		▶ Tickets I Follow	0
▶ My Teams' Tickets	5		▼ My Teams' Tickets	0
▶ Unassigned Tickets	9		▶ Unassigned Tickets	3
▼ All Tickets	16		▼ All Tickets	3
Support Dept.	14		Support Dept.	2
Sales Dept.	2		Sales Dept.	1

Tickets on hold will be displayed in the rest of the interface as normal, whether or not the box is checked.

You can't search for tickets that are on hold from the advanced ticket search. You can find them using the **quick search bar**.

A good way to make sure you don't forget about a ticket you put on hold is to create a [task](#) linked to that ticket.

Changing a ticket's user

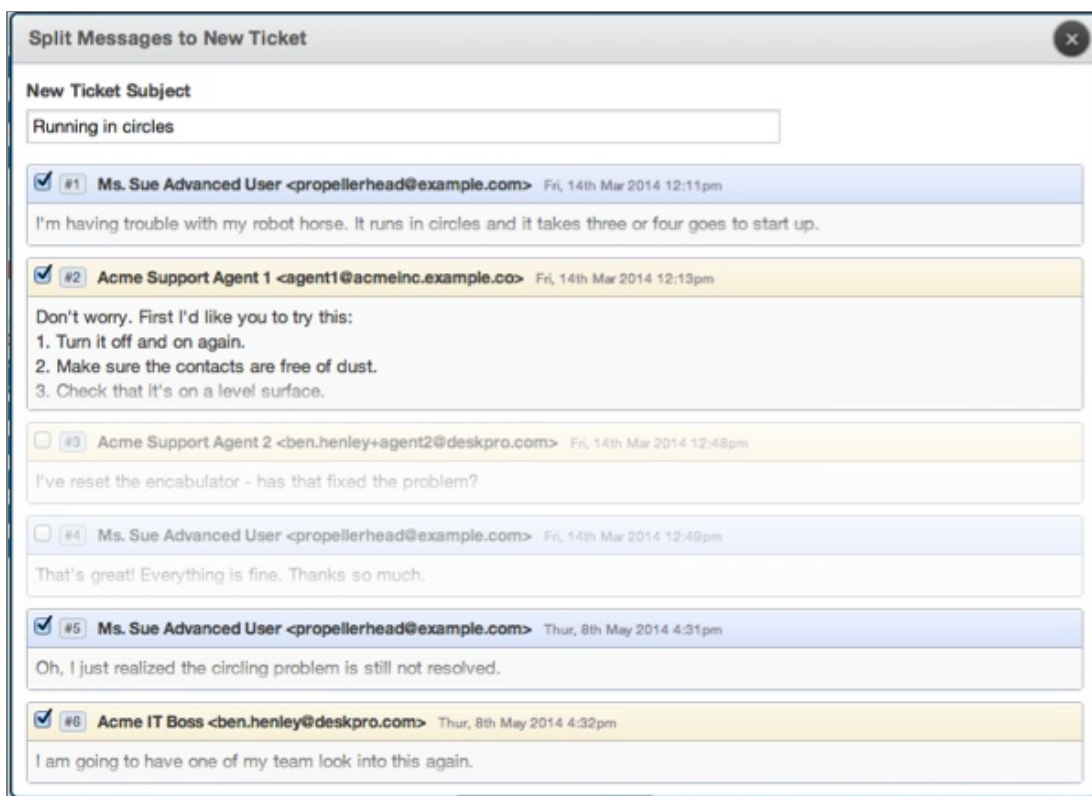
You can change the user associated with the ticket from the **Actions** pull-down menu, creating a new user record if necessary.

For example, if user A creates a ticket, but then tells you that user B will be handling it from now on, change the user. That way user B will receive emails about the ticket, will be able to track it from your web portal, etc.

Splitting messages to a new ticket

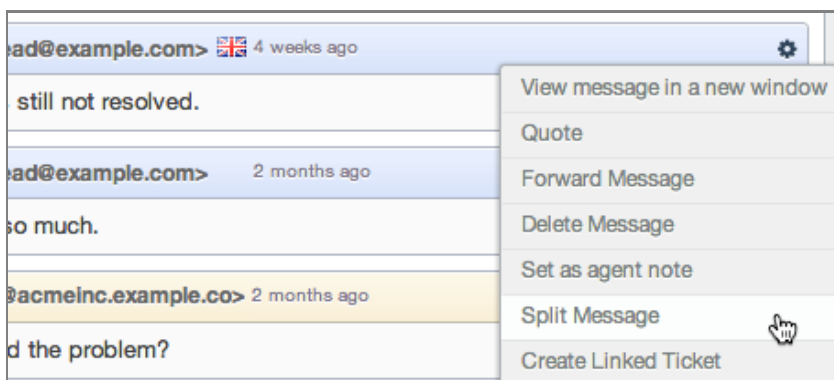
If there are messages about two different issues mixed up in a single ticket, you can use **Split Messages To New Ticket** from the **Actions** pull-down menu.

Enter a title for the new ticket, and select the messages you want to move with the checkboxes.



The user for the new ticket will be the same.

You can also split off an individual message from the ticket history into a new ticket. Click the gear icon at the top right of the message, and select **Split Message**.



Creating a linked ticket

Sometimes you might want to have separate tickets for the same issue. For example, suppose a user raises a ticket and you need to discuss it with an outside contractor. You don't want to change the ticket user, and you don't want to add the contractor as an agent.

The solution is to create a **linked ticket**, using **Create Linked Ticket** the **Actions** pull-down menu.

The new linked ticket acts like an independent ticket, but you can see that it's linked to the original ticket when you open it in the content pane.

ID: 65
Help! I don't know what to do next

Susan (ham@eggs.net.za)
Add CC

Support Dept.
Awaiting Agent
3

PROPERTIES	LINKED TICKETS (1)	TASKS (0)	SLAS	BILLING
Parent Ticket				
Subject	Department	Person	Agent	Status
Help! I don't know what to do next	Support Dept.	Jethro Vortex <user@example.com>	Acme IT Boss	Awaiting Agent 3

This works only one way: you can't see the newer ticket from the original ticket.

Creating a new pending article

If you realize that the issue in a particular ticket should be addressed in a knowledgebase article, you can use **Create a new pending article** from the **Actions** pull-down menu.

Create a new pending article

A pending article is a note in the Publish section about an article that needs to be written.

Enter a note or description about the article that needs to be written. It will also be linked to this ticket.

Enter a **note** describing the article that needs to be written, then click **Add**.

This creates a **pending article** in the Publish app.

PUBLISH
SEARCH
4 ARTICLES

PENDING
Add

Pending Articles	0 selected	Perform Actions
All Drafts 2	☐ Ticket Technical support urgently needed Need to update troubleshooting guide	Create Article Delete

The pending article is linked to the ticket, making it easy to refer to the ticket while writing the article.

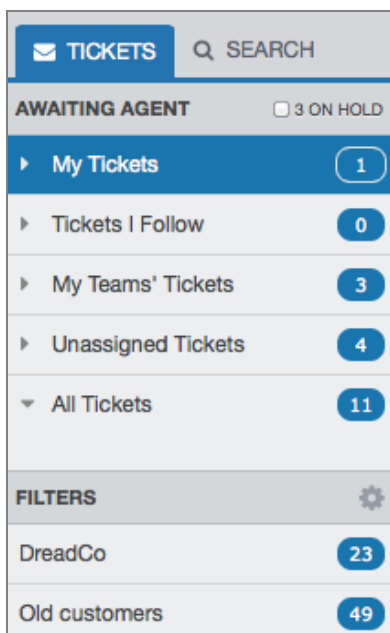
Printing and exporting ticket information

You can select **Print** from the **Actions** pull-down menu to display the ticket in a layout suitable for printing from your web browser.

You can select **Download PDF** from the **Actions** pull-down menu to get a PDF version of the ticket details and message history.

3.11. Filtering and sorting tickets

The Tickets app has a variety of **filters**. Some of them are shown in the image below; for example, **My Tickets** is a filter.



Filters give you an overview of how busy the helpdesk is at a glance, because each filter displays the number of tickets it matches. In this example, there is one ticket in **My Tickets**, none in **Tickets I Follow**, three in **My Teams' Tickets**, and so on.

To select a filter, click on it. The tickets matching it are displayed in the **list pane**.

The awaiting agent section

At the top of the filter pane is the **Awaiting Agent** section. As you'd expect, this section only shows the tickets with **awaiting agent** status; in other words, the tickets agents need to act on because the user is waiting for help!

The filters in this section are:

- **My Tickets** - tickets assigned to you and awaiting agent.
- **Tickets I Follow** - tickets you follow that are awaiting agent.
- **My Teams' Tickets** - tickets assigned to a team you belong to that are awaiting agent.
- **Unassigned Tickets** - unassigned tickets that are awaiting agent.
- **All Tickets** - all tickets that are awaiting agent.

Ticket status filters

At the bottom of the filter pane you can see filters for the other statuses.

TICKETS	LABELS	FLAGGED
Awaiting Agent		11
Awaiting User		27
Resolved		3
Awaiting Validation		0
Spam		0
Recycle Bin		~2

The **Awaiting Agent** filter will show you the same tickets as the **All Tickets** filter in the **Awaiting Agent** section.

The other filters available are:

- Awaiting User
- Resolved
- Awaiting Validation
- Spam (tickets marked as spam)
- Recycle Bin (deleted tickets)

Tickets marked as spam or deleted will be permanently deleted after a period of time set by your admins - by default, spam tickets are kept for 2 weeks, and deleted tickets for 1 month.

Real-time updating in the list pane

When you click a filter, it shows you all matching tickets in the list pane. It's a lot like running a search - except that a filter doesn't just show you the tickets that matched at one point in time.

The list of matching tickets automatically updates itself. If you watch the **All Tickets** filter for a busy helpdesk for a while, you'll see tickets appear and disappear.

Tickets will appear in **All Tickets** as they are set to **awaiting agent**, whether because they have just been created or because the user has just replied.

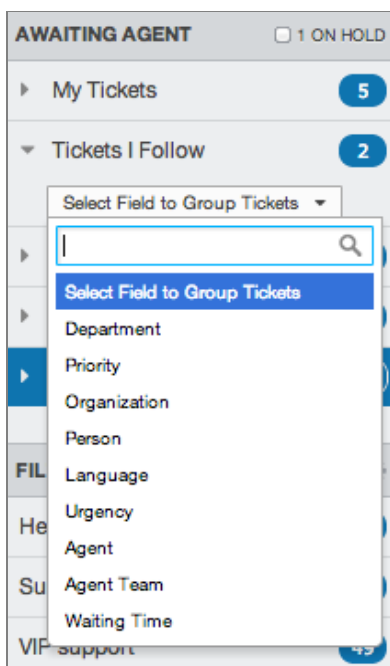
A ticket might disappear because an agent replied and set the status back to **awaiting user**, or because it was marked as spam or deleted, or because it was put on hold.

You can disable real-time updates by clicking the  icon at the upper right of the list pane.

Grouping tickets

You can customize the filters in the **Awaiting Agent** section by **grouping** tickets to create a subfilter.

- 1 Click the arrow to the left of a filter.
- 2 Click on **Select Field to Group Tickets**
- 3 Select the field you are interested in from the pull-down menu.

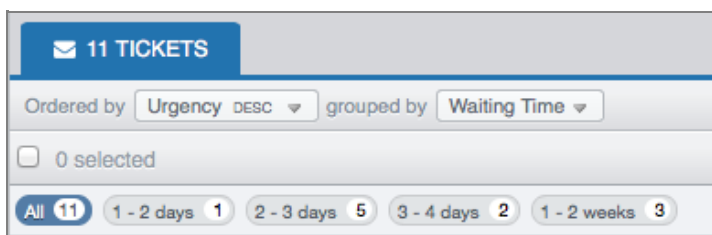


For example, you might choose to group **All Tickets** according to the user's organization.



To change the grouping, just click the arrow again.

A second level of grouping is available in the list pane, using the **grouped by** control.



DeskPRO creates groups based on the range of values for the property you've selected.

You can click the groups at the top of the list pane to filter the results further.

Creating custom ticket filters

If grouping is not sufficient to show you the tickets that matter to you, you can also define your own custom filter.

A custom filter is specific to your account; other agents can't see your custom filters.

When you set up a custom filter, you will also be able to choose to receive notifications about tickets which match the filter in your notification preferences.

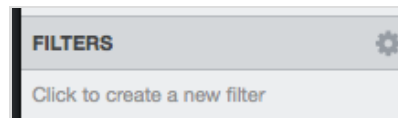
Filters						
	New Ticket	Filter Match	User Message	Agent Message	Agent Note	Property Change
example	☒	☒	☒	☐	☐	☐
filter	☐	☐	☒	☒	☐	☒

To make a custom filter:

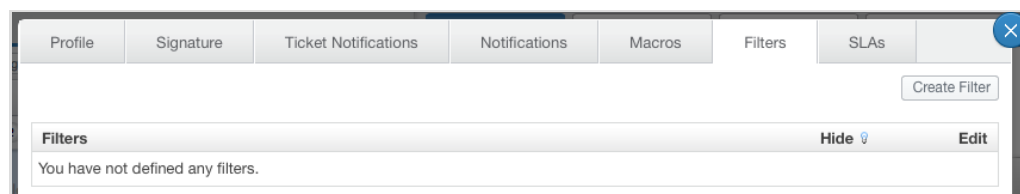
- 1 Click the **Filters** section



icon to make a new custom filter.



- 2 The Filters section of your account **Preferences** opens.



- 3 Click **Create Filter**.
- 4 Under **Title**, enter a name for the filter that describes what it shows.
- 5 Click **Add criteria** to select a ticket property that you want to show in this filter.

Possible criteria are:

- Originated interface (how tickets were created - email, web portal, website or through the agent interface)
- Ticket Gateway Address
- Ticket Gateway Account i.e. the email account through which the ticket was created
- Subject
- Department
- Assigned Agent
- Assigned Team
- Followers (which agents are following the ticket)
- Labels
- Status
- Ticket is on hold
- Organization
- Product
- Category
- Urgency
- Priority
- Workflow
- SLA (filter tickets to which a certain SLA applies)
- SLA Status (filter tickets which are meeting or failing an SLA)
- User Waiting Time (filter tickets that are currently awaiting agent by how long they have had that status)
- User Total Waiting Time (filter by how long in total the ticket has spent awaiting agent over its lifetime)
- Date Created
- Date Closed (when the ticket was archived - this only applies if your helpdesk has a very large number of tickets and older ones have to be archived)
- Date of Last Agent Reply
- Date of Last User Reply
- Custom ticket fields your admins may have set up

You can filter tickets by the properties of the ticket's user:

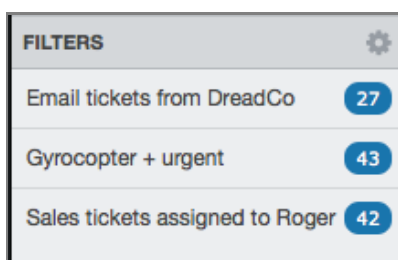
- **Name** (of user)
- **Email Address** (of user)
- **Email Domain** (the part of the user's email address after the @ symbol - useful for finding users from the same company)
- **Person ID** (ID number, the user equivalent of ticket ID)
- **Date** of profile creation
- **Labels** (on the user)
- **Contact Phone**
- **Contact Address**
- **Contact Instant Messaging**
- **Custom user fields** your admins may have set up

You can also filter by the properties of the user's organization:

- **Date Created**
- **Email Domains** (which email domains are recorded in DeskPRO for the organization: e.g. email from anyone @dreadco.zy is from a user belonging to the DreadCo organization)
- **Labels**
- **Contact Phone**
- **Contact Address**
- **Contact Instant Messaging**
- **Custom organization fields**

You can click **Add Criteria** again to add to the filter - the filter will only show tickets which meet *all* the criteria you set.

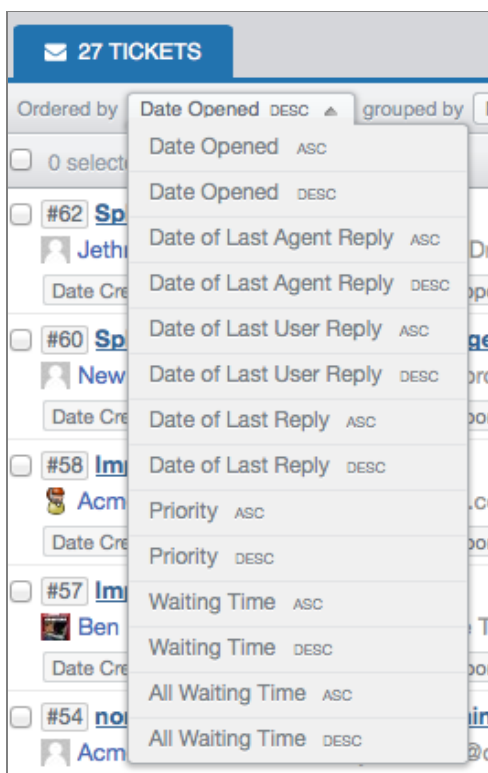
Close the account preferences window with the **X** at the top right. Your custom filters are displayed in the filter pane.



Ordering tickets in the list pane

Once you have selected a list of tickets using a filter, you may want to view them in a certain order - for example, oldest tickets first, or tickets with the highest [urgency](#) first.

You can order the tickets in the list pane using the **Ordered by** pull-down menu.



ASC and DESC mean *ascending* and *descending*. For example, **Waiting Time ASC** means that the tickets will be shown in ascending order of user waiting time: the waiting time gets higher as you go up the list, with the highest waiting time at the top.

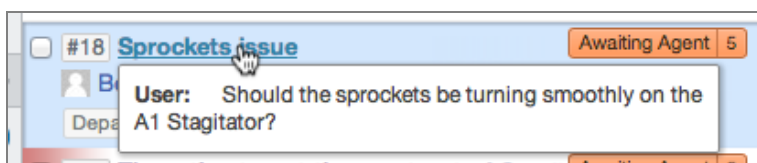
You can order by:

- **Urgency** (available for **Awaiting Agent** and custom filters only)
- **Date Opened** (when the ticket was created)
- **Date of Last Agent Reply**
- **Date of Last User Reply**
- **Date of Last Reply**
- **Priority** (if your helpdesk uses this field)
- **Waiting Time** (for tickets with awaiting agent status; this does nothing on tickets with another status)
- **All Waiting Time** (total time spent with awaiting agent status over the ticket's lifetime)

Note that DeskPRO saves your chosen order separately for each filter.

Ticket mouseover preview

You can see a preview of the most recent message in a ticket by mousing over it.



Field display options

Some fields are shown in gray boxes on each ticket in the list pane.

The screenshot shows a list of tickets. The first ticket is #65, titled "Help! I don't know what to do next", from Susan <ham@eggs.net.za> to Ace Tomato. It has a status of "Awaiting Agent" with 6 agents. Annotations with arrows point to the ticket ID, the user name, the agent name, and the "Date Created" field. The second ticket is #1, titled "free cookies in all packaging", with a status of "1" (yellow circle). It is a "Feature request" in the "Delivery" category, created on "Apr 10 2014". Annotations with arrows point to the ticket ID, the title, the category, and the "Date Created" field. A third ticket is partially visible above the second one, from Orlando Frumious <user@example.com> to Archon, with annotations pointing to the "Tickets: 2", "Labels: expert", and "English" fields.

You can customize which fields are displayed by clicking the  icon at the top right of the list pane.

The dialog box titled "Display Options: My Teams' Tickets" allows users to customize the fields displayed in the ticket list. It features a close button (X) in the top right corner. Under the "Department" section, there are three checked checkboxes: "Department", "Agent", and "Date Created". Below this, there are several unchecked checkboxes arranged in rows: "ID", "Status", "Agent Team", "Language", "Category", "Priority", "Workflow", "Product", "Organization", "SLAs", "Labels", "User Waiting", "All Waiting Time", "Date of Last Reply", "Date of Last User Reply", "Date of Last Agent Reply", "Date Resolved", "Flammability", and "User Field: Custom1". An "Apply" button is located at the bottom center of the dialog.

Use the checkboxes to add and remove fields, then click **Apply**.

The screenshot shows the ticket list after applying the display options. At the top, there is a header "3 TICKETS" with an envelope icon. Below it, there are filters: "Ordered by" set to "Urgency DESC" and "grouped by" set to "None". There is a "0 selected" status bar. The list contains three tickets:

- Ticket #65: "Help! I don't know what to do next" by Susan <ham@eggs.net.za> to Ace Tomato. Status: "Awaiting Agent" (6). Fields displayed: Category: Consumer, Priority: Routine, Flammability: Flammable, All Waiting Time: 3 days.
- Ticket #61: "Rotor splitting during takeoff" by Brian Canid <coyote@example.com> to CTO, DreadCo. Status: "Awaiting Agent" (3). Fields displayed: Category: Regulator, Priority: Existential, Flammability: Inflammable, All Waiting Time: 3 days.
- Ticket #9: "Capacity of the Acme Gyrocopter" by Eric User <rocketfan@example.com> to DreadCo. Status: "Awaiting Agent" (2). Fields displayed: Category: Consumer, Priority: Busywork, Flammability: Inflammable, All Waiting Time: 5 days.

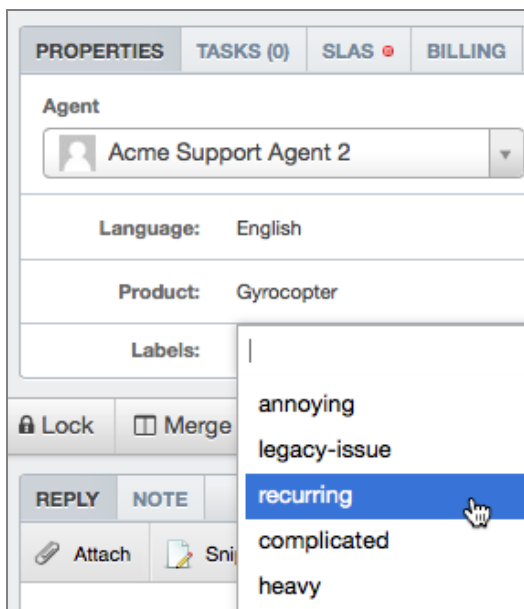
The fields you choose to display are saved separately for each filter.

Labeling tickets

You can apply **labels** to tickets, user/organization records, articles/news posts/downloads and feedback items. A label is a short piece of text you can attach to items to help find them quickly, and group similar items.

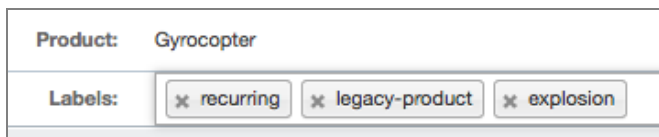
Labels are shared between all agents.

You can add a label to an item using the content pane from the **Properties** section of an individual ticket.



The screenshot shows the 'PROPERTIES' tab of a ticket. The 'Agent' field is set to 'Acme Support Agent 2'. The 'Language' is 'English' and the 'Product' is 'Gyrocopter'. The 'Labels' field is open, showing a list of labels: 'annoying', 'legacy-issue', 'recurring' (highlighted with a mouse cursor), 'complicated', and 'heavy'. There are also 'Lock' and 'Merge' buttons. At the bottom, there are 'REPLY' and 'NOTE' tabs, and 'Attach' and 'Snip' buttons.

You can either select an existing label from the pull-down menu, or type a new one and press Enter (your admins may disable the ability to create new labels for some types of item).



The screenshot shows the 'Labels' field in the ticket properties pane. It contains three labels: 'recurring', 'legacy-product', and 'explosion'. Each label has an 'x' icon to its left, indicating it can be removed.

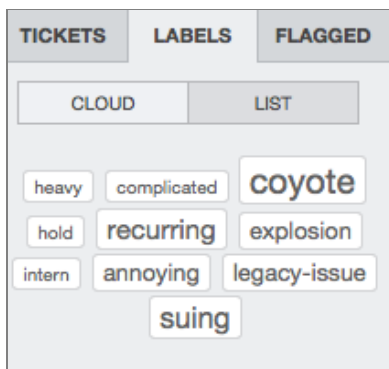
Click the **x** on the left of a label to remove it.

You can also apply labels as a [mass action](#).

There are many possible uses for labels, depending on the needs of your helpdesk.

Labeling has two benefits:

- 1 Searches from the **Quick Search bar** match labels.
Suppose you had a ticket that was about engine problems but didn't mention the word "engine" in the Subject field. A quick search for "engine" wouldn't find it, but you could label it "engine" to make it easier to find.
- 2 You can use labels to filter tickets using the **Labels** tab in the bottom section of the filter pane.



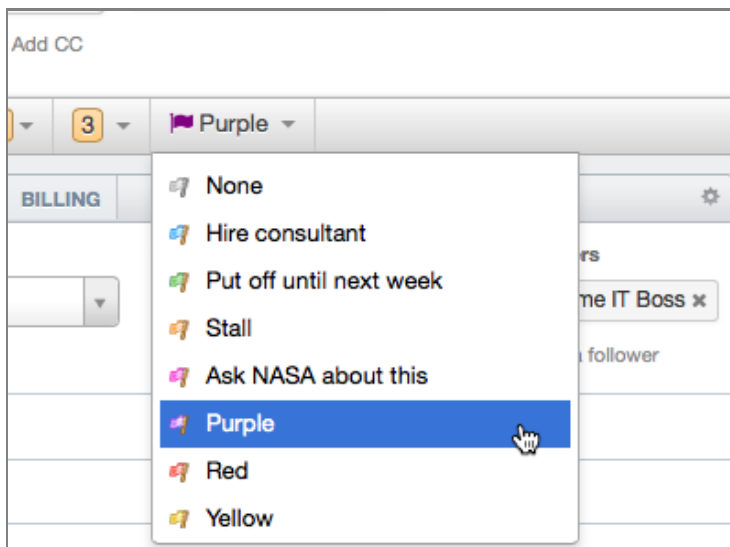
Click on each label to see tickets.

The **Cloud** view shows labels in bigger text the more tickets they have. You can also select a **List** view by clicking on the List tab.

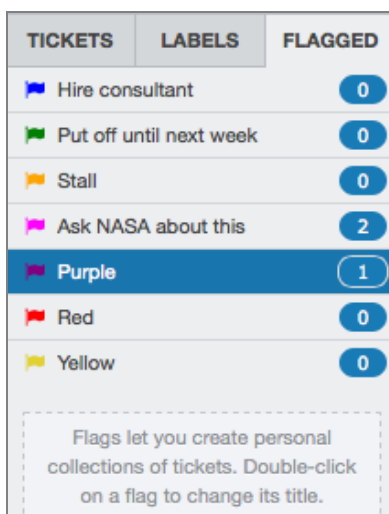
Flags

Flags are a personal way to organize tickets. Unlike labels, other agents can't see your flags.

You can apply flags using the content pane from the **Properties** section of an individual ticket.

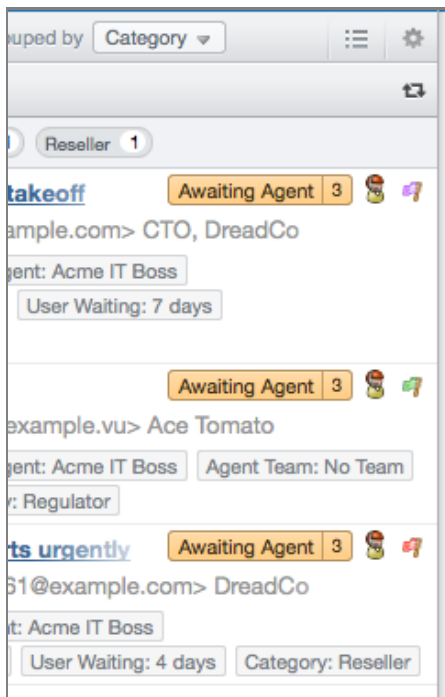


You can use flags to filter tickets from the **Flagged** tab in the bottom section of the filter pane.



By default, flags are named after their colors.

You can double-click on the flag names in the filter pane to change them to something more descriptive. Flags are also displayed at the right hand side of the list pane.



3.12. Prioritizing tickets

There are several different ways in DeskPRO to track which tickets are most important.

SLAs

SLAs (Service Level Agreements) are targets set up by your admins for how soon you should reply to or resolve a ticket. They may reflect your company's own service standards, or contractual obligations your company has to your users.

A simple example is an SLA which states you will send the first reply to each ticket within 4 hours.

The way SLAs track waiting time can be more complex: for example, you can have an SLA that states a user shouldn't spend more than 12 hours total waiting time during your helpdesk working hours before their ticket is resolved.

An SLA may apply to all tickets, or only to certain categories of tickets. For example, if some organizations pay you for premium support, your helpdesk could have an SLA that applied only to tickets from those organizations. Some SLAs can be assigned by agents manually.

An SLA also has a **warning** time which specifies when you will be warned that the ticket is close to failing.

You can see SLAs in the Tickets app filter pane.

SLAs			
First Response	7	2	1
Special VIPs	0	1	0

In this example, 7 tickets are currently passing the "First Response" SLA (figure in green), 2 are on warning (in amber), and 1 has failed (in red).

Click on the name of an SLA to see all the tickets to which it applies, ordered by descending SLA severity (that is, failing tickets at the top).

10 TICKETS	
Ordered by	SLA Severity desc
grouped by	None
0 selected	
☐	#11 Technical support urgently needed
	Simon User <simon@example.com> DreadCo
	Department: Support Dept. Agent: Unassigned Agent Team: No Team
☐	#71 Need replacement parts urgently
	Mariam User <mariam1961@example.com> DreadCo
	Department: Sales Dept. Agent: Acme IT Boss Agent Team: No Team
☐	#70 Loose bolt issue
	A User <auser@example.com> DreadCo
	Department: Support Dept. Agent: Acme IT Boss Agent Team: No Team
☐	#59 Spin-off
	Advanced User <propellerhead@example.com> DHARMA
	Department: Support Dept. Agent: Acme Support Agent 1 Agent Team: Support Mana
☐	#48 Different wheel type??
	Suki User <suki96@example.com> DreadCo

Tickets that are **failing** an SLA are *red* at the left-hand edge whenever they're displayed in the list pane.

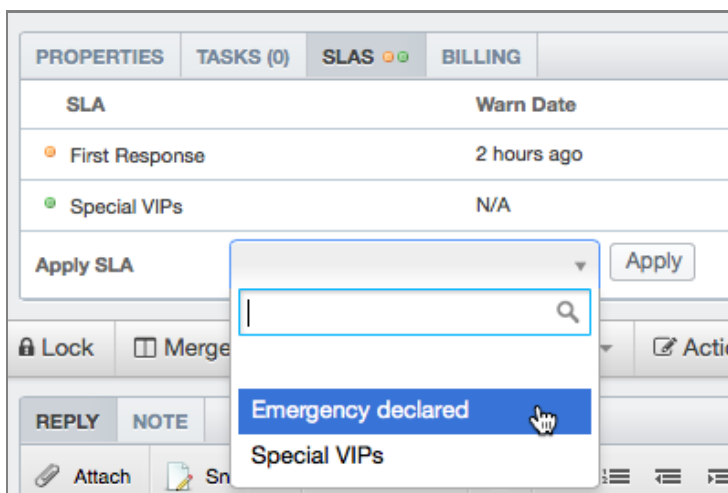
Tickets on **warning** are *amber* at the edge.

To see the details of your helpdesk's SLA conditions, click the  icon in the SLA section.

You can view the SLAs which apply to an individual ticket in the **SLAs** tab in the content pane.

PROPERTIES	TASKS (0)	SLAS  	BILLING
SLA		Warn Date	
 First Response		2 hours ago	
 Special VIPs		N/A	

This is also where you can select agent-assigned SLAs to apply to the ticket.



Filtering SLAs

Click the  icon at the top right of the SLAs section to open the SLAs section of your account **Preferences**.

From here you can use the **Filter SLA results** pull-down menu to change what the SLAs area of the filter pane shows.

Profile	Signature	Ticket Notifications	Notifications	Macros	Filters	SLAs
Filter SLA results: Show only tickets assigned to me 						
SLAs	Type	Warning	Failure	Hide 		
First Response	Time until first response (Default working hours)	90 minutes	3 hours	☐ Hide		
Special VIPs	Time until ticket resolution (24x7)	1 hour	2 hours	☐ Hide		

You can choose from these options:

- Show all matching tickets
- Show only tickets assigned to me
- Show only tickets assigned to my team

For example, if you select **Show only tickets assigned to me** then close **Preferences**, you see SLA information only for tickets assigned to you.

SLAs: MY TICKETS 	
First Response	1 2 0
Special VIPs	1 0 1

You can also use the **Hide** checkboxes to hide SLAs that are not relevant to you.

SLAs	
Future	Hide
Hours	☐ Hide
Days	☒ Hide

If a ticket is created by an agent, SLAs which specify the time until first response will not apply.

PROPERTIES	TASKS (0)	SLAS	BILLING	
SLA		Warn Date		Fail Date
Special VIPs		N/A		N/A
First Response		N/A		N/A

Urgency

Tickets are assigned an **urgency** score from 1 to 10. This is a graded measure of how soon the ticket needs attention.

ID: 70	Loose bolt issue
A User (auser@example.com)	DreadCo
Support Dept. ▾	Awaiting Agent ▾ 8 ▾

Urgency can be set manually by agents. Your admins can also automatically change urgency with automatic processes - for example, admins may use **escalations** to make tickets more urgent if they are taking a long time to resolve.

Here's an example of tickets sorted by descending urgency in the list pane.

All	Regulator: 4	Consumer: 1	Reseller: 2
☐	#70	Loose bolt issue	Awaiting Agent: 8
A User <auser@example.com> DreadCo			
Department: Support Dept. Agent: Acme IT Boss Agent Team: Support Managers			
☐	#64	test split - user should be BH	Awaiting Agent: 5
Ben H <ben.henley@gmail.com> Ace Tomato			
Department: Support Dept. Agent: Acme IT Boss Agent Team: 2nd Level Support			
☐	#61	Rotor splitting during takeoff	Awaiting Agent: 3
Brian Canid <coyote@example.com> CTO, DreadCo			
Department: Support Dept. Agent: Acme IT Boss Agent Team: 2nd Level Support			
☐	#67	Noise issue?	Awaiting Agent: 3
Test User <testymctest@example.vu> Ace Tomato			
Department: Support Dept. Agent: Acme IT Boss Agent Team: No Team			
☐	#68	Problem report (phone call)	Awaiting Agent: 3
Suki User <suki66@example.com> DreadCo			
Department: Support Dept. Agent: Acme IT Boss Agent Team: No Team			
☐	#71	Need replacement parts urgently	Awaiting Agent: 3
Mariam User <mariam1961@example.com> DreadCo			
Department: Sales Dept. Agent: Acme IT Boss Agent Team: Support Managers			

The urgency scores are displayed on the right. Low urgency scores are colored yellow, shading through orange to red as the score gets higher.

Note that SLA condition and urgency score are independent. A ticket can fail an SLA or be on SLA warning, but still have a low urgency.

Ticket priority field

Priority is an optional ticket field. It lets you assign a ticket a priority level - these are ordered from lowest to highest priority.

Your admins set the number of different priority levels and their names.

Here are some examples of priority levels that different helpdesks might use, in increasing priority order:

- Low/Medium/High
- Routine/Urgent
- Deviation/Anomaly/Incident/Accident/Meltdown

While **urgency** and **SLAs** are internal to your helpdesk and can't be seen by users, DeskPRO can be configured to enable users to set priority when they submit tickets from the web portal.

3.13. Macros

Macros let you apply a pre-defined sequence of actions to a ticket quickly and easily.

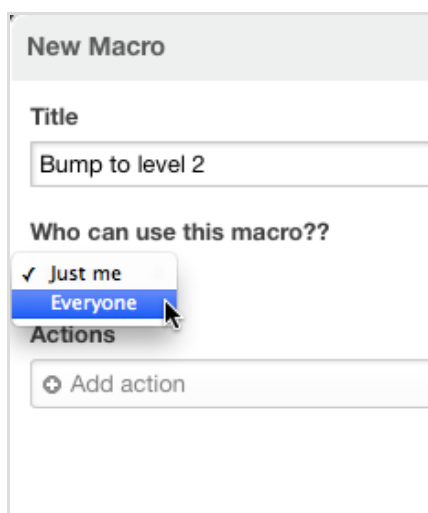
If your workflow involves doing the same steps over and over again, setting up a macro can save you time.

For example, suppose your procedure when you find a complicated problem is:

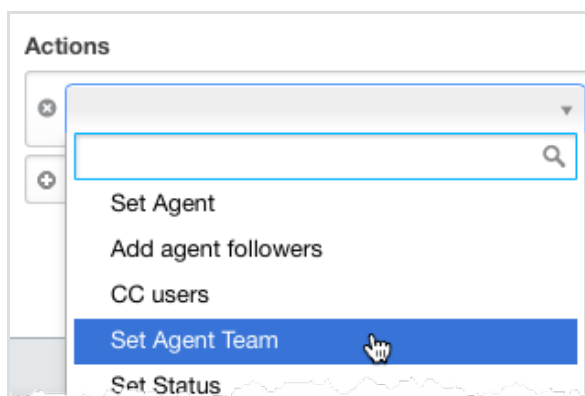
- assign it to the 2nd level support team
- label it "complicated"
- add your manager as a follower

Here's how you would set that up as a macro:

- 1 Open the **Preferences** area (in the toolbar at the top left of the interface) and select the **Macros** tab.
- 2 Click **Create Macro**.
- 3 The **New Macro** window opens.



- 4 Under **Who can use this macro??** select whether the macro is available to just you, or to every agent.
- 5 Click **Add Action**, then select an action from the pull-down menu. In this example, first you need to **Set Agent Team**.



- 6 You then select which team to assign.

7

Now use **Add Action** again with **Add Labels** to have the macro label the ticket "complicated", and use it a third time with **Add agent followers** to have it add your boss as a follower.

The 'Actions' panel shows a list of actions. The first action is 'Set Agent Team' with a dropdown menu set to '2nd Level Support'. Below it is an 'Add action' button.

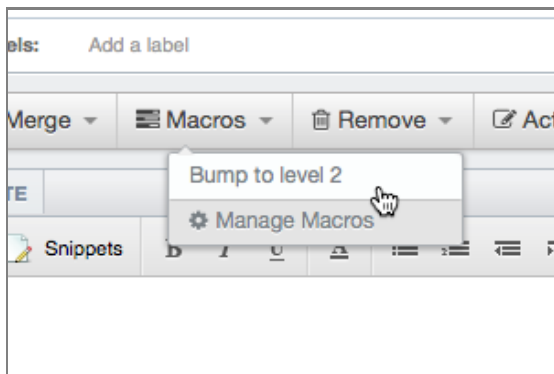
The 'Actions' panel now shows three actions: 'Set Agent Team' (2nd Level Support), 'Add Labels' (complicated), and 'Add agent followers' (Acme IT Boss). A 'Save' button is visible at the bottom right.

8

When the macro is complete, click **Save**.

When you apply that macro to a ticket, the three actions you've stored will be done (in order).

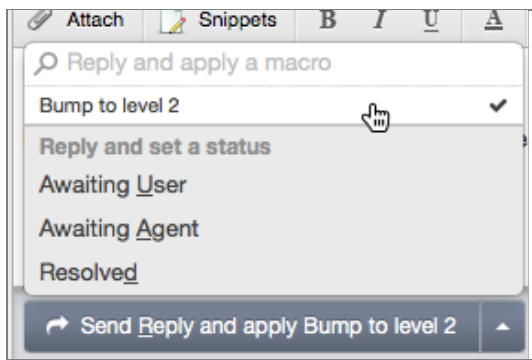
You can apply a macro from the content pane using the **Macros** button.



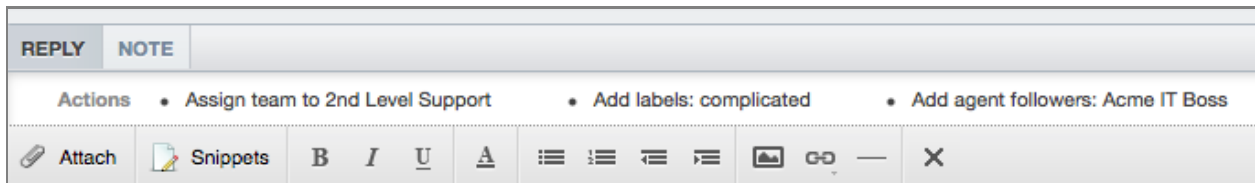
You will be asked to confirm the list of actions.

You can also choose to apply a macro when replying to a ticket, instead of setting a status.

Use the **Reply as...** pull-down and select the macro.



The actions the macro will apply are confirmed at the top of the reply box.



Of course, you can have the macro change the status for you if required.

You can also apply a macro to multiple tickets at the same time by selecting them from the list pane and using a [mass action](#).

Macro actions

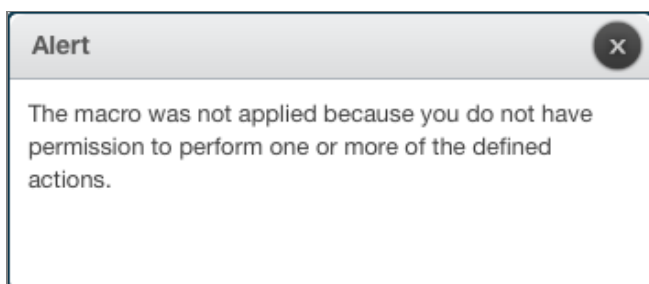
These are the actions you can add to a macro:

- Set agent
- Add agent followers
- CC users - add users who will be copied in on ticket emails
- Set agent team
- Set status
- Ticket hold status
- Delete ticket
- Set department
- Set language
- Set category
- Set product
- Set priority
- Set workflow
- Add labels
- Remove labels
- Add organization managers to ticket
- Set flag
- Increase/decrease urgency - add or subtract the defined amount from urgency score (can't go below 1 or above 10)
- Set urgency - sets the urgency score to the value you enter; you can choose 'Only set when urgency is lower' (e.g. if the urgency is 8 and a 'Set urgency to 7' action runs, the urgency would remain 8) or 'Always set this urgency' (would set the urgency to 7 in that example)
- Set subject
- Add ticket reply - adds text to the ticket's reply box. You can choose to 'Append' text (after anything you're already entered), 'Prepend' text (before anything you've entered) or replace existing text.
- Add reply from snippet
- Set custom field (if your helpdesk has these)
- Set custom user field (if your helpdesk has these)
- Close ticket tab

Macros and permissions

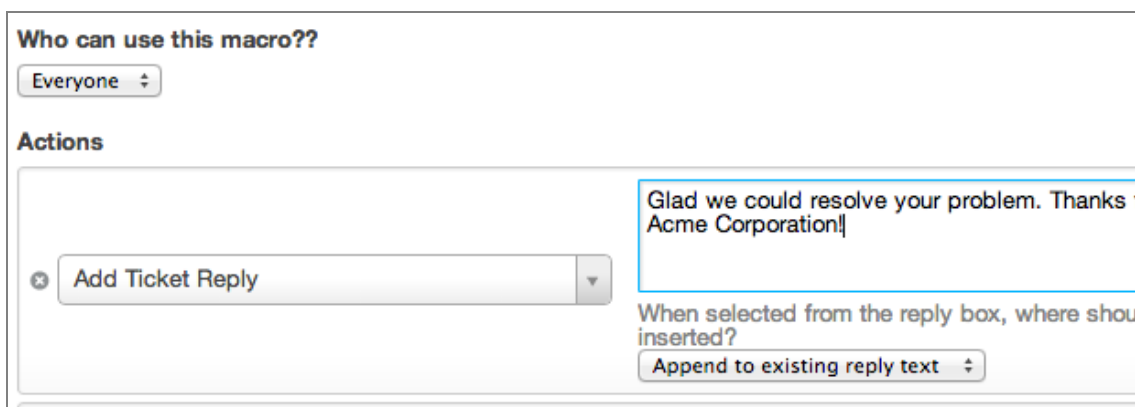
Different agent accounts have different permission levels which affect what they're allowed to do with tickets.

If your account lacks the permissions to do any of the actions in a macro, the macro can't run.

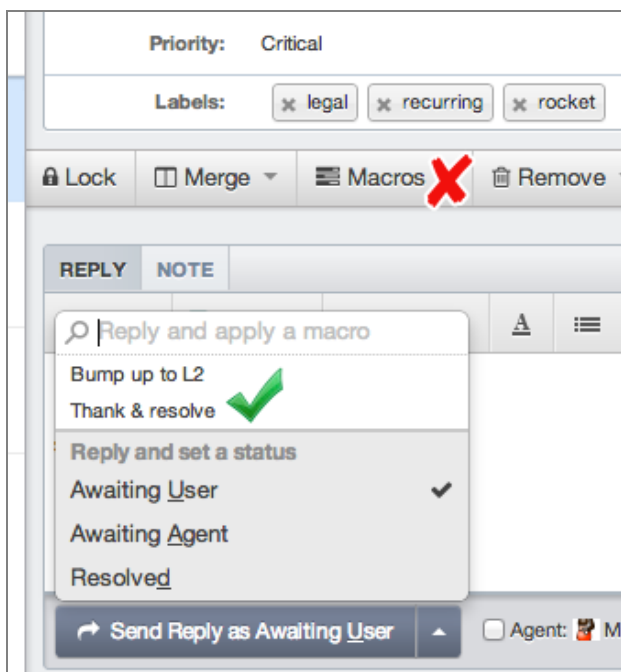


Adding text to a reply with a macro

You can use the **Add Ticket Reply** action to append or prepend text to the reply you are currently writing (i.e. add it either before or after any existing text).



However, for a macro that uses this action to work correctly, you must run it from the **Send Reply** control and not from the **Macros** button.

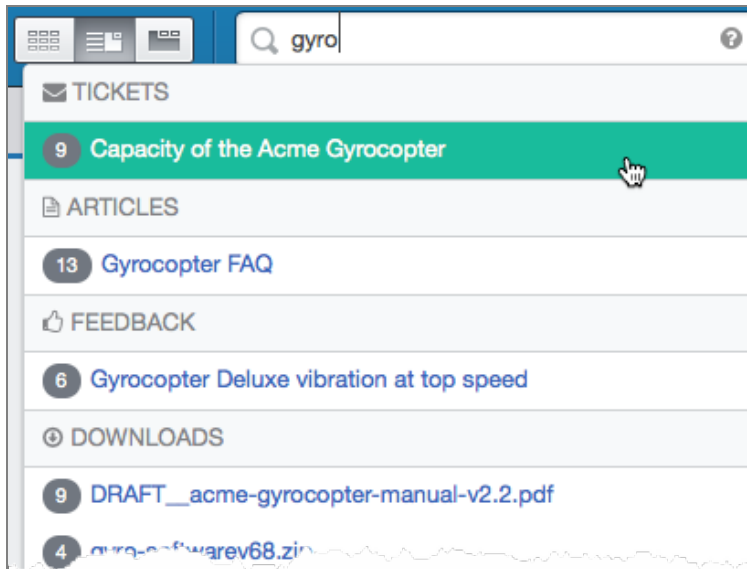


Running the macro from the **Send Reply** control performs actions in the context of your current reply, whereas running the macro from the **Macros** button (or as a mass action) runs the action in the context of the whole ticket, so the text will be sent as a new reply, not inserted into the reply box.

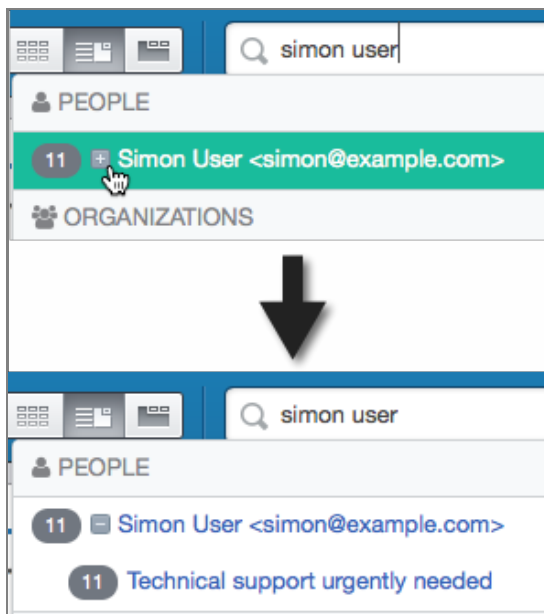
3.14. Searching for tickets

The **Quick Search** bar shows tickets where your search terms match any of the following:

- ID
- Ref code
- Subject
- Labels



Click the gray plus icon next to a user's name to view all their tickets.



If you're looking for a ticket you've worked on recently, you can also filter results from the Recent field.



Advanced ticket search

If your helpdesk has a lot of tickets, the quick search will not always be specific enough. You can construct a much more detailed custom search from the list pane.

Click the **Search** tab in the list pane to access advanced ticket search.

The advanced ticket search lets you search across many more properties of the ticket than the quick search: for example, you can search through all message text, not just the ticket subject.

You can narrow down your search using:

- **Status**
- **Agent** (and/or team)
- **Fields** (department, product, category, priority, workflow, custom fields you have set up etc.)
- **Subject**
- **Message** (the text, who wrote it, and when)
- **User** (name, email, usergroup)
- **Organization**
- **Dates & Times**

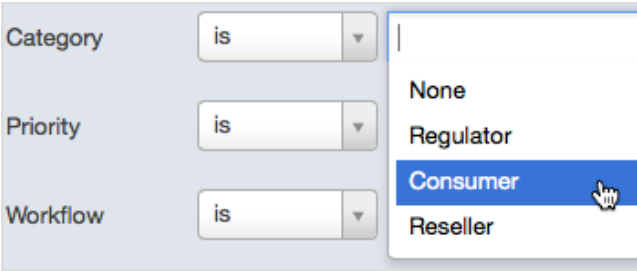
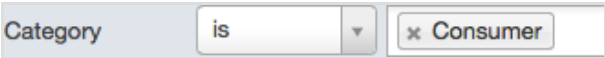
By default, your search is limited to tickets which are assigned to you and have a status of *either awaiting agent or awaiting user*.

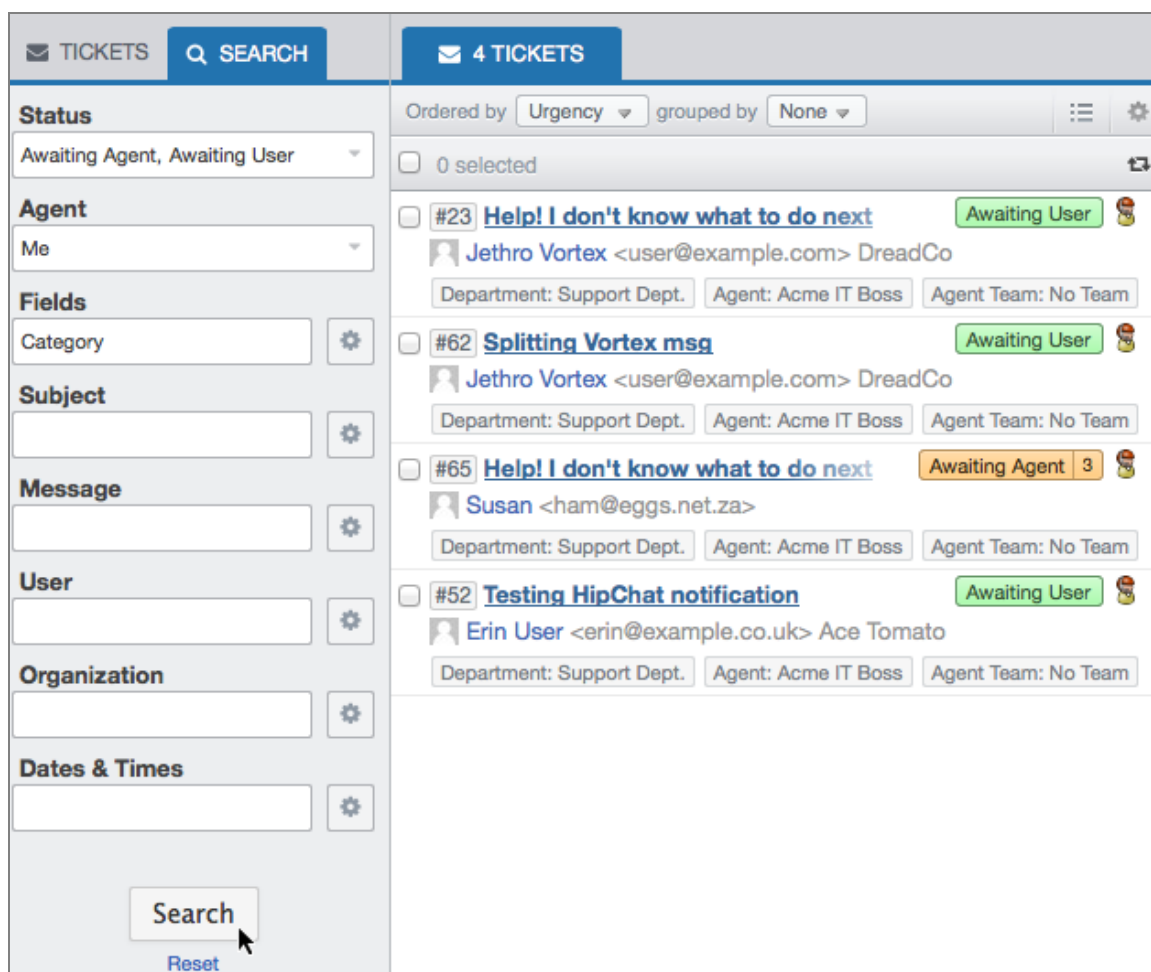
A screenshot of the advanced search filters. It shows two sections: 'Status' with a dropdown menu set to 'Awaiting Agent, Awaiting User' and 'Agent' with a dropdown menu set to 'Me'.

Let's say you want to narrow down the search further by specifying a category.

A screenshot of the advanced search filters. The 'Status' dropdown is set to 'Awaiting Agent, Awaiting User' and the 'Agent' dropdown is set to 'Me'. The 'Fields' section has three input fields with gear icons. The 'Subject' and 'Message' sections also have input fields with gear icons. The 'User' section is partially visible. On the right, there are filters for 'Department', 'Product', and 'Category', each with a dropdown menu set to 'is'. Above these filters, there is a section for 'Ordered by' (set to 'Urgency') and 'grouped by' (set to 'f'). A checkbox labeled '0 selected' is also present.

- 1 Click the **Fields** gear icon

- 2 A gray panel opens showing fields search options. Click to select a category.

- 3 Your selection is shown as a gray box.

- 4 Click outside the gray panel to close it.
- 5 Click **Search** to see your results.



The screenshot displays the DeskPRO interface. On the left, a sidebar contains various filters: Status (Awaiting Agent, Awaiting User), Agent (Me), Fields (Category, Priority, Workflow), Subject, Message, User, Organization, and Dates & Times. At the bottom of the sidebar is a 'Search' button and a 'Reset' link. The main area shows a list of tickets. The top of the main area has a 'TICKETS' tab and a 'SEARCH' button. Below this, there are filters for 'Ordered by' (Urgency) and 'grouped by' (None). The list of tickets includes details such as ticket ID, title, user, department, agent, and team. The 'Search' button is highlighted with a mouse cursor.

Only tickets which match *every* property you have searched on will show up in your search results.

In the example search shown below, the ticket status must be **awaiting agent** *and* the **department** field must match "Support Dept" *and* the **organization** of the user must be DreadCo *and* the user total waiting time must be more than 6 days. (From this view, you can see which properties have been used in the search, but not what values you are searching for).

Status
Awaiting Agent

Agent
[Dropdown]

Fields
Department [Gear]

Subject
[Text Box] [Gear]

Message
[Text Box] [Gear]

User
[Text Box] [Gear]

Organization
Organization [Gear]

Dates & Times
User Total Waiting Time [Gear]

Search
[Reset](#)

Ordered by Urgency grouped by None

0 selected

#9 **Capacity of the Acme Gyrocopter** Awaiting Agent 3
Eric User <rocketfan@example.com> DreadCo
Department: Support Dept. Agent: Acme Support Agent 2
Agent Team: 2nd Level Support All Waiting Time: 3 days

#11 **Technical support urgently needed** On hold Awaiting Agent 3
Simon User <simon@example.com> DreadCo
Department: Support Dept. Agent: Unassigned
Agent Team: No Team All Waiting Time: 3 days

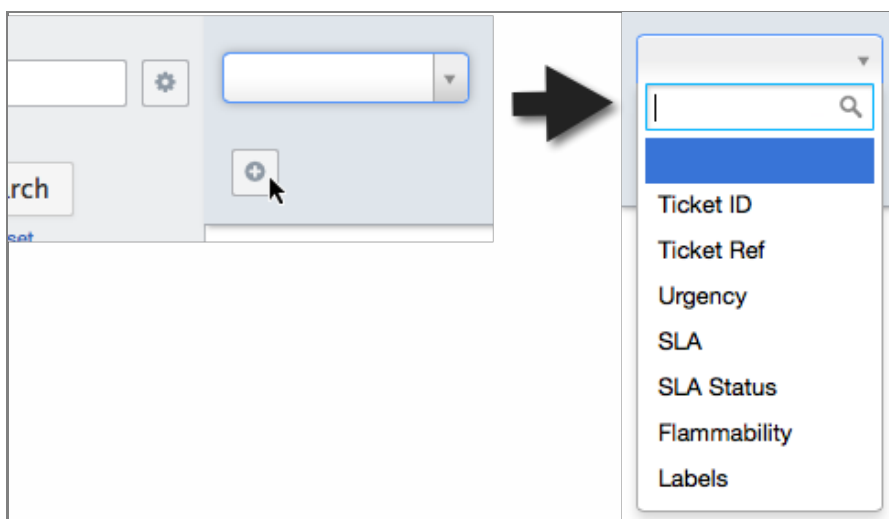
You can click the  icons to view and edit the search terms for a particular ticket property.

Fields

Department [Gear] Department is [Dropdown] x Support Dept.

Subject [Text Box] [Gear] Product is [Dropdown] [Text Box]

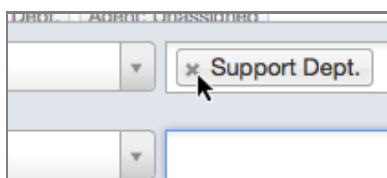
Note that the  icon at the lower left of the gray search options pane lets you access extra search options.



To clear **Status** and **Agent** options, just click the white box and then uncheck them.

Don't forget to clear the defaults for status and agent if they're not what you want.

To clear options denoted by gray boxes, click the **x** at the left.

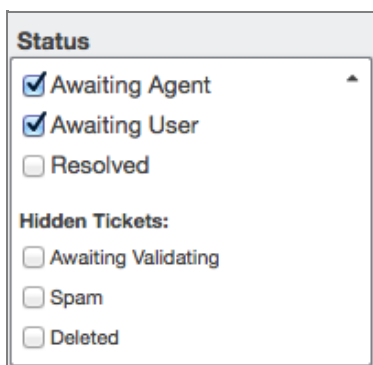


To clear text entry options, delete the entered text.

If you want to completely clear your search and go back to the default setting, click **Reset** under the Search button.

Status

Only the tickets with the checked status types will show up in your search results.



You can search for any combination of:

- Awaiting agent
- Awaiting user
- Resolved
- Awaiting validation
- Spam
- Deleted

You cannot search for tickets with "on hold" status using advanced search.

Agent

You can search for tickets assigned to any agent or team.

A screenshot of the 'Agent' selection dropdown menu. The menu is titled 'Agent' and contains two sections: 'Agents' and 'Teams'. Under 'Agents', there are checkboxes for 'Unassigned', 'Me' (which is checked), 'Acme Admin 1', 'Acme Newbie Agent (Limited)', 'Acme Sales Manager', 'Acme Support Agent 1', 'Acme Support Agent 2', 'Dave', and 'New Agent'. Under 'Teams', there are checkboxes for 'None', '1st Level Support', '2nd Level Support', 'Sales Team', and 'Support Managers'.

If you select **Unassigned** and **Me**, your search will match tickets which are either unassigned or assigned to you.

If you select **Sales Team**, your search will match tickets which are assigned to that team, but not tickets which are assigned to an individual agent who belongs to that team.

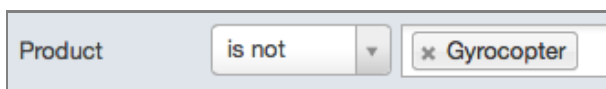
Fields

The fields search allows you to match by department, product, category, priority or workflow (your helpdesk may not have all of these set up).

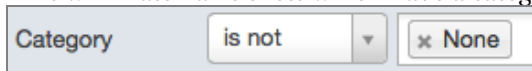
Note that you can also choose **None** to match tickets which have no value entered for a field.

You can choose to apply either **is** or **is not** to the field.

This will match tickets where the product is *not* Gyrocopter (including tickets with no product).

A screenshot of a search field for 'Product'. It contains a dropdown menu with 'is not' selected, and a text input field containing 'x Gyrocopter'.

This will match all tickets which have a category, but not tickets where no category was set.

A screenshot of a search field for 'Category'. It contains a dropdown menu with 'is not' selected, and a text input field containing 'x None'.

The extra options accessible from the  are:

- Ticket ID
- Ticket ref code
- Urgency
- SLA
- SLA status
- Custom fields
- Labels

You can filter the available search options.

Message text

You can enter text into the **Subject** and **Message** boxes. You can press Enter to update your search straight away.



Use the  to construct more advanced searches.

You can choose to search for tickets which either contain or do not contain the text.

You can choose to match/exclude by:

- **All words** - every word you type must be present
- **Any words** - any word you type can be present
- **Phrase** - the words you type must be present in that order

The message search also has options to match messages:

- **By anyone**
- **By an agent**
- **By a user**

and to match messages

- **Written any time**
- **Written before**
- **Written after**
- **Written between**

where the relevant time is selected from a calendar.

Click **Relative time** on the calendar to specify a number of minutes, hours, days, weeks, months or years ago.



For the text search options, the  icon does not let you select extra properties, but instead lets you chain searches together.

User

You can search on the details of the user associated with the ticket:

- Name
- Email
- Usergroup

and from the  icon:

- Custom fields
- Person ID
- Date of profile creation
- Labels
- Contact Phone
- Contact Address
- Contact Instant Messaging

Organization

You can search on the organization associated with the ticket.

From the  icon:

- Date created (date the organization was added to your helpdesk)
- Email Domains
- Labels
- Name
- Contact Phone
- Contact Address
- Contact Instant Messaging

Dates & times

You can search by:

- User Waiting Time (time the user has been waiting since the last agent action)
- User Total Waiting Time (how long the user has spent waiting over the life of the ticket)
- Date Created
- Date Resolved
- Date Closed (that is date the ticket was archived - this only applies to very large helpdesks which have to archive old tickets)
- Date of Last Agent Reply
- Date of Last User Reply

3.15. Mass actions

You may find that you need to apply the same action to a number of tickets at once.

Instead of clicking through each ticket one by one, you can carry out **mass actions**.

You can use mass actions from the list pane, by selecting tickets from the list using the checkboxes on the left.

■

The total number of tickets you have selected is displayed at the upper left of the list pane. You can click the checkbox at the upper left to select all the tickets on the page.

When you select a ticket, the **Apply actions to selections** window appears.

■

You can:

- set all tickets to a certain status
- assign them to an agent or team
- change their department
- set a built-in field
- set them to a certain language
- write a mass reply which is sent to the users of all the tickets

Note that if you have set a signature it will be prefilled in the **Mass Reply** box, but DeskPRO will not send a message unless you enter some other text.

More actions, including setting custom fields and adding labels, are available from **Add action** under **Other Properties**.

The full list of actions is:

- Set agent
- Add agent followers
- CC users
- Set agent team
- Set status
- Ticket hold status (add or remove from [hold](#))
- Delete ticket
- Set department
- Set language
- Set product
- Add/remove labels
- Add organization managers to the ticket
- Set flag
- Increase/decrease urgency (by an amount you specify)
- Set urgency (you can choose **Only set when urgency is lower**, e.g. if you selected this option and applied 'set urgency 7' to a ticket with urgency 8, the urgency would remain 8)
- Set subject
- Set custom ticket or user fields
- Close the ticket tab

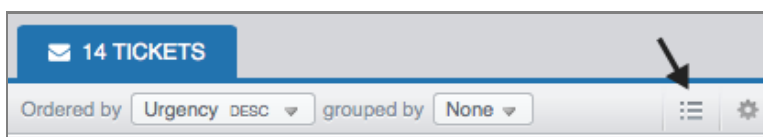
You must have the correct permissions to apply the actions. Note that your permissions may limit you from replying using a mass action, even if you would have permission to reply to the tickets individually.

If you are writing a mass reply, you could customize the message to each user by using [snippets](#).

For maximum productivity, you can apply a macro as a mass action.

Table view mass actions and CSV export

You can also carry out mass actions using the **table view**, which is accessible from the upper right of the list pane.



Select the tickets you want to act on using the checkboxes at the left, then press the **Perform Actions** button at the bottom left of the table view window.

-
-

The table view also offers an **export to CSV** button at the bottom right. Click this to download details of all the tickets in the table as a file in CSV (*Comma Separated Values*) format. CSV is compatible with most spreadsheet programs (such as Excel) and databases.

Note that the CSV export always includes all columns for all the tickets in the table; the table view options or checkboxes you have selected do not affect it.

3.16. User satisfaction

Users can rate your support for each ticket using a simple satisfaction survey (if your admins have enabled it).

-

You may be able to see satisfaction ratings and comments that users have left on your tickets.

-

3.17. Time log & billing

Your helpdesk may enable you to bill users amounts of money based on the support you provide, or record how long it takes to resolve a ticket, or both.

Depending on which of these features is enabled, you will see a **Billing**, **Time Log** or **Billing & Time Log** tab when you have a ticket open in the content pane.

You can view previous charges for an organization from its profile in **CRM**, as well as from the **Billing** section of the reports interface if you have access to it.

Billing

To use billing:

- 1 Make sure the **Amount** button is selected.
- 2 Enter the charge in the specified currency.
- 3 Enter a comment in the **Comment** field (optional).

The billing currency is set by your admins.

Time log

To use the time log:

- 1 Make sure the **Time** button is selected.
- 2 Click the **Start** button at right.
- 3 The timer starts counting. This can be used to time how long it takes you to do work related to the ticket e.g. a chargeable support call. Click **Pause** to stop the timer (if you stop doing chargeable work), and **Start** to restart it.
- 4 When you are ready to bill for the amount of elapsed time, enter a comment (optional) and click **Add Charge**.

Your helpdesk may have been configured so that the timer starts automatically when you open a ticket. You still need to click **Add Charge** to record the elapsed time.

If you have the correct permission, you may be able to directly enter an amount of time, instead of running the timer.

Editing time logs and charges

If you have the correct permission, you may be able to edit previous logs and charges.

A single permission grants you the ability to edit former logs/charges and manually enter amounts of time.

4. Chat

The **Chat** app enables you to communicate with users via real-time text chat. Depending on your helpdesk configuration, users may be able to initiate a chat from the web portal or your website, or from both.

The **chat button** in the status bar gives you an overview of the state of the chat system. It shows the number of agents who are logged in to chat, and the number of users who are browsing your pages on your site or portal where chat is available.

▪

Click the button to see details of the agents who are logged in to chat, and the users who are browsing your portal or website.

▪

If you are not available to chat, you can log out of the chat system while remaining signed in to DeskPRO. Click the **Sign out of chat** button to do so.

Note that there is a separate instant messaging system for use between agents. Logging out of user chat does not log you out of agent IM. See the section on [Agent IM](#) for details.

If you are logged in to chat, the button is green.

▪

If you are not logged in, but other agents are, the button turns brown.

▪

If no agents are logged in, the button turns red.

▪

If no agents are logged in, users who try to chat are offered the option to email the helpdesk instead.

You can get a more detailed view of current and past chats from the Chat app filter pane:

▪

4.1. Accepting chats

When a user initiates a chat and you're logged in to chat, you will see a **NEW CHAT** pop-up window at the top left of the user interface. You will also hear an [audio notification](#) if you have them enabled.

▪

You can choose to **Dismiss** the chat and leave it for other agents, or you can **Accept** to begin chatting.

You can also accept a chat by going to the **Open Chats** section of the filter pane, find the chat you want and click it in the list pane to open it. Note that this will accept even if you are not logged in to chat.

While waiting for an agent to accept the chat, the user sees a **Finding an agent** message.

▪

Depending on your DeskPRO configuration, user login may not be required before using chat. This means that somebody starting a chat could enter the email address of a registered user, without needing to log in and prove that the address is theirs.

When this happens, you will see the following warning:

▪

You should avoid discussing sensitive data in case the user is an impostor, at least until you can verify that they are really the user by other means.

Setting chat notification volume

To change the level of chat sound notifications, expand the toolbar chat button and then click **Chat notification volume**.

▪

To mute chat sounds altogether, simply move the slider all the way to the bottom.

4.2. Chatting with users

Chatting works much like popular chat clients such as Google Talk, Facebook Messenger, AIM etc. You see each message the user types in a blue speech bubble.

Use the reply box at the bottom of the window to send your response. You can use the  button or just press **Enter/Return** on your keyboard.

Your replies are shown in gray bubbles.

When a user has read your message, it is marked with a green icon: .

You can mouse over the icon to see when they read your message.

You can see what pages the user is viewing on your web portal or website in lines with a gray background. This gives you context for their issue or question: you can check which product they're looking at, that they are in the right place while following troubleshooting instructions etc.

You can format your reply in a similar manner to a ticket message. See the [reply formatting](#) section for more details. You can attach files to chat messages just as you can with a ticket reply, except that drag and drop only works with images. Users can also send you files.

Between the formatting bar and the **Send** button are two buttons specific to Chat.

The  button creates a ticket linked to the current chat. This is useful if you can't resolve the user's issue during the chat and need to track it in the ticket system.

Note that if the user did not enter a valid email address when you started the chat, you must enter one when you create a linked ticket.

The  button ends the chat.

Chat details

At the top of the tab you can see:

- the chat's ID number
- the **department** selected by the user, which you can change
- the label field - you can label a chat as with a ticket or user

Chat visitor information

During the chat you can switch to the **Visitor Information** tab to get details about the user:

- **IP Address**
- **User Agent** (this describes what web browser they're using)
- **Session Start Time** (the time they arrived at your web portal or site in their current browsing session)
- **Session Landing Page** (the first page they arrived at this session)
- **Initial Visit Time & Initial Landing Page** (the time and page they arrived at when they first visited your portal/site, as recorded by browser cookies)

Block user

If a chat user is abusive, trying to waste your time, or should be excluded from chat for some other reason, you can switch to the **Block User** tab and block them for the next 24 hours.

Enter a brief description of why you chose to block the user, then click **Block User**.

■

You can optionally select **Block IP address**. This prevents all chat attempts from that user's last IP address. Note that if the user was chatting from a shared network (such as a business, university or wi-fi hotspot), blocking their IP may prevent all users on that network from chatting. Also, users accessing the internet from home or mobile broadband tend not to have fixed IP addresses.

4.3. Assigning chats

Chats are assigned to agents, just like tickets. A chat is automatically assigned to you when you accept it.

You can see the assigned agent for a chat in the **Assignments** section at the upper right.

You may decide that another agent would be in a better position to deal with a chat that's assigned to you.

To assign a chat to another agent:

- 1 Click the  at the top right of the **Assignments** section.
- 2 The **Assignments** window opens. In the **Assign to** pane, select an agent.
 - You can click on **Filter** at the top right of the pane and type to filter the list of agents.
 -
- 3 Click **Apply**.

The chat opens in the content pane of the newly assigned agent's interface.

You can also make the chat **Unassigned**.

Note that if you make a chat unassigned, other agents are not notified, so you should be careful not to leave the user waiting.

You can also invite other agents to join a chat using the **Invite Others** pane. This is useful if you want to stay in control of the chat, but you want to get another agent's input.

- 1 Click the  icon at the top right of the **Assignments** section.
- 2 The **Assignments** window opens. In the **Invite Others** pane, select the agent to invite.
- 3 Click **Apply**.

Again, the chat opens in the invited agent's interface.

If you close the tab of a chat that's assigned to you, you see the **Leave Chat?** warning pop-up - you can choose to either unassign yourself from the chat, or end it.

 -

4.4. Viewing closed and missed chats

You can view chats from the Chat app filter pane.

■

There are sections for open (active) chats, ended chats, and filtering chats by label.

Open chats filter

The **Open Chats** section shows current active chats:

- **New Chats** - chats that have not yet been assigned.
- **My Open Chats** - open chats assigned to you.
- **All Open Chats** - all chats, sub-filtered by agent.

Note that even if you signed out of chat, you can click on open chats to accept them.

Ended chats filter

The **Ended Chat** section shows:

- **My Chats** - ended chats that were assigned to you
- **Assigned Chats** - ended chats that were assigned to an agent
- **Missed Chats** - chats where the user left before an agent was assigned

When you view ended chats in the content pane, there is a **Create ticket** button in the **Person** section of the chat record. This creates a ticket linked to the chat.

■

You can use this to quickly open a ticket linked to a missed chat and maintain communication with the user.

4.5. Custom chat fields

Your admins can set up custom chat fields to record extra information about chats. These work like [custom ticket fields](#).

Users may be able to enter values for custom fields when they initiate the chat.

▪

In this example, **Nature of query** is a custom field.

If your helpdesk has any custom chat fields, chats you view in the content pane have a **Fields** tab. Select it to view the custom fields.

▪

Click the  at upper right to edit the custom fields.

▪

5. CRM

The CRM (*Customer Relationship Management*) app is where you view and manage your helpdesk's **users**.

■

DeskPRO can also record details of user **organizations**: this is typically the company the user works for.

You can also manage what each user is allowed to do on your helpdesk by adding them to **usergroups**. Belonging to a usergroup grants the user a set of **permissions**.

The usergroups available and what permissions they grant are defined by your admins. For example, if your company policy was to limit the chat system to paying users only, your admins could implement this by setting up a "paying users" usergroup, and disabling chat for users who do not belong to it.

You can store extra information about users, such as contact details or notes. You can also use the CRM app to view details of your agents and teams.

5.1. Filtering and sorting users and organizations

You can use the filter pane on the left of the CRM app to filter users and organizations.

Filtering users

The **People** section at the top of the filter pane lets you filter by **usergroup**. The result of your selection is shown in the list pane.

■

The number of users in each usergroup is displayed on the right of the filter pane.

You can also filter users with **labels**.

■

Click on a label to open the users matching that label in the list pane.

The **Cloud** view shows labels in bigger text the more tickets they have. You can also select a **List** view by clicking on the List tab.

Filtering agents

You can filter agents by **team** at the bottom of the filter pane.

■

Click on a team to see its agents in the list pane.

Filtering people alphabetically

When the list pane is showing a list of people, you can further filter it alphabetically, as in an address book, using the alphabet strip to the left of the list pane.

Click a letter to show people who have a surname beginning with that letter, and who match the filter selected in the filter pane.

■

In this example, the G has been selected, so only users with surnames beginning with G are being shown.

To clear your letter selection, click the dot at the top of the strip.

Ordering people

When you're viewing a list of people (agents or users) in the list pane, you can change how they're ordered with the **Ordered by** pull-down.

■

You can choose to order them by:

- **Name** (first name, alphabetically)
- **Date created** (oldest account at top)
- **Last login time** (most recent at top)
- **Organization** (users with no organization at the top, then alphabetically)
- **Number of tickets** (users with most tickets at the top)

Viewing a table of people

You can view the contents of a list of people as a table using the  icon at the upper right of the list pane.

■

You can choose how the list is ordered and which fields to display using the controls at the top right.

■

5.2. User records

Click a user in the list pane to open their details in the content pane.

Users have a unique **ID** number, just like tickets do.

In most parts of the agent interface, you can open a user record by clicking on the user's name.

If you do this from the content pane, the user record is displayed as a pop-up window to the left. To open it in the content pane, click the green arrow at the top left of the record.

Setting user organization

Click the  icon at the top right of the **Organization** section to select the user's organization.

You can type into the text field at the top of the list to filter the list.

You can also **Create a new organization**.

See the [Organizations](#) section for more details.

Setting usergroups

Click the  at the top right of the **Usergroups** section to set usergroup memberships.

Select the checkboxes for the usergroups the user should be in.

Click **Save** when you are done.

See the [Usergroups](#) section for more details.

User summary and files

The **Summary** field is a text field that you can use to record general information about the user, any special requirements they have, and so on.

Simply click on it and enter or edit text, then click **Save**.

If you need to store more information about the user, you can save files to their profile. You can use this to store invoices, useful documentation, software configuration files - anything that you or other agents might need to help the user in future.

User contact information

The **Contact Information** section shows the contact details available for the user.

If you mouse over the user's email address, a yellow clipboard icon appears. Click on the icon to copy the address to your clipboard.

Mouse over the user's mailing address to see a map.

Click the  icon at the upper right to edit the user's contact information.

User contact information can include:

- **Email address** (every user must have at least one email address)
- **Phone number**
- **Website**
- **IM** (instant messaging) account name
- **Twitter** username (no need to include the @ symbol)
- **Linkedin** account (enter the full profile web address e.g. `http://www.linkedin.com/in/sueuser7/5/43`)
- **Facebook** profile (enter the full profile web address e.g. `http://www.facebook.com/sue.advuse`)
- **Address** (mailing address)

Users with multiple email addresses

You can enter more than one email address for a user.

However, DeskPRO will only send ticket notifications to the **primary email address**.

When the user has more than one email address, the primary one is marked with a yellow tag:

▪
In this example, `propellerhead@example.com` is the primary address.

To set the primary address, mouse over another email address until a green **make primary** tag appears:

▪
Click the green tag to make that address the primary one.

If the same person sends emails from two different addresses, DeskPRO might set up two separate user accounts for that person. You can fix this by [merging users](#).

Changing user email address for a ticket

If the user has more than one email address, you can change the address where they receive notifications for a particular ticket.

You can do this from a ticket in the content pane: use the pull-down control on the right of the user box.

▪
This control is only present if the user has more than one email address.

User properties

The **Properties** section records information about user timezone and language.

This is also where you can view and edit any **custom user fields** your admins have set up.

▪
The **Local Time** for the user is displayed here, based on their timezone.

If no language is shown, the user is receiving content in the default user language of your helpdesk.

To change properties, click the  icon at the top right of the Properties area.

▪
Click **Save** when you have finished editing the fields, or **Cancel** if you don't want to save your changes.

Note that custom fields with no value set for the user will not be displayed until you click the gear (in this example, **Limbs** is such a field).

Set the user's local timezone with the **Timezone** control. This affects times shown on email notifications etc.

If multiple languages are enabled on your helpdesk, you can set the user's preferred language with the **Language** control. This will change the language of their email notifications and the text they see when they're logged in to the web portal. (If you don't see the language you want, your admins may need to install a language pack).

User history and notes

Below the user Properties section, you can see the user's tickets, chats and billing history.

▪
If there is a long ticket history, it can be useful to use the **Sort Tickets By** control at the upper left.

▪
You can add notes at the bottom left of the user record.

▪
This is separate from the [ticket notes](#) system, and does not support **@mentions**.

Unlike the summary, you can enter more than one note about the user.

Click on the **Activity Stream** tab to see a more detailed activity history.

▪
Click on the **Detail** tab to see technical details about the account and the user's login activity.

▪

Dealing with 'out-of-office' auto-replies from users

The **Auto-responder?** option is used to avoid email loops. If the user's email account sends an automatic response, such as a vacation message, DeskPRO may reply with its own automatic response, triggering a further response from the user account, and so on.

If this starts happening, go to the user's **Detail** tab, click on the blue **User is not an auto-responder** text and select the option to disable DeskPRO's auto-replies.

▪

Agent records

At the bottom of the CRM filter pane is a section for your agents.

▪

You can filter agents by team. You can view individual records for agents, just as you can for users. You can see an agent's activity stream and view and edit a summary, additional contact information and notes, just like you can with a user.

▪

This can be a useful way to keep track of the other agents on your helpdesk, especially if you have agents who work at different physical locations.

5.3. Usergroups

You may want some users to have a different level of access to the helpdesk than others.

For example, your company may want to restrict chat access to users who pay for a premium support package, or accept feedback only from experienced users of your products.

DeskPRO supports this by giving each user **permission** levels: these determine what areas of the web portal the user can see, and what helpdesk functions they can use.

You control a user's permissions by assigning them to **usergroups**. Each usergroup grants the user a set of permissions.

Your admins decide what usergroups your helpdesk has and what permissions they grant.

Here are some example usergroups a helpdesk might have:

- **Registered** - all users who are [registered](#) with the helpdesk
- **Power Users** - advanced users who know your product well
- **Trial Users** - users who are evaluating your product with a free trial
- **VIPs** - users who pay extra for priority support

Some example permissions:

- **Power Users** can submit comments without agent approval in the web portal
- **Trial Users** can access chat with the sales department
- **VIPs** can access chat with the support department

Note that each user can belong to multiple usergroups, and is granted the combined permissions of them all.

In the example above, if User A is a member of **Power Users** and **VIPs**, they can submit comments without agent approval *and* access chat with the support department.

Setting usergroups

Open a user in the content pane and look at the **Usergroups** section (lower right) to see their usergroups.

▪

Click the  icon to see all usergroups.

▪

Use the checkboxes to select the user's usergroups. Click **Save** to keep your choices, or **Cancel** to close the section without saving your changes.

You can also see usergroups in the filter pane of the CRM app.

▪

Note that usergroups with no members will not be shown in the filter pane.

Guest and registered users

By default, even guest users - those who haven't been registered in the system, for example by signing up for an account through the web portal - have some permissions. For example, most helpdesks allow anyone browsing the web portal to view news items and Knowledgebase articles without logging in.

Guest permissions are set by admins using a usergroup called **Everyone**.

Most DeskPRO helpdesks have a **Registered** usergroup which grants permissions to all registered users (the requirements to be registered vary depending on the helpdesk setup, from simply emailing a ticket address to registering and being approved by an agent).

5.4. Organizations

Organizations are used to record the company (or other enterprise) to which each user belongs.

In most cases, that will be the user's employer, but it might be the charity they volunteer for, or the reseller they bought your product from, if that is what is relevant to your helpdesk.

Each user can only belong to a single organization.

To view all the organizations set up in your helpdesk, select the **Organizations** filter.

Organization details

Open an organization in the content pane to view its details.

You can edit the organization's name by double-clicking it.

You can see the history of all tickets from the organization, and store a summary, files and notes just as for a user.

Organization members

The **Members** section shows you all the users who belong to the organization. Click a user's name to view their details in a pop-up window.

You can record the **position** (job role) of each user in an organization.

If a user doesn't have a position yet, click on the **No position set** text to add one:

You can click on a user's position to edit it.

Use the small flags on the right to set which users are **organization managers** who can see all tickets from their organization. See the [Organization managers](#) section for more details.

The **Tickets** and **Chats** tabs let you view all the tickets or chats associated with any member of the organization.

To remove a user from an organization, click on the red icon at right. This does not delete the user.

Organization properties

The **Properties** section is where you view and edit any custom organization fields your admins have set up.

For example, you could have a **Profit status** field to track if the organization is for profit or non-profit.

Click the  at the top right of the Properties section to edit the fields.

Click **Save** when you have finished editing the fields, or **Cancel** to leave them as they were.

Note that custom fields with no value set for the organization will not be displayed until you click the gear icon.

The Properties section also displays the date when the organization was created.

Automatically associating users with organizations by email domain

The **Email domain associations** section allows you to automatically associate users with the organization, based on their email address.

For example, suppose you want to have all new users with an `@acetomato.zy` address automatically added to the "Ace Tomato" organization.

Click the  at the top right of the section.

The **Email Domain Associations** pop-up window opens.

Enter the domain e.g. `acetomato.zy`.

Click **Add** to associate it with the organization.

You can now add another domain. For example, you may want to associate the `.com` and `.co.uk` domains for an international organization.

When you are finished adding domains, close the window with the **X** at top right.

Note that email domain associations only apply to users who register after you have set up the association.

However, if there are existing users whose addresses match the domain, DeskPRO will prompt you to associate them with the organization.

In this example, clicking **Associate 10 users** would associate all existing users who do not belong to an organization with example.com.

Linking organizations to usergroups

You can add all the members of an organization to a usergroup using the **Usergroups** section at the lower right of the organization record.

Click the  to set which usergroups are linked with the organization.

Linking an organization to a usergroup in this way is convenient when the permissions users should have changes an organization-wide basis.

For example, suppose the **VIPs** usergroup is for users who are entitled to VIP-level support, and the Ace Tomato Company decides to pay for VIP support for all its employees. You *could* find all users who belong to the "Ace Tomato" organization and change their usergroup, but it's better to link the usergroup to the organization:

- 1 | it's quicker
- 2 | any future Ace Tomato users will automatically join the VIPs usergroup

If you try to remove a user from a usergroup that is linked to their organization, it won't work.

Note that DeskPRO remembers the difference between users who were added to a usergroup individually, and users who were added through a link to their organization. For example:

- 1 | To start with, User A is the only member of **VIPs** from the DreadCo organization.
- 2 | DreadCo is then linked to the **VIPs** usergroup. *Every* DreadCo user is now a member of **VIPs**.
- 3 | The link between DreadCo and **VIPs** is removed.

User A would not be removed from **VIPs**.

Organization managers

The **organization managers** feature allows specific users to oversee all the tickets for their organization.

Normally, a user can only see tickets that they've created or interacted with.

However, an organization manager can see any ticket associated with their organization, and can even automatically be added as a participant to any new tickets.

You can see and edit manager status on the user's record in the organization section, as well as from the organization's record.

-

An organization manager can view all of their organization's tickets via the web portal.

-

A manager can choose to automatically join any tickets for their organization when they're created. They can set this option on the **Edit your profile** page.

-

5.5. New users

Your helpdesk may be configured so that a user account is created automatically when the user submits a ticket via email or the web (an **open helpdesk**).

However, users may be required to **register** before submitting content.

Your admins may enable **validation** of new users when they register.

There are two separate forms of validation:

- 1 **Email validation:** users required to prove that their email address is valid by clicking on a link in an email
- 2 **Agent validation:** new users need to be manually approved by an agent.

If there are users who need to be validated, you will see them in a **Pending** section at the top of the CRM app filter pane.

The user's tickets will be held in the **Awaiting Validation** filter in the Tickets app until the user is validated.

TICKETS	LABELS	FLAGGED
Awaiting Agent		11
Awaiting User		24
Resolved		6
Awaiting Validation		1
Spam		0
Recycle Bin		~5

To approve a user who needs **agent validation**, simply find them in the list pane or content pane and click the **Approve** button.

Creating a user

You can also create a user account from scratch with the **Create** button.

Select the **New Person** option.

The New Person window opens.

You must enter an email address for the user in the **Email** field.

Name and **Organization** are optional.

If your helpdesk uses **custom user fields**, they may be required or optional.

Users may also be able to log in with their Facebook, Twitter or Google accounts.

User rules

DeskPRO can automatically associate users with organizations based on their email address.

For example, your helpdesk could add all users with a `@dreadco.zy` address to the DreadCo organization.

See the section on [email domain associations](#) for how you can set this up.

Your admins can also set up rules which automatically add new users to usergroups.

These user rules only apply to new users created after the rule was set up.

You can use [linking an organization to a usergroup](#) to associate all of an organization's new and existing users with a usergroup.

5.6. User actions

When you open a user record in the content pane, you can carry out the following actions.

▪

Create ticket

This opens a pop-up window where you can create a ticket assigned to the user.

Merging users

If you have duplicate user records for the same person, you can combine them into one record using the **merge** action.

When users merge, some properties will be overwritten. For example, a user can only have one organization, so the merged user can keep the organization from only one of the originals.

You can pick which user will overwrite the other user's properties.

The labels from both users will be applied to the new user.

- 1 Click **Merge**.
 -
- 2 Any users whose records are currently open are offered as targets for the merge. Click the user you want. If the user you want is not shown, click **Find Person**. The **Merge People** window opens.
 - Type part of the user's name or email address to filter user records, then click the user you want.
- 3 Click **Switch** to pick which user's properties to keep where there's a conflict. The values shown in red will be overwritten.
 -
- 4 Click **Merge these two profiles** to complete the process.

Login as user

Click the **Login As User** button to access the user's web portal account.

This can be useful when troubleshooting; you can see exactly what the user does when they view their tickets and chats on the web portal.

Disable account

Use the **Disable Account** option from the **More** pull-down menu to temporarily disable the user's account.

When the account is disabled the user's profile image is marked with an X.

▪

The user will not be able to log in or create tickets.

They will still show up in searches and filters. You can still set them as the user for existing tickets.

Select **Enable Account** from the **More** pull-down to restore the account to normal.

Reset password

Use the **Reset password** option from the **More** pull-down menu to change the user's password.

▪

The password you enter will replace the user's old password. The new password will be emailed to the user, so it is important that you have the right email address for them.

Deleting users

Use the **Delete User** option from the **More** pull-down menu to permanently delete the user's account.

Deleting a user will also delete all their tickets.

The **Delete User & Ban Email** option does the same thing, but also prevents the user registering again with the same email address.

5.7. Searching for users and organizations

You can search for users and organizations from the Quick Search bar at the top right of the agent interface.

Quick search will match what you enter to the name, ID number or label of a user or organization. It will show you users whose email addresses match your search, and organizations where any user's email address matches.

■

Advanced search for users and organizations

You can access advanced search for users or organizations from the filter pane when the **CRM** app is selected.

■

Use the **Type** field to select if you want to search for **People** (users) or **Organizations**.

Note that if you enter values for more than one of these properties, the results will include only users/organizations which match all your requirements.

6. Publish

The **Publish** app is used to manage the help content on your web portal.

There are four different types of content you can manage through Publish:

- **Knowledgebase articles** - rich-text articles that can include images or attachments; they typically address a common user problem or explain how to do something.
- **News posts** - designed for announcements about product updates, new products, company updates, etc.
- **Downloads** - files you want to make available to your users; for example, manuals, brochures or software drivers.
- **Glossary words** - definitions of terms you use in **articles** to help users understand them.

Feedback also appears on the web portal, but is managed in its own [Feedback](#) app, rather than in Publish.

Portal content items (articles, news posts or downloads) can have the following **statuses**:

- **Published** - item is visible to users on the web portal
- **Unpublished** - item not visible to users
- **Draft** - item not visible to users, appears in the **Pending** section of the agent interface
- **Archived** - status only available once an article has been **published**; removes item from visibility on web portal; use this for outdated content

You can see an overview of your portal content using the filter pane.

Content is organised into [categories](#). In this example, you can see that posts in the News section are divided into categories called **New products**, **Sales** and **General**.

At the top of the filter pane is the **Pending** section which shows:

- **pending articles** that need to be written
- any content (articles, news posts, downloads) saved with **Draft** status

You can expand and collapse the different sections to show only the items that are relevant to you.

Click the ▢ icon to collapse a section.

Click the ▢ icon to expand a collapsed section again.

6.1. Organizing portal content into categories

You can help your users find what they're looking for by organizing your articles, posts and files using categories.

Items in the same category are displayed together on the web portal. In this example, **Advanced Usage**, **Choosing a Product**, **Vehicles**, **General** and **Getting Started** are all categories.

You can limit access to each category by **usergroup** - for example, you could set it so that only users in the **Experienced** usergroup could see articles in the **Advanced Usage** category.

You can create one category inside another, giving you a **nested** category structure. This is useful to subdivide large categories.

In this example, the **Vehicles** category has four sub-categories inside it.

Nested categories are also used to help users navigate the portal.

You can have as many layers of nested categories as you want.

In the filter pane, there are two numbers next to a category: the first shows the number of items in the top level of the category, and the second the total number inside it, including in subcategories.

In the example above, there is one article in the Vehicles category, and ten more articles in subcategories below Vehicles.

The category structures for **Knowledgebase**, **News** and **Downloads** are all separate.

Adding a new category

You can create new categories from the filter pane of the **Publish** app. Use the **Add new category** link at the bottom of the relevant section.

- 1 Click the **Add new category** link.
- 2 The **Add Category** window opens.
 - Enter a **Title** for the category to identify it to agents and users
 - If you want the category to be nested, select the **Parent Category** that it should be inside
 - Use the **Permissions** checkboxes to select which usergroups can see the category.
- 3 Click **Save**.

If the **Everyone** usergroup is selected, anyone can see articles in the category without logging in. When **Everyone** is selected, it overrides all the options below - deselecting other usergroups has no effect, because all users have permission to view the category through their membership of **Everyone**.

If the **Registered** usergroup is selected, all users who are registered on the helpdesk and logged in can see the category. Again, when **Registered** is selected, deselecting the usergroups below has no effect.

Editing, deleting and reordering categories

To edit an existing category, click on it in the filter pane.

The items in the category are displayed in the list pane. Click on the name of the category at the top.

-
-

You can use the **Delete Category** button to remove the category altogether. You must remove all items from the category (either deleting them or putting them in different categories); otherwise deleting will not work.

In the **Edit Category** section, you can edit the category **title** or change which usergroups have **permissions** to view the category.

You can use the **Reorder Category** section to change the display order of categories.

For example, suppose you decide it would make more sense to have the "Getting Started" category appear before "Advanced Usage".

- 1 Click on the category, and drag it with the mouse button held down.
 -
- 2 Drag the category to where you want it to go.
 - A horizontal blue line means you are going to put it *between* categories
 - A blue box means that you are going to put it *inside* another category.
 -
- 3 Let go of the mouse button when the category is where you want it.
 -

You can expand nested categories by clicking on the triangle icons. They also expand automatically when you drag something over them.

-

Adding items to categories

When you open a **Knowledgebase** article, **News** post or **Downloads** file in the content pane, you can change its category using these controls:

-

Note that a Knowledgebase article can belong to more than one category, but News posts and Downloads files can't.

6.2. Creating a Knowledgebase article

To create an article from scratch:

- 1 Select the **New Article** option from the **Create** button in the toolbar.
 - 2 The **New Article** window opens.
 -
 - 3 Select a **Category** that the article will appear in. You can add extra categories later.
 - 4 Choose the **Status** the article should have when you save it.
 - **Published** - article visible to users on the web portal, appears in the **Knowledgebase** section of the filter pane
 - **Unpublished** - article not visible to users, still appears in the **Knowledgebase** section of the filter pane
 - **Draft** - article not visible to users, appears in the **Pending** section (under **My Drafts** for articles you create)
-
- 1 Enter a **Title**, and then write the article in the rich text editor. The editing controls are an expanded version of the controls found in the **Tickets** message editor. See the section [Knowledgebase article editing controls](#) for more details.
 - 2 Click **Properties** to add a label to the article.
 - 3 Click **Attachments** to attach a file to the article.
 - 4 Click **Create Article** to save the article with your chosen status.

Note that if you want to insert a link to an existing article from the text of your new article, you can insert a quick-link from the list pane, in the same way you can when writing a ticket reply. See [Quick-linking to Knowledgebase articles and downloads](#) for details.

Saving a new article as **draft** is useful if you don't want to publish it straight away; for example, if you haven't finished it yet, or you want to get someone else to check it over before you publish it. Because draft articles appear in the **Pending** section, saving them with draft status makes it more obvious to other agents that there is an article in progress.

When you have finished creating your article, you should consider helping users find it by linking it to related articles, setting search terms, or adding labels. See [Helping users find portal content](#) for details.

Pending articles

Pending articles are a way to keep track of which articles need to be written.

Select the **Pending Articles** filter (at the top of the **Pending** section) to view all pending articles.

▪

From this view, you can use the **Add** button at the top left of the list pane to create a new pending article.

▪

Enter a brief description of the article and click **Add**.

Often an article that needs to be written will be about an issue that has come up in a ticket. You can make a pending article based on a ticket using the **Create a new pending article** action available from the ticket **Actions** menu.

A pending article created this way is linked to the ticket.

When you click **Create Article**, the new article takes the title of the original ticket, and the first message from the ticket is inserted into the article, formatted as a question.

Of course, you can edit the content from the ticket as you write the article.

If you want to refer to more details of the original ticket, click the link to it at the top of the new article window to open it in the content pane. The **Create Article** window opens in a pop-out to the left of the content pane, so you can see both the article and the ticket at the same time.

Adding attachments and images to a Knowledgebase article

Note that when editing an article, you can't use drag and drop to add attachments or images as you can with a ticket message.

You can attach a file to the article using the **Attachments** section at the bottom.

- 1 Click **Choose Files** and select the attachment(s) you want. You can upload multiple files at once by holding down **Ctrl/Cmd**.
- 2 Click **Upload**.

You can insert an image into the text of an article, use the  button.

Do not use  to attach non-image files. It may look like it has created a link, but the link won't work for users.

You can use the  button to embed an image from the internet into your article.

Be wary about embedding images from servers your company doesn't control. The content of the image displayed in your article could change without warning.

Knowledgebase article editing controls

Icons	Function
	make text bold, italic or underlined
	make text left-aligned (default), centred or right-aligned
	set the text color, set a background color (giving a highlighter effect)
	apply styles
	select custom font settings

Icons	Function
▪	make bulletpoint lists or ordered lists
▪	indent paragraphs or decrease indent
▪	add or remove links; add an anchor; insert an image; hotlink or edit images
▪	add a horizontal rule; add a table
▪	table editing options
▪	toggle table guidelines; view raw HTML; remove formatting; toggle full screen editor

6.3. News posts

News posts are intended for communicating information which is time-sensitive, like a new product announcement or details of a holiday sale.

In contrast, Knowledgebase articles are for content which will be useful for a long period of time, like a product troubleshooting guide. If the information in an article is likely to be stale within a week or two, it may be better as a news post.

News posts are shown on the web portal in reverse chronological order, like blog posts.

■

You can make a news post using the **Create** button in the toolbar.

News posts contain rich text content. The process of editing and publishing them is the same as for creating Knowledgebase articles.

Remember that your news post is only visible once you save it as **Published**.

News posts can only belong to one category (but news categories can still be nested).

6.4. Downloads

A **download** is a file you want to make available to your users. It might be a PDF manual or brochure, a software application or driver.

Each download consists of a single file, plus a rich-text description which you can create and edit as you would a Knowledgebase article.

If you use DeskPRO Cloud, the file size limit is 10MB. On DeskPRO Download, the limit depends on your server configuration.

You can make a new download using the **Create** button in the toolbar.

■

To select the file, you can either:

- click **Choose Files** and upload a file from your computer
- click the **Hotlink an existing file** link and enter a URL (web address) for the file
 - you must enter the full URL e.g. `http://www.example.com/files/manual.pdf`
 - you can optionally specify the file size to display

Once you've selected a file, you can use the **File Name** field to change the filename. You can use this to pick a name that is more meaningful to users. For example, you might have saved your download file as `Gyr Manual-updated FINAL davehasapproved.pdf`, but a better user-facing filename would be `ACME_Gyrocopter_Manual-v2.pdf`.

Click **Create Download** to save your download. It will only be viewable by users if you set the status to **Published** first.

6.5. Comments on portal content

Users with the right permissions can add comments on portal content.

You can select user comments from the **Comments** section of the filter pane.

▪

Comments may need to be approved before they can become visible.

Select comments in the filter pane to view them in the list pane.

▪

You can approve, delete and edit comments from this view. You can also create a linked **ticket** in case the user's issue needs addressing.

You can also view comments on an item when it is open in the list pane, using the **Comments** tab.

6.6. Glossary

The **glossary** is used to provide definitions of terms you use in **Knowledgebase articles**.

If you have a glossary entry for a term, then it is show underlined on the web portal the first time it appears in an article. Users can mouse over to see the full definition.

▪

This is useful to explain acronyms or technical terms which might confuse users.

The glossary is displayed at the bottom of the filter pane.

▪

To create a new definition:

- 1 Click **Add new glossary word**.
 -
- 2 Enter the term you wish to define in the top field, then press **Tab**.
- 3 Enter the definition and click **Add**.
 - A term can consist of more than one word.
 -
 - If you want several variations of a term to share the same definition, you can enter multiple versions
 -

Click an existing term to edit it.

6.7. Translations for Publish content

If your helpdesk has multiple languages enabled, Knowledgebase articles have a **Translations** tab for managing alternate language versions.

▪

Click on a language and edit the translation with the usual rich text editor.

The **Set contents from article** loads the untranslated text into the editor as a guide.

▪

6.8. Helping users find portal content

Editing the URL slug for portal content

An item's **URL Slug** is the text that appears at the end of the web address for the item on the web portal.

You can see the **URL Slug** for an item in its **Properties** tab. By default, this is based on the title of the item.

For example, if you had an **article** with the title "Diagnosing Shim Failure":

- its URL slug will be `diagnosing-shim-failure`
- its address on the portal will be something like `https://acmeinc.deskpro.com/articles/12-diagnosing-shim-failure`

Putting more descriptive text in the web address can help users find your help content through web search engines.

Click **Edit Slug** to change the URL text to something more descriptive.

▪

Click **Okay** to save your change.

Any links to the old address will be redirected to the new address, so don't worry that editing the slug will break any links, or stop users' bookmarks working.

Linking articles to products

On the **Properties** tab of an article, you can select related products. This improves navigation on the web portal.

Viewing revisions of portal content

Click the **Revisions** tab to see a list of previous versions of an item.

To see a comparison of exactly what changed between two versions:

- 1 Select the two versions to compare with the checkboxes on the right.
▪
- 2 Click **Compare Selected**.
- 3 The **Comparing Revisions** pop-up window opens, showing the differences.
▪

Setting related content

You can use the **Related Content** tab of an item to cross-reference it to other portal content.

- 1 Find related items in the list pane, then click the **Related Content** tab.
 -
- 2
 - icons appear next to the list items.
- 3 Click the
 - to link the two items.

Each of the linked items is shown under "Related articles" when viewed from the other item's portal page.

Setting search terms

You can ensure that an important article is always included in the top results for certain searches, regardless of keyword matching.

For example, you may have many articles which mention "maintenance" in their text, but only one which is a comprehensive maintenance guide and should always come up in response to a user search containing "maintenance".

Go to the **Search** tab of an item and enter search terms.

When a user searches for any of the terms you enter using the portal search function, the item will always be listed in their top results.

Labeling Publish content

As with other helpdesk content, labels you add to Publish items are used for matching in the agent Quick Search bar and displayed as a word cloud in the agent interface filter pane.

In addition, the labels you add to some types of content are displayed to users on the web portal.

If a user clicks on a label, they can browse similarly labelled items, and choose to filter them by type.

Labels are also used to return search results from the portal. If an item doesn't mention a relevant term in its main body, you can add that term as a label and the article will be returned in the search results. Unlike search terms, labels are not weighted any more heavily.

7. Feedback

The **Feedback** app lets you view and manage user suggestions from the web portal. This enables you to gather ideas to improve your products or services.

▪

As well as submitting items of feedback, users can vote and comment on them (depending on their permissions). This allows 'crowdsourcing' where users can identify the most popular ideas and discuss their pros and cons.

▪

Agents can also vote and comment on feedback.

7.1. Feedback types

Feedback submitted is organized by **type**. The possible types are set by your admins, but some examples would be:

- Suggestion
- Product idea
- Bug report
- Feature request

▪

Your admins can configure the helpdesk so that some types of feedback can only be submitted by particular usergroups. For example, you might take **Feature request** feedback only from members of the **Advanced users** usergroup, or **Bug reports** only from **Registered users**.

Feedback categories

Your helpdesk may also require users to select a **category** for their feedback. The categories available are chosen by your admins, based on what categories your helpdesk finds useful.

Examples of some possible sets of feedback categories:

- Delivery/Set-up/Usage/Maintenance
- Desktop/Mobile
- Software/Hardware/Packaging/Manuals/Accessories

▪

7.2. Feedback status

Feedback items have a **status** which tracks what your enterprise is doing with that item. Users can see the status on the web portal.

■

A feedback item starts out with **new** status. On the web portal, this is displayed as "Gathering Feedback".

■

Agents can then change the status to reflect what is happening with each feedback item.

The available statuses are chosen by your admins. You can have as many different statuses as you like, but they are divided into two main kinds:

- **Active** statuses - indicate that the feedback has been looked at by an agent, and your enterprise is going to do something further with it - for example, it is going to be studied further, or it is actively being implemented
- **Closed** statuses - indicate that your enterprise is not going to do anything further with the feedback - for example, it has been acted on or rejected

Examples of possible **Active** statuses:

- Under review
- Planning
- Started
- Testing

Examples of possible **Closed** statuses:

- Completed
- Duplicate
- Declined

Setting an item to a **Closed** status means it is **archived** on the web portal: still visible to users, but no further comments or votes will be accepted.

There are also **hidden** statuses, just as with tickets - items that have been **deleted** or **marked as spam** or are waiting for the user to validate their email address. Hidden items are not shown on the web portal.

7.3. Filtering and sorting feedback items

You can see an overview of feedback items in the filter pane.

▪

The **Pending** section shows feedback and comments that need agent approval before becoming visible on the web portal.

Your admins set the details of which items need approval.

The **Status** section shows all feedback items which don't need approval, filtered by status.

Use the **Type** or **Labels** tabs to filter by the relevant properties.

Approving pending feedback items and comments

Use the **Feedback to Validate** filter to approve pending feedback items.

▪

To approve feedback items individually:

- 1 Click on the feedback item. It opens in the content pane.
- 2 Use the **Disapprove/Approve** buttons in the upper left.
 -
- 3 Click **Approve** to move the feedback to **new** status.
*Or click **Disapprove** to delete the feedback. You can enter a brief explanation which will be emailed to the user who created it.*
 -

To approve feedback items with mass actions:

- 1 Select the items you want to delete using the check boxes to the left.
- 2 Click the **Perform Actions** button and select **Approve** or **Delete**.
 -

If you choose to **Delete** items with a mass action, you can enter a single explanation to send to all the users.

Use the **Comments to Review** filter to approve pending comments.

▪

Approving comments works like approving feedback, except that:

- you can't enter an explanation when deleting a comment
- you can **Edit** comments from the list pane; to edit a feedback item you need to open it in the content pane
- you can click the **Create Ticket** button to make a ticket based on the comment .

Working with feedback in the list pane

Click on a filter to view all its feedback items in the list pane.

▪

The number of votes for each item is displayed in a yellow circle.

▪

You can use the **Ordered by** control at the top of the list pane to sort feedback by:

- **Votes** - total user votes
- **Popularity** - popularity score (takes into account both the total number of votes received and how long it took to get those votes)
- **Date Created** - newest at top

▪

You can group by feedback **type** in the list pane:

▪

Note that if you have a **type** filter selected in the filter pane, you can group by status instead. ▪

To carry out **mass actions** on feedback, select items with the checkboxes on the left, then click **Perform Actions**.

Mass actions available for feedback items are:

- **Set status**
- **Set type**
- **Delete**
- **Mark as spam**

Searching for feedback

You can find feedback items by ID, title or labels using the **Quick Search bar**.

Advanced search is available from the **Feedback** app filter pane.

▪

Search only works for feedback items, not comments.

7.4. Working with feedback in the content pane

Click on a feedback item in the list pane to open it in the content pane.

From this view of a feedback item, you can view and edit it in detail.

You can change the **status** of the item using the pull-down menu at the upper left. If your helpdesk has a lot of different statuses, you can type in the search box at the top to filter them.

You can also click on the **Type** box to change the item's type (if your helpdesk uses types).

The **Properties** section enables you to apply a range of actions to the feedback item.

Next to the item's **Votes**, you can vote for it yourself by clicking the **+1** button. If you change your mind, you can withdraw your vote by clicking **+1** again.

Feedback item properties

Click **Edit Properties** to change the item's **category**.

You can also **Delete**, **Mark as Spam** and **Merge** the item.

Merging feedback items works like [merging tickets](#)

Click **Copy permalink** to see a permanent web address for this item that will not change even if you [edit the URL slug](#).

Click **View in user interface** to see the item on the web portal, as users would see it. Note that this shows you how the item will look on the web portal even if it is not currently being displayed to users because it is awaiting validation. In that case, you will see a reminder.

Editing the URL slug for a feedback item

The item's **URL slug** is the text that appears at the end of the web address for the item on the web portal. By default, this is based on the user-submitted title of the item.

For example, if the feedback item's title is "Leaky Valve":

- its URL slug will be `leaky-valve`
- its address on the portal will be something like `https://acmeinc.deskpro.com/feedback/view/17-leaky-valve`

Putting more descriptive text in the address address can help users find your content through web search.

Click **Edit Slug** to change the URL text to something more descriptive.

Click **Okay** to save your change.

Any links to the old address will be redirected to the new address, so don't worry that editing the slug will break any links, or stop users' bookmarks working.

Editing feedback item content

The **Description** tab at the bottom of a feedback item shows you the description submitted by the user.

Click the **Edit** button on the right to edit the description. This might be necessary to fix a formatting problem, or to remove sensitive information like passwords.

The **Comments** tab shows the comments on a feedback item.

▪

You can use the comment box here to add your own comment, which will be displayed to users on the portal.

Click the  icon to the upper right of an existing comment for options to:

- **Edit** the comment
- **Delete** the comment
- **Create a ticket** based on the comment

▪

Comments awaiting agent approval will have a **Validate** link at the top right. Click it for options to **Validate** or **Delete** the comment.

▪

Click the **Revisions** tab to see a list of previous versions of the feedback item.

To see a comparison of exactly what changed between two versions:

- 1 Select the two versions to compare with the checkboxes on the right.
▪
- 2 Click **Compare Selected**.
- 3 The **Comparing Revisions** pop-up window opens, showing the differences.
▪

8. Tasks

The **Tasks** app is a way to keep track of pieces of work agents need to do beyond dealing with tickets.

DeskPRO keeps a list of your outstanding tasks, and can send you a notification the day a task is due.

You can **delegate** tasks to other agents, and see when they have been completed.

Tasks can be **private** or **public**. Public tasks are visible to all agents. Private tasks you create are visible only to you and any agents you assign them to.

Tasks can be assigned to **teams** instead of single agents.

8.1. Creating a task

To create a new task:

- 1 Click the **Create** button in the toolbar, then **New Task**.
- 2 The **New Task** window opens.
 - Enter a description of the task.
- 3 To set a **due date** (optional), click on **No due date** and select a date from the calendar.
 - - If a due date is set, you can also choose to specify a time on that date.
- 4 By default, the task is **Public**.
 - You can make the task **Private** using the pull-down menu.
- 5 By default, the task is assigned to you. If you wish to delegate it, click **Me** and pick an agent or team from the pull-down menu.
 -
- 6 If you need to create more than one task, click **Add another task** and repeat the above steps.
- 7 When you are finished, click **Save**.

Creating a task linked to a ticket

You can create a task linked to a ticket, making the context for the task more obvious.

There are two ways to create a linked task. You can *either*:

- If a **ticket** is open in the content pane when you create a new task, the new task will be linked to it by default. ▪ If you don't want the task to be linked to the ticket, click the  icon to remove the link.
- or*
- Click on the **Tasks** tab of a ticket that is open in the content pane, and enter a task from there. ▪

8.2. Keeping track of tasks

The **Tasks** app filter pane shows you an overview of outstanding tasks.

You can filter tasks based on assignment and due date.

My Tasks shows tasks assigned to you.

My Teams' Tasks shows tasks assigned to any team to which you belong.

Tasks I Delegated shows any task you have delegated to another agent or team.

All Tasks shows every outstanding task that you are allowed to see:

- all public tasks
- any private tasks you have created or that have been delegated to you

Under each of these filters are sub filters based on due date, showing which tasks are **overdue**, which are **due today** and which are **due in future**.

If there is no due date set for a task, then it is always shown in the **Due Today** filter.

Click on any of these filters to see matching tasks in the list pane.

Task notifications

By default, you are notified when a task is assigned to you or your team, when a task you delegated is completed, and when a task that's assigned to you is due that day. You can configure your task notifications in the **Notifications** area of your account preferences.

8.3. Working with tasks in the list pane

Unlike most DeskPRO items, you can't open a task in the content pane.

Everything you need to do with tasks can be done in the list pane.

At the top of the list pane, you can choose to sort by **Date** (most overdue at top, shown here), **Assigned agent** or **Creator**.

▪

You can re-assign (delegate) a task by clicking the assigned agent or team, and selecting a new one from the pull-down menu.

▪

To mark a task **completed**, just use the checkbox to the left.

▪

8.4. Commenting on tasks

You can click on the **Add Comment** control to comment on a task.

■

9. Agent IM

Separate from the user chat system, DeskPRO also provides IM between agents.

Even if you are logged out of user chat, you will be available on the agent IM system. There's no way to sign out of agent IM, short of logging out of the agent interface completely.

You can see which of your fellow agents are online in a bar on the lower left of the agent interface:

■

Click the bar to expand the agent IM interface. This opens a chat window in the list pane.

■

You can initiate a one-to-one IM session with an individual agent by clicking their name.

You can also select the **Show Offline** checkbox to see agents who aren't currently logged in to DeskPRO.

Click the **Teams** tab to send an IM to a team, and the **Everyone** tab to send an IM to everyone.

If you send IMs to agents who aren't currently online, they will see them next time they log in to DeskPRO.

The agent IM system is used to send notifications about @mentions. When someone @mentions you in a ticket note, you can either respond to them via IM or by replying with another note with an @mention. The advantage of using notes to discuss a ticket is that they are kept as part of the ticket message history, so it's easier for other agents to find your discussion and see it in context.

You can view all old agent IM conversations (even if you weren't involved) using the **Chat History** link at the bottom right of the agent IM interface.

10. DeskPRO Terminology

Admin: staff member within your company who has administrator access to configure and customize your helpdesk

Agent: staff member within your company who uses DeskPRO to provide help

Article: in the context of DeskPRO, an article refers to a piece of **knowledgebase** content

Assignment: a ticket can be assigned to an agent or a team to track who is dealing with that ticket

CC: a user who is CCed on a ticket will receive notifications about its progress. The equivalent for agents is **following**

Chat: real-time instant messaging between agents and users; may be available to users from the web portal or integrated into a website

CRM: the app used for managing users and assigning them to **organizations** and **usergroups**; short for *Customer Relationship Management*

Downloads: useful files you provide to users through your web portal; e.g., software drivers or product manuals; maintained in the **Publish** app

Feedback: suggestions from users submitted through your **web portal**; e.g. a feature request or new product idea

Following: an agent added as a follower of a ticket can get notifications and see it in the **Tickets I Follow** filter; useful for keeping track of a ticket without being assigned to it

Glossary: part of the **Publish** app used to maintain definitions of terms which are automatically displayed in **knowledgebase** articles

Knowledgebase: part of the **web portal** which contains rich-text help **articles**

News: part of the **web portal** which displays news posts chronologically; useful for product announcements

Organizations: used to track the company or other enterprise a user belongs to; you can assign users to organizations using the **CRM** app, or DeskPRO can automatically assign organizations based on user email addresses;

Permissions: settings which control what an agent or user can do with DeskPRO; your agent permissions are set by your admins and might, for example, prevent you deleting tickets; a user's permissions depend on their **usergroup**

Publish: the app used to maintain content for the web portal: knowledgebase articles, news posts, downloads and glossary entries

SLAs: short for *Service Level Agreements*; goals for dealing with tickets that your helpdesk aims to meet, e.g. that you must reply to a new ticket within 4 hours; shown in the **Tickets** app.

Snippets: short pieces of text which you can quickly insert into messages to users; useful to save time entering standard greetings, phrases, canned answers etc.

Status: a ticket's status is used to track who needs to act on a ticket next: **awaiting agent** means the helpdesk must do something related to that ticket; **awaiting user** means the helpdesk is waiting for the user to reply; **resolved** means the issue that ticket represents has been resolved

Tasks: an app used to track "to-do" items for agents

Teams: agents are grouped into teams to enable group ticket assignment

Ticket: represents a user question, problem or complaint; can be created automatically from incoming user email, or by a user from the **web portal**, or by an agent on a user's behalf

Ticket email account or just **email account:** an email account that is linked to DeskPRO so that incoming emails are turned into tickets e.g. `support@example.com`

User: one of the people the helpdesk is trying to help

Usergroup: users belong to usergroups which determine what they are allowed to do and see when interacting with DeskPRO; created by admins, assigned with the **CRM** app

Web portal: the user-facing web interface of DeskPRO - can be integrated into your own website; help information on the portal is maintained using the **Publish** app